MONDAY
October 12, 2026

CHENNAI
CITY EDITION
20 Pages ₹ 5.00

THE HINDU

www.thehindu.com

INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Vol. 149 • No. 242
Regd. TN/ARD/110/2024-2026
RNI No. 1001/1957

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WORLD ARTHRITIS DAY

Freedom from Rheumatoid Arthritis

The Rheumatologist-Patient Partnership: Why Your Questions Matter

Dr. S Ramakrishnan
Consultant Rheumatologist

Good rheumatic disease care is not something done to a patient, but something built together with one. Current guidelines explicitly call for shared decision-making, where treatment choices reflect both clinical evidence and the patient's values, concerns and daily life circumstances. This means questions about side effects, cost, family planning or work schedules are not distractions - they are essential information for choosing the right path. Patients who ask questions, voice concerns and describe how symptoms affect their routine often end up with treatment plans that fit better and are followed more consistently. Your voice is a working part of your own care.

Arthritis Is More Than Joint Pain: Understanding the Many Faces of RMDs

Dr. R Porkodi
Consultant Rheumatologist

When people hear "arthritis," they often picture aching knees in old age. In reality, rheumatic and musculoskeletal diseases (RMDs) are a family of over 150 conditions - from wear-and-tear osteoarthritis to autoimmune diseases like rheumatoid arthritis and lupus, where the body's own immune system attacks healthy joints and tissues. Some affect only joints; others involve skin, eyes, lungs or blood vessels. Globally, RMDs affect an estimated 1.71 billion people and remain the leading cause of disability worldwide. Recognising this diversity matters, because each type needs a different approach to diagnosis and care. Understanding your specific condition is the first step toward managing it well and continuing to pursue your goals

Your Lungs, Skin and Eyes Can Speak Too: When Arthritis Is a Whole-Body Disease

Dr. M Hema
Consultant Rheumatologist

Many rheumatic diseases are systemic, meaning inflammation can extend well beyond the joints. Rheumatoid arthritis may affect the lungs; psoriatic arthritis brings skin and nail changes; axial spondyloarthritis can cause eye inflammation known as uveitis; lupus may involve skin, kidneys and more. These extra-articular signs are sometimes dismissed as unrelated, delaying recognition of the underlying disease. A persistent dry cough, unexplained rash, or sudden eye redness and pain in someone with joint symptoms deserves prompt medical attention. Viewing the body as connected, rather than treating each symptom in isolation, helps doctors reach an accurate diagnosis sooner.

Women and Rheumatic Diseases: Why Symptoms May Need a Different Conversation

Dr. T. Aarthipriya
Consultant Rheumatologist

Several rheumatic diseases, including rheumatoid arthritis and lupus, occur far more often in women, frequently emerging during reproductive years. Hormonal shifts across menstrual cycles, pregnancy and menopause can influence disease activity, and symptoms are sometimes attributed to hormonal changes or stress before an underlying rheumatic condition is considered. This can delay diagnosis. Women experiencing persistent joint pain, unusual fatigue or skin changes should feel able to raise these symptoms directly, rather than assuming they are routine. Tailored conversations between women and their doctors, covering family planning and life-stage-specific concerns, support better long-term disease control and wellbeing.

Remission Is Possible: What Does "Disease Control" Really Mean?

Dr. C Panchapakesa Rajendran
Consultant Rheumatologist

For many people newly diagnosed with inflammatory arthritis, remission can sound like an unreachable ideal. In modern rheumatology, remission means minimal or no detectable disease activity - little to no swelling, tenderness or elevated inflammation markers - allowing many patients to feel close to their pre-disease selves. It does not always mean a permanent cure, and some people achieve low disease activity rather than full remission, which can still allow a good quality of life. With current treat-to-target approaches, remission or low disease activity is a realistic goal for a substantial proportion of patients, especially when treatment begins early and is adjusted based on regular monitoring.

Is Every Joint Pain Arthritis? Learning to Recognise the Difference

Dr. P S Arul Rajamurugan
Consultant Rheumatologist

Not all joint pain is arthritis, and not all arthritis is the same. Occasional aches after exercise or a minor injury usually settle with rest. Osteoarthritis develops gradually, mainly in weight-bearing joints, and worsens with activity. Inflammatory arthritis, however, often brings swelling, warmth and stiffness that is worse in the morning and eases with movement. These differences matter because treatment approaches differ significantly between mechanical wear and immune-driven inflammation. Self-diagnosing from internet searches can delay appropriate care. If pain persists beyond a few weeks, is accompanied by swelling, or limits daily activities, it is worth having it properly assessed rather than assuming it will simply pass with age.

The Earlier the Diagnosis, the Better the Journey: Why Time Matters in Rheumatic Diseases

Dr. Ramesh S
Consultant Rheumatologist

In inflammatory arthritis, there is a "window of opportunity" - the early months when treatment can most effectively bring disease activity under control and help protect joints from lasting damage. Delayed diagnosis, on the other hand, allows inflammation to continue unchecked, which can be harder to reverse later. This is why persistent joint symptoms should prompt timely evaluation rather than a wait-and-watch approach. Early diagnosis does not guarantee an easy path, but it consistently improves the odds of preserving function and quality of life. For anyone hoping to keep working, playing with grandchildren, or pursuing personal goals, early action gives the best chance of staying on track.

Blood Tests for Arthritis: What Do ESR, CRP and Other Tests Really Tell Us?

Dr. S Sham
Consultant Rheumatologist

ESR and CRP are blood tests that measure general inflammation in the body, not aspecific disease. Raised levels can support a suspicion of inflammatory arthritis, but they can also rise with infections or other unrelated conditions, and can occasionally stay normal even in active rheumatic disease. Other tests, such as rheumatoid factor or anti-CCP antibodies, look for specific immune markers linked to particular conditions, but a positive result alone does not confirm a diagnosis, nor does a negative one rule one out. Blood testsare one piece of a larger clinical picture, interpreted alongside symptoms and examination findings - never the sole basis for a diagnosis.

When Your Hands Feel Weak: Is It Arthritis or Something Else?

Dr. V Krishnamurthy
Consultant Rheumatologist

Struggling to open a jar or grip a steering wheel can stem from several different causes, not only arthritis. Joint inflammation can weaken grip by causing pain that inhibits muscle effort, while nerve compression conditions such as carpal tunnel syndrome cause weakness through a completely different mechanism, sometimes with tingling or numbness rather than swelling. Muscle conditions are another, less common possibility. Because the underlying cause changes the treatment path significantly, hand weakness deserves proper assessment rather than an assumption either way. Noting whether weakness comes with joint swelling, numbness, or only after certain activities gives your doctor valuable clues toward the right diagnosis.

The Rheumatologist's Toolbox: How Arthritis Is Diagnosed Beyond a Blood Test

Dr. Brig K Shanmuganandan
Consultant Rheumatologist

Diagnosing rheumatic disease is rarely a single-test affair. Rheumatologists piece together a diagnosis from your history of symptoms, a careful physical examination of joints and other organs, selected blood tests, and sometimes imaging - much like assembling a puzzle rather than reading one definitive result. This is why a first visit often involves detailed questions about symptom timing, family history and pattern of joint involvement, alongside hands-on examination. No single test can diagnose most rheumaticdiseases in isolation. Understanding this process can help patients feel less anxious about"inconclusive" early tests and more confident that a thorough diagnostic approach is genuinely at work.

Can Arthritis Start Without Swelling?

Dr. R Ravichandran
Consultant Rheumatologist

Recognising the Less Obvious Symptoms
Textbook descriptions of arthritis often emphasise visibly swollen joints, but early disease does not always look this dramatic. Some people first notice only stiffness, a vague ache after activity, or subtle loss of grip strength, with little or no visible swelling for weeks or months. This can make early inflammatory arthritis easy to overlook, both by patients and, occasionally, in routine examinations. Persistent, unexplained joint discomfort - even without obvious swelling is still worth discussing with a doctor, particularly if it affects the same joints repeatedly or lasts beyond a few weeks. Subtle symptoms are still valid symptoms, and describing them clearly helps guide appropriate evaluation.

Do I Need to Take My Medicine When I Feel Better? Understanding Treatment Adherence

Dr. M.M. Kavitha
Consultant Rheumatologist

Feeling well is often the goal of rheumatic disease treatment - but feeling well usually means the treatment is working, not that the disease has gone. Stopping medication on your own once symptoms ease is a common but risky decision, as inflammation can return, sometimes more strongly, once treatment is withdrawn. Any changes to treatment, including tapering or stopping, are best made gradually and under medical supervision, based on sustained disease control over time. Discussing how you feel about your medication, including any concerns, openly with your rheumatologist supports decisions that protect the progress you have already made.

Swollen Fingers, Skin Changes and Joint Pain: Could It Be Psoriatic Arthritis?

Dr. S Balameena
Consultant Rheumatologist

Psoriatic arthritis often arrives quietly, sometimes years after skin psoriasis first appears - though occasionally the joint symptoms come first. A telltale sign is dactylitis, where an entire finger or toe swells into a "sausage" shape, along with nail pitting or ridging and tendon-area tenderness. Because it can affect skin, joints and tendons together, care often involves both dermatologists and rheumatologists working as a team. People with psoriasis who notice new joint pain, stiffness or swelling should mention this specifically, since it is not always volunteered during a routine skin check. Recognising the connection early allows more coordinated, effective management.

Beyond the Diagnosis: Better Care, Bigger Dreams

Dr. S Rajeswari
Consultant Rheumatologist

A rheumatic or musculoskeletal disease need not define the limits of your life. Early assessment by a rheumatology team, a clear treatment goal, and regular follow-up can help control inflammation, pain and fatigue while protecting movement and daily function. Good care is a partnership: discuss your priorities-whether work, family, travel, sport or independence and make decisions together. Ask for tailored education about your condition, safe physical activity, pacing, sleep, emotional wellbeing and when to seek help. Keep appointments and share any new symptoms or treatment concerns promptly. With informed self-management, support from loved ones and timely care, your goals remain important. This World Arthritis Day, let your health plan support your RMDreams.

Pain in the Heel, Pain in the Back: Could It Be Spondyloarthritis?

Dr. Thilagavathi
Consultant Rheumatologist

Heel pain and low back pain seem unrelated to most people, yet together they can point toward one condition: axial spondyloarthritis, which inflames the spine and the entheses, the sites where tendons and ligaments attach to bone. Heel pain from enthesitis, particularly at the back of the heel or sole, combined with back pain that eases with movement and worsens with rest, forms a recognisable pattern. This combination is often missed because heel pain and back pain are usually assessed separately by different specialists. Mentioning both symptoms together, rather than treating them as unconnected complaints, can help your doctor consider this important diagnosis

One Treatment Does Not Fit Everyone: The Move Towards Personalised Rheumatology

Dr. G Rajasekhar
Consultant Rheumatologist

Two people with the same diagnosis can respond very differently to the same treatment. Age, other health conditions, disease pattern, pregnancy plans and even personal preferences all influence which approach is likely to work best and remain safe over time. Modern rheumatology guidelines increasingly emphasise individualising treatment rather than applying a fixed formula to every patient. This is why your doctor may choose a different starting point or pace of treatment for you than for a family member or friend with a similar-sounding condition. Personalised care, guided by evidence but shaped around the individual, is now central to good rheumatic disease management.

"This is a patient awareness initiative by MSN Labs. The views and opinions expressed here are based on the expertise of the doctors and are not endorsed by MSN Labs. Readers are advised to seek necessary medical advice from a qualified medical practitioner."

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DEATH TOLL RISES

CM calls for peace as violence grips Manipur

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'IMMEDIATE EFFECT'

Ukraine, Russia reach 'energy truce', says Trump

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VOLATILE FRONT

India condemns Riyadh strike as citizen dies

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EVERY VOTE COUNTS

Confronting the democratic crisis

The situation extends beyond one EC to weak institutional safeguards

EDITORIAL & OPINION » PAGES 8 & 9

HAVING THE LAST LAUGH

India prevails in a high-scoring contest

SPORT » PAGE 15

NEARBY

Sixth POCSO Act case filed against Veeramani

CHENNAI
The Greater Chennai Police have registered one more case under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act against Gem Granites chairman R. Veeramani, taking the total cases against him to six. » PAGE 6

Rice mill body urges public not to panic-buy rice

MADURAI
The Tamil Nadu Rice Mill Owners' Association urged the public not to resort to panic buying of rice amid rumours on social media regarding a shortage in the State. » PAGE 6

EDUCATIONPLUS » PAGE 17, 18

Stop illegal detentions, says SC amid crackdown in Delhi

Top court directs Centre, Delhi Police to ensure free movement of people 'subject to law and public order'; Saturday's conditions a 'step away from police state', says lawyer who was detained

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

A day after mass detentions and a "curfew-like" clampdown on civil rights in Delhi, which senior lawyers compared to the 1975 Emergency, the Supreme Court convened what it called an "extraordinary, exceptional" Sunday hearing to direct the Union government and the Delhi Police to stop illegal detentions and allow free and smooth movement of people and traffic, as well as the operations of Metro and rail services, but "subject to law and public order".

A Special Bench of Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V. Mohana ordered the police to forthwith review the imposition of barricades on public roads, ensure that Internet connectivity was not disturbed, and lift prohibitory orders issued under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita in and around the Supreme Court and other courts of law in the capital to help litigants access lawyers and justice.

The court did not explicitly comment on the legality of the prohibitory orders.

State actions

Lawyers described a state crackdown that swept up thousands of people in an operation aimed at preventing them from gathering to demand the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged electoral irregularities. "Yesterday, we were one step away from a police state. Protect the right of citizens to peacefully protest in the capital city," senior advocate Shadan Farasat, who was dragged into a police van and detained for hours on Saturday, told the court.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 10

Special hearing

SC stresses need to uphold constitutional protections while preserving state's power to enforce reasonable restrictions

Directions to the police:

- Review imposition of barricades on public roads
- Ensure Internet connectivity is not disturbed
- No detentions except by law outside the 4-km prohibitory zone in Delhi
- Allow peaceful assembly outside the restricted zone

Rahul urges citizens to join march to SC

NEW DELHI
Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Sunday appealed to all citizens to join the INDIA bloc's march to the Supreme Court to submit a memorandum to CJI Surya Kant on the issue of alleged vote theft. » PAGE 10

Journalists, youth held as protest against CEC continues

Lavpreet Kaur
Nikhil M Babu
NEW DELHI

Rajya Sabha member John Brittas and All India Students' Association president Neha were among a number of protesters allegedly injured by security forces as they were being detained in Delhi on Sunday, the second day of a protest called by youth organisations demanding the exit of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Despite the Supreme Court's directives, around a dozen journalists were detained. There was no official data on the total number of detentions on Sunday. Activists alleged that they were beaten by security forces, which the Delhi Police denied.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 10
MORE REPORTS ON » PAGES 10 & 11

Fostering growth: Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay inaugurating projects at an event held on the IIT-Madras campus on Sunday. R. RAGU

Modi, Vijay pledge to work together for T.N.'s development

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Sunday committed themselves to maintaining healthy Centre-State relations and working together for Tamil Nadu's development.

Inaugurating a slew of projects, including the Metro Rail services on the Vadapalani-Poonamallee stretch, Mr. Modi said that while governments changed, his commitment to the development of Tamil Nadu and his service to its people had remained the same. "As the Chief Minister [of Gujarat], I had the opportunity to interact many times with (former Tamil Nadu Chief Ministers) Karunanidhi*ji* and *Amma* Jayalalithaa*ji*," he said.

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^Ex-showroom price, New Delhi in Lakh and rounded off to two decimal places. *Total benefit amount includes applicable cash, exchange, corporate or any other applicable offer/ benefits. Available only for limited period on select model and in select cities. Stock without benefits is also available. ^^Optional Accessory available at an extra cost from third party, to be fitted at Dealership. Warranty on such accessories is supported by Supplier. °Segment to be defined as sedans less than the length of 4 000 mm. ♡10 year Anytime Warranty: Extendable up to the maximum age of 10 years or 1 20 000 kilometers by renewing every year and is applicable from the date of purchase of car. Please refer to the owner's manual and Warranty Document for more details. #CNG: Govt. approved CNG retrofitment kit is provided by third party. CNG Kit warranty and any other related terms and conditions are applicable as specified by third party. Applicable on select models only. Black glass appearance on vehicle is due to lighting effect. Actual vehicle color, features, and specifications may vary from those shown and might not be part of standard fitment. Please check the availability of grade, colors, features, and offers at authorized dealerships. Honda Cars India Limited reserves the right to change or withdraw any colour, grade, feature, offers/ scheme or benefits without any prior notice. Scrappage benefits applicable on select models subject to receipt of valid certificate of deposit issued by RVSF. Honda SENSING (ADAS) cannot substitute human acumen and vigilance while driving. Honda Cars India Limited urges drivers to follow traffic rules which are meant to keep them safe on roads. All Honda cars manufactured in India since 1st Jan 2009 are E20 material compatible and customers can use E20 fuel in their existing cars without the need of changing any part in the car. For more information, please visit our authorized dealership or www.hondacarindia.com. For corporate sales enquiry please write to corporatesales@hondacarindia.com.

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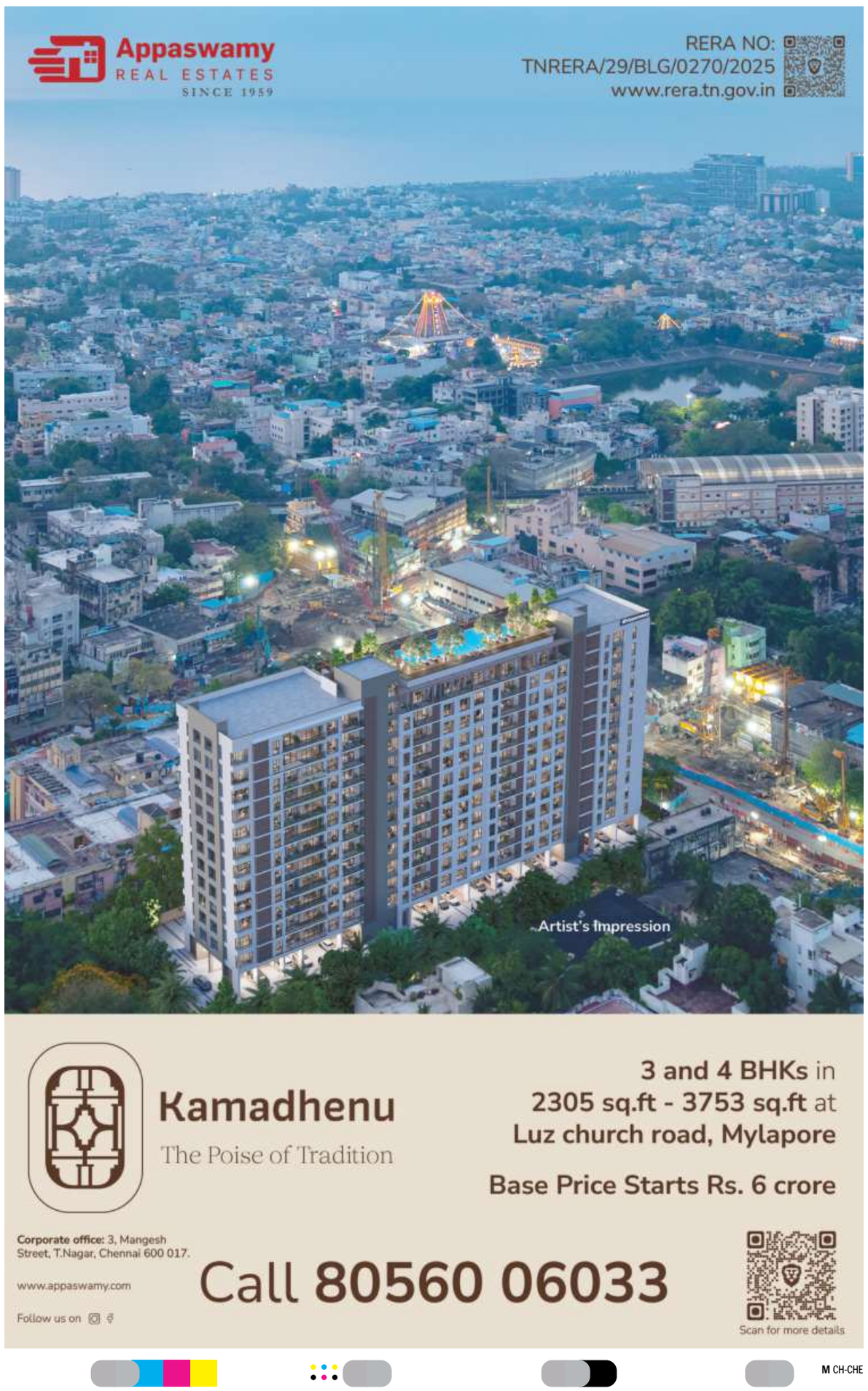

Bioluminescence lights up beaches along city's coast

Residents enjoy the sight of glowing waters at Thiruvanmiyur and Kovalam beaches; onlookers have been gathering along the city's coastline to catch a fleeting glimpse of this rare phenomenon

Rare occurrence: Narayanan, a fishing community leader, also said that many fishermen had spotted bioluminescence in the waters off Kovalam beach this season. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Sahana Mira S.
CHENNAI

At around 3:30 a.m. last Tuesday, surfer Saravanan. B, who runs Saro Surf School, was just making his way into the sea when he spotted bioluminescence; the waves off Kovalam beach lit up in electric blue. Since word of this rather unusual sighting made the rounds, many inquisitive onlookers have been gathering along the shore from dusk till dawn to catch a fleeting glimpse of this phenomenon first hand.

"I spotted it in 2024 too, and it was such a spectacular sight," said Mr. Saravanan. "I have witnessed it multiple times this month. But we can't plan an outing around it because it is unpredictable. Last night, we went to see it, but it did not make an appearance," he added.

Another resident, Sujith Sivakumar, recounted his experience of a bioluminescence sighting at Thiruvanmiyur beach at around 4:50 a.m. on Thursday. Describing it as a magical experience, he said, "Seeing the waves glow with an ethereal blue light against the dark shoreline felt completely surreal like something straight out of a fantasy film," he said.

Narayanan, a fishing community leader, also said that many fishermen had spotted this phenomenon in the waters off Kovalam this season.

Explaining the ecology of blue-lit coastline, ecologist Ranjit Daniels of Care Earth Trust noted that bioluminescence is a characteristic of many marine organisms inhabiting the deep sea, where they use it to communicate with each other. This is found in marine organisms like jellyfish, squids, deep-sea shrimps, and dinoflagellates, to name just a few. "Bioluminescence is a very well-known phenomenon among organisms that live in the deeper sea and use this ability for various survival purposes," he said.

According to a case study by Mishra et al. of the National Centre for Coastal Research, following a spell of heavy rain in 2019, there was an unusual occurrence of heterotrophic bioluminescent dinoflagellates along the Chennai coast.

Environmental factors

Regarding that year's sighting, the study noted that environmental factors such as high atmospheric temperatures change the sea surface temperature and increase the availability of dissolved nutrients. These conditions promote the growth of *Thalassiosira* (a type of microscopic algae), which provides favourable conditions for the rapid growth of *Noctiluca scintillans*, a plankton responsible for the blue bioluminescence sometimes seen in seawater.

Teachers' federation urges govt. to rescind order on meal duties

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu Government Employees Teachers Welfare Federation has urged the School Education Department to withdraw its announcement of appointing the same monitoring teacher for both the breakfast and the mid-day meal programme.

In a release, the federation noted that the move would leave the teachers with little time for teaching. In a circular, the Department had directed all primary education officers to notify nodal teachers to monitor the hygiene and preparation of the meals.

S. Arunan, president of the federation, said the government has been implementing many schemes in various forums and through NCC, Scouts and the NSS. He said that the order has upset all the teachers. The federation added that implementation of the move would be difficult in schools with only two teachers.

Cylinder blast in hut destroys jewellery, cash

CHENNAI: A cylinder blast caused a fire accident at a hut in Mogappair West on Sunday. Police said, Geetha, a 40-year-old flower vendor, managed to escape the thick smoke inside the hut, but two gas cylinders exploded. Five sovereigns of gold jewellery and ₹1.60 lakh in cash were destroyed in fire.

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PERSONAL

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I, SENTHIL R., S/o R. Ramalingam, residing at 405, Surendra Homes, Pallavaram, Ch–43, have changed my name to R. Senthil for all purposes.

I, S. Sadhana, D/o R. Senthil, residing at 405, Surendra Homes, Pallavaram, Ch–43, have changed my name to Sadhana S. for all purposes.

I, Vinoo Mathew Varghese, H/o Veena Mathew, residing at D2 T3, VGN Minerva, 273, Guruswamy Road, Nolambur, Chennai, Tiruvallur District, PIN - 600095., declare that my wife's name has been wrongly printed as Veena instead of Veena Mathew in my passport. Both names refer to one and the same person, who is my wife vide affidavit dated 01/10/2026 sworn before Notary, N. Geetha, Chennai.

PERSONAL

CHANGE OF NAME

I, J ABILASH son of John Peter, residing at 152/88 5th Street, annai sathya nagar, Greenways road, Chennai 600028, hereby declare that my name has been incorrectly printed as J ABIZASH in my 10th and 12th marksheet. My correct name is J ABILASH, Henceforth, I shall be known as J ABILASH for all purpose

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Navarathri Music concerts, Today 5 p.m Divya Yanmantra - Vocal, Avantika Saravanan, Thirucherai Kaushik, 6.30 p.m Neyveli Dr. S. Radhakrishna - Double Violin, Neyveli K. V. Ramkumar, H. Prasanna. All are welcome.

Sri Sringeri Jagadguru Sankara Math (Branch), Krupasankari Street, West Mambalam
12.10.2026 – 7.00 p.m. - Dr. Gayathri Girish – Vocal, R. Rahul, B. Sivaraman, Trichy Murali.

MISCELLANEOUS

Sri Sringeri Jagadguru Sankara Math (Branch), Krupasankari Street, West Mambalam
12.10.2026 – 9.00 am - Sri Mrutyunjaya, Sarvarogha Hara Shanthi, Aikya Mathya Sukta Homams; Chandi Parayanam, Veda Parayanam, Sahasranama Archanai, Suvasini & Kanya Pooja; 12.30 p.m – Annadhanam; 6.30 pm – Vrushabha Vahana Alankaram.

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May 17 cadre stage protest against Modi's visit to city

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Members of the May 17 movement organised a protest, waving black flags, against the visit of Prime Minister Narendra Modi in T. Nagar on Sunday.

May 17 movement founder Thirumurugan Gandhi said it was shameful that Mr. Modi had come to flag off the Chennai Metro Rail project, initiated under the DMK government, while also denying funds for the Coimbatore and Madurai Metro Rail projects. The police detained over 50 protesters and released them later in the evening.

Members of the Students' Federation of India and the Democratic Youth Federation of India staged a protest against Mr. Modi in Saidapet, condemning the attack on student protesters in New Delhi.

The police forcibly removed over 50 students and detained them in a nearby community hall.

Modi, Vijay flag off first train of Metro Rail's Phase II network

They also take a ride on the Metro from Porur Bypass to Poonamallee. With the launch of Poonamallee-Vadapalani stretch, the 54-km Phase II network has been expanded to 68 km. Regular passenger services will be operated from 7 a.m. to 9 p.m.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Metro milestone: Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay flagging off the first service of the Phase II network at Porur Bypass Station. (Right) They take a Metro ride till Poonamallee after the inauguration. PTI, ANI

Chennai Metro Rail's new chapter began on Sunday morning, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay flagging off the Phase II network from the Porur Bypass Station.

The 54-km Phase II network is now 68-km-long, following the opening of the Poonamallee-Vadapalani stretch.

On arrival at the Porur Bypass station around 11.30 a.m., Mr. Modi and Mr. Vijay were briefed on various aspects of the 118.9-km Phase II project, including the balanced cantilever project at Kathipara and the progress of tunnelling work.

Subsequently, both of them flagged off the first service, and boarded the next train for a ride from Porur Bypass to Poonamallee.

The 14.6-km stretch comprises 11 elevated stations – Poonamallee Bypass, Poonamallee Bus Stand, Poonamallee Government Hospital, Karayanchavadi, Kumananchavadi, Kattupakkam, Iyyappanthangal, Thelliyaragaram, Porur Bypass, Porur Junction and Vadapalani.

At Vadapalani station, both the Phase I and the Phase II networks intersect and are linked by an 'L' shaped skywalk. Commuters can use this facility to change trains from Phase II network to the Phase I network, and travel to various locations in corridor I (Wimco Nagar to Chennai airport) and corridor II (Chennai Central to St. Thomas Mount).

The regular passenger services will be operated from 7 a.m. to 9 p.m. from Monday.

Our efforts paid off: EPS

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami was present at the Chennai airport to receive Mr. Modi.

The former Chief Minister recalled the efforts made during the erstwhile AIADMK regime to implement the Phase II project.

"Even when funds from the Central government did not come through, it was the AIADMK government that allocated funds for the project and commenced work," Mr. Palaniswami said.

A journey between Poonamallee and Vadapalani will now take less than 40 minutes on the newly launched stretch. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

New stretch set to improve mobility, reduce travel time

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

A journey between Poonamallee and Vadapalani, which takes nearly an hour by road during peak hours, will now take under 40 minutes on the newly inaugurated Poonamallee-Vadapalani stretch of the Chennai Metro Rail's Phase II network.

The initial euphoria was high, with thousands of commuters looking to take a ride on the 14.6-km stretch, not only to experience the new network, but also to gauge how fast one could commute between the two localities.

Be it travelling for work or shuttling between the western suburbs and core areas of the city, the new stretch is set to be a game-changer, as mobility will improve significantly.

Thiruvikraman, a resident of Kattupakkam, had been eagerly awaiting the launch of this stretch. The Kattupakkam Metro Rail Station is less than five minutes from his residence. "Earlier, I dreaded commuting to Vadapalani during peak hours, as it would take me an hour. During weekends, I prefer to go to the mall there with my family, but it was a difficult commute not only due to traffic congestion, but also the cab ride, which would cost me ₹300-₹400. The new stretch will be convenient for me," he said.

Engineering students Harshita B. and Boomika D. were among the first to arrive at the Poonamallee Bypass Station. They often commute from their residence in Nazarathpet to Vadapalani and Anna Nagar by bus. "The bus ride will take about an hour owing to traffic. But now, we are excited that this new stretch is operational. The fare is reasonable, and the travel time is significantly less," Ms. Harshita said.

The Phase II network has several new features, such as charging points, half-height platform screen doors in the elevated stations, and digital route maps. Unlike the Phase I network, in which the trains have a separate ladies coach, the Phase II network has three-coach trains, with half a coach demarcated for women.

Commuters seek better frequency, timings of new services

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

For commuters who have been awaiting the opening of Chennai Metro Rail's Phase II network from Poonamallee to Vadapalani, the timings and frequency are a dampener.

Unlike the Phase I network where services begin as early as 5 a.m. and the last train departs at 11 p.m., trains in the Phase II network will be operated from 7 a.m. to 9 p.m. only. The peak hour and non-peak hour frequencies planned are 10 minutes and 15 minutes respectively.

Commuters say the train timings and frequency in the Phase II network are inadequate and do not align with their needs.

R.K. Ravichandran, of Iyyapanthangal, says it is disappointing that the operating hours have been reduced. "Many who leave town after 10 p.m. and return early in the morning will find these timings inconvenient. It is unfair that commuters are not fully benefiting from the project, even after having waited this long," he adds.

Azhagar Senthil, a social activist and a resident of Porur, says the Chennai Metro Rail should have completed the construction of the stretch long ago. "It is upsetting that it is incomplete even now. Due to the delays from their end, it is the passengers who have to suffer," he adds.

Sources say the operating hours have been reduced to facilitate the construction of six stations between Porur Junction and Vadapalani at night.

First-day rush: Many people turn up to travel on the Metro train from Poonamallee to Vadapalani. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Prime Minister urges students to take Tamil culture across country

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday appealed to students to dream big, think differently, and live without fear, emphasising that India's young generation had the potential to provide solutions to the world's challenges and lead the country towards becoming a developed nation by 2047.

"Today, the world is looking for solutions and you have the potential to provide those solutions," he told students at the Golden Jubilee celebrations of Jaigopal Garodia Hindu Vidyalaya Matriculation Higher Secondary School.

He called for a collective commitment to building Viksit Bharat by 2047, making India one of the world's top three economies, establishing the country as a global manufacturing hub, and contributing to the development of Tamil Nadu.

The Prime Minister then spoke about the importance of preserving the Tamil language and culture. "I encourage you to discover India. Wherever you go, carry the Tamil culture with you. Share Tamil poetry, stories, and traditions with friends. Make friends with people from different backgrounds. Our nation's unity is built by the friendships you forge," he said.

He also highlighted the timeless wisdom of *Thirukkural* and the influence of Mahakavi Subramania Bharati's years in Kashi on his national outlook.

Mr. Modi recalled how the school began in 1975 with just seven students and limited infrastructure in West Mambalam, and has since grown into a network of 15 establishments.

He then touched upon the evolving education landscape in India and the National Education Policy.

Mr. Modi also spoke of the growing importance of sports. He expressed confidence that the talent, determination, and capabilities of the country's youth would help India achieve significant milestones in sports and other fields.

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	36	24
Chennai Airport	36	27
Chennai City	35	27

Chennai Airport Today
36°C The weather will be mostly dry. The day will be very warm with an uneasy afternoon. The night will be comfortable.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
36°C The weather will be dry. The day will be very warm and uneasy. The night will be comfortable.

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Timings
CHENNAI

MONDAY, OCT. 12			
RISE	05:59	SET	17:52
RISE	07:10	SET	18:55
TUESDAY, OCT. 13			
RISE	05:59	SET	17:52
RISE	08:03	SET	19:40
WEDNESDAY, OCT. 14			
RISE	05:59	SET	17:51
RISE	08:56	SET	20:27

THE HINDU
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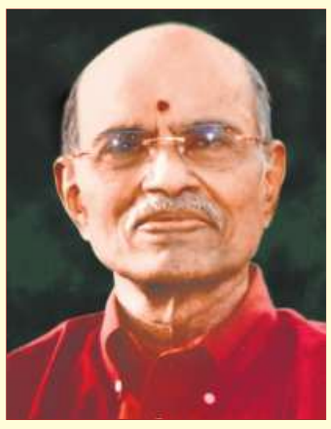
OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

12th YEAR ANNIVERSARY



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BIRTH CENTENARY

BIRTH CENTENARY

MAISIE DOREEN PADMA LAWRENCE

This day, Monday, 12th October 2026 is a special day in our life.

Our mother MAISIE DOREEN PADMA LAWRENCE, nee Silas
Who left us on September 11, 2016,

would have celebrated her 100th birthday (12th October 1926).

We are blessed to have had her as our Mother.

Our beloved loving mother, **Maisie Doreen Padma** was a woman who defined the purest form of love & grace & taught us contentment, compassion and humility.

My Mother made everyone feel important. She was always there to listen. My Mother had happiness, an inner joy that bubbled up from inside her. My Mother was not only beautiful, but her beauty was also in the elegant way she carried herself.

She laid great emphasis on looking at life in a positive way. She always told us to continuously Praise the Lord! I grew up in a house where I have never heard my Mother complain, because she was filled with a loving God who gave her strength to cope with any situation. God's Spirit lived in her.

Classical Indian Music was one of her subjects for graduation. Mummy got her first Veena at the age of eight, and could play any song by listening to the tune!

Mummy was a prolific letter writer. Pages can be written of my Mummy's hospitality, selfless sacrifice, kindness, generosity and above all her love for me was beyond measure.

Just as my Father loved her, my Mother's every breath was my Father. We Thank and Praise God for the blessing of loving parents.

A man of integrity, Daddy retired as the Director of School Education, Tamilnadu and was known as the Architect of Higher Secondary School Education in Tamilnadu and also, the Father of Vocational Education, Tamilnadu.

We miss you dearly Daddy and Mummy

You will always live in our hearts.
Ashalatha and **Sidney Ponniah**
Usha Rajendran
Grandchildren and **Great Grandchildren**

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

FIRST ANNIVERSARY

Mr.K.A.Narayanan
D.O.B - 12.08.1930 D.O.D - 12.10.2025
Deputy Director (Retd),
Ministry of Labour & Employment, New Delhi.
Fondly Remembered by
Friends & Relatives
aruna_anantha@yahoo.com

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

TWENTY EIGHTH ANNIVERSARY

M.MARIAPPA PILLAI
Retd.Chief Accounts Officer
Custom House, Chennai
Founder
SOLAIMALAI CORPORATION
Customs Broker, Chennai

IN MEMORIAM

IN LOVING MEMORY

Thirumathi. D.A. INIMAI
Loved Forever and Always
D. RAMESH RAJAN & FAMILY

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES
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ISSN 0971 - 751X

Minorities Welfare Minister A.M. Shahjahan, SBI Chennai Circle CGM Vivekanand Choubey, and CREDAI national president-elect G. Ram Reddy releasing a report by Jones Lang LaSalle on Sunday.

'Chennai accounts for 51.5% of Tamil Nadu's residential launches'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNNAI

Chennai accounts for 51.5% of Tamil Nadu's residential launches, while plotted developments account for 79% to 88% of launches in secondary growth corridors, said a report released during the fifth edition of CREDAI Tamil Nadu's STATECON 2026, which began in Chennai on Sunday.

Simplifying regulatory approvals, improving access to finance, and adopting Artificial Intelligence and robotics in construction were discussed at this year's conference, the theme of which was 'Tamil Nadu 2036 - Building the Next Decade Towards a $1.5 Trillion Economy'.

The report by Jones Lang LaSalle (JLL), a global commercial real estate and property consultancy, was released jointly by Minister for Minorities Welfare A.M. Shahjahan, SBI Chennai Circle Chief General Manager Vivekanand Choubey, and CREDAI national president-elect G. Ram Reddy during the inaugural session of the conference.

The report examines how economic growth and real estate development are spreading beyond Chennai to Coimbatore, Madurai, Tiruchi, Hosur, Salem, and Thoothukudi.

It identifies opportunities in industrial, residential, and commercial real estate, driven by manufacturing, logistics, technology, and infrastructure investments.

It also flags gaps in housing supply, social infrastructure, and organised development in emerging cities, and recommends faster project approvals, land pooling, transit-oriented planning, and more affordable housing to support Tamil Nadu's ambition of becoming a $1.5-trillion economy by 2036.

A panel discussion on ease of doing business brought together senior government officials, including Tamil Nadu Real Estate Regulatory Authority Chairperson K. Phanindra Reddy, Additional Chief Secretary Rajesh Lakhoni, Principal Secretary for Housing and Urban Development R. Kirlosh Kumar, and Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority Member-Secretary A.R. Rahul Nadh.

CREDAI Tamil Nadu president W.S. Habib said the State had the economic base, talent, infrastructure, and entrepreneurial strength to enter a new phase of growth. He said real estate would play an important role in supporting urban development over the coming decade.

New CREDAI chapters

The conference also saw the induction of five new CREDAI city chapters in the Nilgiris, Kodaikanal, Vellore, Thanjavur, and Karur, expanding the organisation's presence across Tamil Nadu.

The first day's sessions examined changing homebuyer preferences, financing, growth beyond major cities, and emerging real estate markets. FAIRBUILD 2026, held alongside the conference, provided a business platform for developers, suppliers, and technology companies.

17 families relocated from streets to shelter

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) has relocated 17 families living on the streets in Chepauk and Peters Road to temporary accommodation at a family shelter on Marina Beach, as part of its rehabilitation measures.

The families were relocated on October 9 by the Community Development Department of the GCC. Transport was arranged to move the families and their belongings safely to the shelter, according to a press release.

The shelter, built to accommodate families on Marina Beach, has been completed and is now being used to provide temporary accommodation to those relocated from the two areas.

The GCC has also made arrangements to provide the families with three meals a day, drinking water and sanitation facilities, taking into account their basic needs.

The Community Development Department would continue to take measures to ensure the safety, basic needs and dignity of the families living on the streets, the release said.

Two persons killed in road accident

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Two persons were killed after a man lost control of his two-wheeler and hit a truck on the Maduravoyal Bypass Road near Vanagaram on Saturday.

The Avadi police said Yukesh Kumar, 23, a resident of Thiruverkadu, was working as a storekeeper at a private company.

The accident occurred when he was going to attend a personal work with his friend, Sathyabharathi, 19, riding pillion. When the two-wheeler hit the lorry, both were thrown off the vehicle. They sustained severe head injuries, and died on the spot.

The police have detained the lorry driver, Karthik, 25, of Arcot.

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Brief E-TENDER NOTICE

e- Tender Notice No :-
1) SHAR / CMD / E / D 2687204 / 2026-27, Dated: 07-10-2026
2) SHAR / CMD / E / O 2687215 / 2026-27, Dated: 07-10-2026

On behalf of President of India, Item Rate tenders are invited through e-tendering for the following works:

Sl. No.	Name of Work	Value
1	**Electrical works for construction of test control centre at SMP & ETF area, SDSC SHAR (Electrical work)**	₹ 235.23 Lakhs
2	**Extension and Refurbishment of Old Sigma Mixer Building to establish new sample casting facility [Construction of building, Civil renovation works in existing building, BT paved area etc.,] at SMPC Unit-I, SDSC SHAR. (Electrical work)**	₹ 32.69 Lakhs

Last date for sale (Tender documents can be downloaded) upto **26-10-2026**, **14:30 hrs**.For eligibility criteria and other details, interested tenderers may please refer to the detailed bilingual (Hindi-English) Notice Inviting Tenders (NIT) on the website **https://www.isro.gov.in/Tenders.html** and tender free view at **https://www.tenderwizard.com/ISRO**

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Tender Notice No. ICF/PCMM/EOT/41/2026 Dated: 09.10.2026

The following e-tenders are published in IREPS website. Firms are requested to login to **www.ireps.gov.in** and quote against these tenders. Manual quotations will not be entertained for these tenders. Closing and Opening time for all tenders are **14.15 hrs.** Hindi version of tender notice is available on website **www.icf.indianrailways.gov.in**

Sl. No.	Tender No.	Tender Title	Quantity	Due Date
01.	06260157	S&I OF BIO-TANK LH & RH, LHB-S TRAP	1500 NO'S	22/10/2026
02.	06261965	SET OF 2 X 685 LIT WATER TANK	340 SET	22/10/2026
03.	02262073	TROUGH FLOQR ARRGT (KM DTC RVNL)	71 SET	23/10/2026
04.	02262074	Set of Corrugated sheet floor (KM MC & TC RVNL)	214 SET	23/10/2026
05.	02262155	SHELL KIT (RAPID METRO M)	25 SET	26/10/2026
06.	07262720	S & I FRP PANELING FOR SIDE WALL	57 SET	26/10/2026
07.	07263178	SUPPLY & INSTALLATION OF 3 SEATER COMP(DBL) for EMU/3P-SSTEEL	740 NO'S	26/10/2026
08.	07262886A	WB IMPREG COM.LAN.SHT6X1220X2440	2702 NO'S	27/10/2026
09.	08261855	CABLE 25 SQ MM YELLOW & BLUE 1.8 KV	17200 METRE	27/10/2026
10.	07262854	S & I OF EMERGENCY OPENABLE WINDOW FOR MEMU/US COACHES	2231 NO'S	28/10/2026
11.	08261862	CABLE 2.5 SQ MM CHOCOLATE 1.8 KV	138700 METRE	28/10/2026
12.	02261991	BEARING BRACKET FOR SCHAKU COUPLER	764 NO'S	30/10/2026
13.	02260124	C/S of Side wall Assembly (VB Sleeper TC)	30 SET	30/10/2026
14.	02262024	C/S of Roof, Side Wall and End Wall (LS)	30 SET	30/10/2026
15.	01265486	Advanced Car Body Integration Jig for Vande Bharat Chair Car/Sleeper.	1 NO	30/10/2026
16.	02260164	C/S of Frame work, Welding parts and Carline (VB Sleeper DTC)	25 SET	02/11/2026
17.	03262180	NON-ASBESTOS BASED "K" TYPE HIGH FRICTION COMPOSITION BRAKE BLOCK'	19591 NO'S	02/11/2026
18.	08261835	S&I E.P BRAKE EQPT MEMU/TC/JK, MEMU/NDMC/JK & MEMU/DMC/JK	Refer IREPS Website	02/11/2026
19.	02262006	C/S OF ROOF & SIDE WALL (MEMU DMC)	27 SET	02/11/2026
20.	08261761	HIGH VOLTAGE PT VB SPARE	18 NO'S	03/11/2026
21.	03262333	BRAKE DISC FOR AXLE MOUNTED BRAKE SYSTEM	723 SET	04/11/2026
22.	02261987	C/S OF CRF TROUGH FLOOR PART (MEMU DMC, NDMC & SPIC)	29 SET	05/11/2026
23.	03261954	Bogie general arrangement for KOL METRO MC, TC, DTC Bogie items	Refer IREPS Website	05/11/2026
24.	02262240	END WALL (MEMU DMC)	33 NO'S	06/11/2026
25.	02262083	End wall (LWACCN PP, LWACCW PP & LWFAC PP)	72 NO'S	06/11/2026
26.	02260121	C/S of Sidewall Assembly (VB Sleeper NDTC)	5 SET	09/11/2026
27.	02261894	C/S OF SOLE BAR	215 SET	10/11/2026
28.	08260193	PROPULSION ELECTRICS FOR VANDE BHARAT TRAIN SETS	Refer IREPS Website	20/11/2026

CORRIGENDUM NO. 41

Corrigendum has been issued to the following tender. Please check IREPS website for further details.

Sl.No.	Tender No.	Existing value	Modified value
01.	02261666	Additions of Drawing, Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
02.	02261973	18/10/2026	15/10/2026
		EMD 569920	325670
		Item Description Modified and Additions and Deletions of Drawings. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
03.	02261817	05/10/2026	21/10/2026
04.	02261915	Postponement of due date on 15/10/2026. Item Description Modified and Additions and Deletions of Drawings. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
05.	02261650	Deletions of Drawing, Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
06.	02261739A	Postponement of due date on 22/10/2026. Item Description Modified, EMD, Quantity and Additions and Deletions of Drawings. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
07.	02261736A	Postponement of due date on 22/10/2026. Item Description Modified, EMD, Quantity and Additions and Deletions of Drawings. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
08.	07261935	08/10/2026	16/10/2026

INTEGRAL COACH FACTORY, CHENNAI - 38

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

Principal Chief Medical Officer, Integral Coach Factory, Chennai - 600 038 invites Application in sealed cover for empanelment for the treatment / Procedures from the Eye Hospitals who are interested to participate on or before **03/11/2026 at 11.00 hours** to the office of the Principal Chief Medical Officer, Integral Coach Factory Hospital, Chennai - 600 038.

1.	Tender Notice No.	**No. MD/ICF/34/Empanel/EYE. Dt. 08-10-2026**
2.	Name of the E.O.I	Ophthalmic Treatment Procedures as per CGHS Chennai-2025 Rates.
3.	Eligibility	All empanelled CGHS, ECHS and ESI Eye Hospitals who are willing to accept the rates prescribed by the Central Government Health Scheme presently in vogue.
4.	Terms and conditions	To be downloaded from the below mentioned website at Sl.No.8.
5.	Period of Empanelment	Two years (As per Empanelment schedule)
6.	Date and time for submission of EOI	**Upto 11.00 hrs. 03/11/2026**
7.	Date and time for opening of Tender	**At 11.30 hrs. 03/11/2026**
8.	Website Address	**www.icf.indianrailways.gov.in**

Contact Phone : No.**044 26146633, 26146639 & 26146640.**

Principal Chief Medical Officer
For and on behalf of the President of India

THE HINDU GROUP

SAVEETHA
INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL AND TECHNICAL SCIENCES
(Declared as Deemed to be University under Section 3 of UGC Act 1956)

PRESENTS

THE HINDU
Sustainability Dialogues 2026

Intelligent Healthcare for a Sustainable and Human-Centered Future

The Future of Medicine: Harnessing AI for Better Healthcare

At the intersection of AI, medicine and engineering, a new era of healthcare is taking shape. The Hindu Sustainability Dialogues brings together experts to explore how technology can drive smarter, more sustainable healthcare while keeping it ethical, inclusive and human-centred.

Chief Guest

Dr K G Arunraj
Minister for Health, Medical Education, & Family Welfare, Government of Tamil Nadu

Guest of Honour

Dr N M Veeraiyan
Chancellor, SIMATS, Chennai

Inaugural Session: 10:00 am – 10:45 am

Fireside Chat: 10:50 am – 11:15 am

Topic: Future Healthcare Systems: Convergence of Artificial Intelligence and Medicine

Panelist: Dr K G Arunraj
Minister for Health, Medical Education, and Family Welfare, Government of Tamil Nadu

Moderator: Ramya Kannan
Health Editor & Chief of Bureau (TN), The Hindu

Panel Discussion 1: 11:35 am – 12:35 pm

Topic: Artificial Intelligence-Driven Healthcare: Innovation, Ethics, Accessibility and Sustainability

Panelists:
Dr Richa Pant
Director, Research, DeepTek

Dr Sindhuja Giritharan
Clinical Lead, Digital Health & Patient Engagement, Sundaram Medical Foundation.

Dr A Hariharan
Associate Professor, Department of Transfusion Medicine, Saveetha Medical College, SIMATS

Reuben Fernandes
Founder & CEO, Skyfire Applied Intelligence Pvt Limited (Atom360)

Moderator: Zubeda Hamid
Senior Assistant Editor, The Hindu

Panel Discussion 2: 12:40 pm – 1:40 pm

Topic: Human Touch in the Age of Artificial Intelligence: Preserving Compassion, Trust, and Ethics in Modern Medicine

Panelists: Dr Abdul Ghafur
Senior Consultant and Adjunct Professor in Infectious Diseases, Apollo Hospitals, Chennai

Dr K Ganapathy
Honorary Distinguished Professor, IIM Jammu, Distinguished Professor, The Tamil Nadu Dr. M.G.R Medical University, Emeritus Professor, National Academy of Medical Sciences

Dr S Iniyan
Professor & Clinical Head, Department of Psychiatry, Saveetha Medical College, SIMATS

Moderator: Geetha Srimathi S
Senior Reporter, The Hindu

Vote of Thanks: 1:45 pm

Tuesday, Oct 13, 2026 | 10:00 am onwards
Kurinji Hall, Saveetha Medical College and Hospital, Thandalam, Chennai – 602105

Scan the QR Code to watch the event live
newsth.live/THSASDY
Entry by Invitation only

From Page One

Modi, Vijay pledge to work together for T.N.'s development

"And, after becoming the Prime Minister, I had the opportunity to work with Jayalalithaa*ji*, O. Panneerselvam*ji*, E. Palaniswami*ji*, and M.K. Stalin*ji*. And, today, with that same commitment, we are taking this journey of Tamil Nadu's development forward together with Chief Minister Joseph Vijay," Mr. Modi said.

Earlier, Mr. Vijay assured Mr. Modi that his government believed that when the Union and State governments worked together, the benefits would be reflected in the lives of the people.

"Tamil Nadu continues to contribute to India's progress in industry, science, education, arts, literature, and social justice. Strong States make a strong India. Tamil Nadu has always been the foundation for India's economic, social, and cultural progress," he said.

At an event held at the Kendriya Vidyalaya on the IIT Madras campus, Mr. Modi said that as the Chief Minister, he had personally understood the expectations of States. After becoming the Prime Minister, he had not only sought to fulfil those aspirations but had also made every effort to help each State achieve its own goals. "We want to build a Tamil Nadu that keeps reaching new heights. And, for this, whatever support is needed from the Centre, we stand with you with full commitment. Let us together realise the resolve of a developed India through a developed Tamil Nadu. With this spirit, once again, I extend my heartfelt congratulations and best wishes to all of you for these projects," he said.

Mr. Modi said urban development was one of the priorities in Tamil Nadu. "I have always believed that urbanisation is not a challenge, but an opportunity. And public transport plays a very important role in this. When transportation is good, it improves the ease of living. We all know that merely widening roads is not enough to create better transportation. In modern cities, we need holistic infrastructure," he said. The Prime Minister also visited the Sudha Gopalakrishnan Brain Research Centre at IIT-Madras.

Vijay urges Modi to sanction Metro Rail from Hosur to Bommasandra

The CM says the inter-State link will benefit both T.N. and Karnataka. He also urges Modi to reconsider Metro Rail projects in Coimbatore and Madurai in view of the future development and economic growth of T.N.'s western and southern regions

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday urged Prime Minister Narendra Modi to sanction the inter-State Metro Rail link between Hosur in Tamil Nadu and Bommasandra in Karnataka for the benefit of both States.

Participating in the inauguration of passenger services on the Chennai Metro Rail stretch from Poonamallee Bypass to Vadapalani, covering 11 elevated stations, and the foundation-laying ceremony for new projects, Mr. Vijay urged the Prime Minister to reconsider the proposals for Metro Rail projects in Coimbatore and Madurai in view of the future development and economic growth of western and southern Tamil Nadu. The event was held at the Kendriya Vidyalaya on the IIT-Madras premises.

"I take this opportunity to request that Phase III of the Chennai Metro Rail project, covering approximately 65 km from the Airport to Kilambakkam, Poonamallee to Sunguvarchatram, and Koyambedu to Pattabiram, be approved early to improve connectivity, strengthen public transport, and ensure comprehensive coverage of the Chennai Metropolitan Area," Mr. Vijay said.

A warm welcome: Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay at the function held on the IIT-Madras campus in Chennai on Sunday. R. RAGU

He said Tamil Nadu would create new opportunities and aim to become a $1.5-trillion economy by 2036 by implementing schemes in agriculture, information technology, and industry.

"To take growth to the next level, we are giving importance to innovation, investment, and infrastructure. At the same time, the benefits of development should go beyond Chennai and reach every district," he said.

High-speed rail services

Mr. Vijay thanked the Prime Minister for announcing two high-speed rail corridors connecting Bengaluru, Hyderabad, and Chennai in the Union Budget 2026, saying the projects would benefit these regions. "We have already made a request to the Government of India for sanctioning high-speed rail corridors from Chennai to Kanniyakumari and Chennai to Coimbatore to better serve Tamil Nadu. This will also benefit the tourism sector," he said.

The Chief Minister also urged the Centre to accord priority to several infrastructure projects, including the widening of the Chengalpattu-Tiruchi section of Grand Southern Trunk Road (NH32), Tiruchi-Panjapur-Jeeyapuram-Karur section of NH81; and an elevated corridor from Madhavaram to Sholavaram on NH87.

"Timely approval and implementation of these projects will greatly support the economic development of the nation," he said.

Interlinking of rivers

Reiterating that the interlinking of rivers was essential to ensure water equity across the States, Mr. Vijay said the Godavari-Cauvery river-linking project should be accorded priority as it presented an important opportunity to augment water resources in the southern States.

Recalling a resolution adopted by the Tamil Nadu Assembly seeking the use of Tamil as the principal language in the proceedings of the Madras High Court, Mr. Vijay said a proposal seeking the President's consent had been sent and should be considered.

Mr. Vijay added that ₹5,110 crore, representing the Centre's share under the Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan (SSA), was due to Tamil Nadu and urged the Centre to release the amount without imposing any conditions.

A TVK cadre with the placard at the event held in IIT-Madras on Sunday. R. RAGU

TVK cadre show placards hailing Vijay as 'next PM'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A section of the cadre of the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) blew whistles, the party's election symbol, while Prime Minister Narendra Modi was addressing an official function on the IIT-Madras campus on Sunday.

Seated in the last row, the cadre erupted in cheers and blew whistles whenever Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay's name was mentioned. They continued the display even while Mr. Modi was speaking. They blew whistles and held placards and posters featuring Mr. Vijay's photographs and slogans hailing him as the "Next PM".

As their actions caused a disturbance, the police asked them to behave. The cadre calmed down briefly, but resumed their activities later.

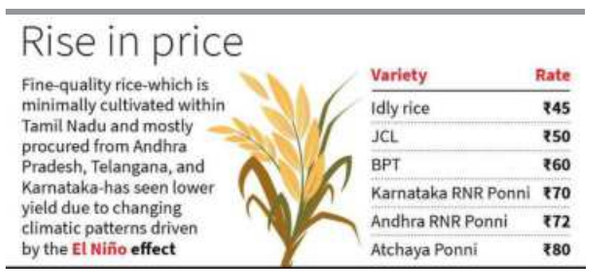
Rice mill owners urge public not to resort to panic buying amid rumours of shortage

The Hindu Bureau
MADURAI

The Tamil Nadu Rice Mill Owners Association has urged the public not to resort to panic buying of rice due to rumours circulating on social media regarding a shortage in the State.

During a press meet held in Madurai on Sunday, association leaders clarified while there had been a reduction in cultivation caused by the Super El Niño effect, the situation was not alarming and adequate reserves remained in stock.

Association president M.R. Dinesh Singh said the generally preferred fine-quality rice (*sannarisi*), which was minimally cultivated within Tamil Nadu and mostly procured from neighbouring states such as Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, and Karnataka, had seen lower yields due to changing climatic patterns driven by the El Niño effect. "It is true that the prices have gone up specifically for the fine rice quality, but other varieties such as *ganaragam* remain the same," he pointed out.



Mr. Singh clarified that the elevated prices were expected to decrease gradually following positive cultivation outcomes in Andhra Pradesh and Telangana, as well as the upcoming Northeast monsoon. "Though the *Kuruvai* cultivation is a failure this year, these positive developments will definitely control the prices before January," he said.

As cultivation was affected and shortage indicators emerged, traders and farmers began purchasing rice in large quantities from neighbouring States, which subsequently triggered high demand and price increases, he said.

To counter such challenges in future, Mr. Singh said the Tamil Nadu government, which, according to him, had not taken active steps toward promoting the cultivation of fine-quality rice varieties locally, should initiate research and development efforts to boost the State production.

"As people 15 years ago moved largely from coarse varieties to fine-quality rice varieties, the cultivation in the State could not match the need. This caused the need to import from neighbouring States," he recalled.

Once fine varieties start growing successfully in Tamil Nadu, the State can effectively manage any future shortages or scarcities, he said. Another major demand raised by the association was the provision of adequate facilities for farmers to dry their paddy and store it for future use.

Sixth POCSO Act case booked against 'Gem Granites' Veeramani

S. Vijay Kumar
CHENNAI

The Greater Chennai Police have registered one more case under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act against Gem Granites chairman R. Veeramani.

The case was registered on the basis of statements given by two minors stating that they were sexually abused by the businessman. The allegations were clubbed and probed as one case. With this, the police are investigating the alleged exploitation of 10 minor girls in all the six cases, police sources said on Sunday. This is the sixth case registered under the POCSO Act against the octogenarian, who has also been booked in a case of abetment of suicide of a minor in 2004, the sources said.

Investigators will take custody of Mr. Veeramani in the second POCSO Act case soon. He was examined by the police in the first case, in which video evidence was available and the complainant was eventually identified by the police. Meanwhile, a search was launched on the residential premises of Veeramani on Lloyd's Road at Royapettah. Acting on specific information, the police conducted the searches, the sources said. "We have filed a request in the designated court requesting custody of the accused for questioning in another case," a senior police officer said.

R. Veeramani has also been booked in a case of abetment of suicide of a minor in 2004. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Mr. Veeramani and his associates were arrested in the first case and lodged at Puzhal Central Prison. They were later detained under the Goondas Act. The accused would be formally arrested in all other cases, the sources said.

(Assistance for overcoming suicidal thoughts is available on the State's health helpline 104, TeleMANAS 14416 and Sneha's suicide prevention helpline 044-24640050)

CEA Anantha Nageswaran releases 'white paper' on AI, automation, and workforce

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Economic Advisor (CEA) to the Government of India V. Anantha Nageswaran on Sunday released a privately authored 'white paper' titled *AI, Automation and India's Workforce: Who Gains, Who's Exposed, and How Policy Can Shape the Future*.

The paper was authored by Vidya Mahambare, chairperson of the Centre for Finance and Economics Research at Great Lakes Institute of Management, Chennai; Vivek Jadhav, assistant professor of economics at the Institute of Management Technology, Ghaziabad; and Vishnu Venugopalan, an IAS officer currently serving as Additional Secretary to the Tamil Nadu Chief Minister.

According to the paper, the share of Indian employment exposed to artificial intelligence (AI) has risen modestly since 2012, and the quality of that exposure has improved. The share of employment with a realistic chance of AI complementarity has also risen, although fewer than 8% of employed people were in these occupations in 2025.

Chief Economic Advisor V. Anantha Nageswaran releasing the 'white paper' on AI at an event in Chennai on Sunday. J. JOHAN SATHYA DAS

The ratio of substitution pressure to complementary work has fallen, but work under substitution pressure still outweighs complementary work by half. The share of employment in routine work exposed to automation pressure rose by 4.8% between 2012 and 2025, the paper said.

According to the paper, the number of workers in AI complementary occupations stood at 46.3 million in India, compared with 52.5 million in the United States and 20.9 million in Russia.

AI exposure is concentrated among workers in the early stages of their careers and declines steadily with age. About 29% of workers aged 25 to 34 are in AI-exposed occupations, 10 percentage points higher than the share among those aged 55 to 64, at about 19%.

The paper also said the southern States lead in the quantity of AI exposure, but not in its quality. The five southern States have an average employment share of 30.9% in AI-exposed occupations, while Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Rajasthan, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh and Madhya Pradesh are at the lower end, with shares ranging from 16.8% to 20%.

Vettri Payanam Thittam: what is the economic mileage of a no-fare bus ride?

Santosh V. Perumal
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu government's expanded Vettri Payanam Thittam (VPT) – the no-fare bus travel for women – which alone is expected to cost an additional ₹1,600 crore a year and a total of ₹6,000 crore, has brought to focus the social return on investment (SROI) versus fiscal cost.

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay seems to have mastered the art of welfare politics by including the gratis within the State's about ₹4-lakh-crore revenue spending framework.

However, the question is can the government convert the estimated 84 lakh daily journeys into measurable gains in employment of women, productivity, household income, and mobility?

Tamil Nadu's Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP), estimated at ₹40.67 lakh crore for 2026-27, is large enough to accommodate VPT; even as its outstanding liabilities are projected at about 27% of GSDP in 2026-27. Debt servicing is about ₹1.28 lakh crore or 37% of the estimated revenue receipts.

The latest initiative, launched on Gandhi Jayanti, is an extension of the existing women's zero-fare bus scheme, Vidiyal Payanam, covering a wider range of public transport buses. The government expects around 84 lakh women to benefit every day.

Cost to exchequer

Tamil Nadu's 2025-26 Budget allocated as much as ₹3,600 crore as subsidy for Vidiyal Payanam (started by previous DMK regime), alongside ₹1,782 crore for concessional student fares and ₹1,857 crore as diesel subsidy.

The State government expects around 84 lakh women to benefit from the Vettri Payanam Thittam every day. E. LAKSHMI NARAYANAN

The expanded VPT is about 1.7% of revenue receipts and 0.15% of GSDP in isolation, but the concern is the State's budgeted ₹55,775-crore revenue deficit, meaning current revenues are insufficient to meet the current expenditure. There is no longer a specific Finance Commission cushion for States whose revenue expenditure exceeds revenue receipts.

Rising concerns

The recurring burden of the scheme, which may appear to be small in terms of GSDP, is that it is not targeted, which means part of the subsidy goes to those who may not need any assistance.

The higher the ridership, the larger will be the reimbursement needs. To ensure sustainability, the State should have a clear formula linking the reimbursement to actual passenger journeys and route costs. Otherwise, it may put pressure on transport funding.

If reimbursement does not fully compensate Tamil Nadu's State Transport Undertakings (STUs), it would further weaken the financial metrics of them, which has been incurring daily average losses of ₹19 crore.

The existing arrangement is that the State compensates transport undertakings for zero-fare journeys. The Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) reported that the government reimbursed the Metropolitan Transport Corporation (MTC) at ₹16 per zero-value ticket, implying revenue loss is effectively shifted from the transport corporations to the State Budget.

A yearly ₹6,000-crore commitment is not a one-off theatrics, rather the State government has to transparently quantify the benefits of unstringed subsidy to show mobility efficiency, labour market efficiency, income generation efficiency, cost-benefit ratio, and long-term sustainability (at the end of current term of the TVK).

The ultimate fare for its success is measurable SROI, not the electoral mileage.

Chennai-bound IndiGo flight was diverted to Hyderabad. PTI

IndiGo flight diverted to Hyderabad over smoke onboard

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

A Chennai-bound IndiGo flight from Delhi was diverted to Hyderabad on Sunday after smoke was detected inside the aircraft from a passenger's personal electronic device.

According to FlightRadar24, IndiGo flight 6E 6115 departed from Delhi's Indira Gandhi International Airport at 1.30 p.m. and was scheduled to land at the Chennai International Airport at 4 p.m.

Following the incident, the flight was diverted and landed at Hyderabad's Rajiv Gandhi International Airport (RGIA) at about 3.15 p.m.

"In line with the established protocols, the pilots diverted the flight and landed safely at Hyderabad. An alternate aircraft has been arranged to continue the journey to Chennai. We regret the inconvenience caused to our customers due to this unforeseen situation", the airline said in a statement.

29,000 forms seeking SIR deletions in Karnataka not available on portals of ECI

While State CEO's statement says 1,10,654 Form 7 applications were received, portal only shows 81,822; details of who filed the forms and against whom are put on the portal for public scrutiny

Rishita Khanna
Pon Vasanth B.A.
BENGALURU/CHENNAI

Besides missing forms, the CEO's own press releases have reported contradictory figures on Form 7 applications. J. ALLEN EGENUSE

Details of nearly 29,000 Form 7 applications, submitted primarily to seek the deletion of names from electoral rolls, received in Karnataka until October 8, amid the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) process, have not been made public on the websites of the State's Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) or the Election Commission of India (ECI).

This is despite communications from the CEO and the ECI that details of all Form 7 applications would be made available for public scrutiny.

A statement from the office of CEO V. Anbu Kumar on October 9 said 1,10,654 Form 7 applications had been received between June 16 when the pre-SIR rolls were frozen, and October 8.

The Hindu has found that details of only 81,822 Form 7 applications are available on the ECI website for that period. The remaining 28,832 account for over one-fourth of the number of applications as per the CEO's statement.

Without details of these forms, it is unclear which constituencies they were filed in, by whom and against whom.

The Hindu has found that details of only 81,822 Form 7 applications are available on the ECI website for that period. Following a protest by Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar and his Cabinet colleagues, the Karnataka CEO directed District Election Offices (DEOs) to take action following an inquiry into that matter.

The CEO's statement on August 24, 2026, when the draft SIR rolls were released, said, "List of claims & objections in Forms 9, 10, 11, 11A & 11B will also be available on the website of CEO Karnataka so that public are able to see the list and lodge objections with concerned ERO." As per the process, Form 7 applications received every day in each Assembly constituency should be consolidated into Form 10 – another ECI reporting format – and uploaded on the website.

An analysis of all Form 10 details on the portal revealed the gap.

Contradictory figures

Besides the missing forms, the CEO's own press releases have reported contradictory and starkly different figures on Form 7 applications.

The August 24 release said 67,307 Form 7 applications had been received between June 16 and August 23. But a September 11 statement put the figure for June 16 to September 9 at 34,631 – 32,676 fewer than the previous figure.

Another release said 41,792 Form 7 applications were received between June 16 and September 17 – 25,515 short of the August 23 figure.

Even as of September 24, a day after the claims-and-objections period ended, the CEO's tally of 61,130 was still 6,177 short. Since then, the figures have climbed rapidly to 1,10,654 as of October 8.

A comparison of the CEO's figures with those in the portal showed that in some periods, the CEO reported more applications than the portal held, and in others, the reverse could be seen. Between June 16 and August 23, the CEO reported 67,307 Form 7 applications, but the portal held details of only 6,951, leaving 60,356 inaccessible to the public.

Asked about the mismatches, Mr. Anbu Kumar said the "claims-and-objections period should be counted only from August 24 to September 23", but did not elaborate. Even within that period, the discrepancy remained, with the portal showing details of 28,097 applications, while the CEO's cumulative figure fell by 6,177.

When Mr. Anbu Kumar was contacted again, he was unavailable for comment.

Make Data Protection Board active in 8 weeks: HC tells Centre

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

The Kerala High Court has directed the Union government to make the Data Protection Board, constituted under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, functional within eight weeks.

The Division Bench issued the directive while disposing of a public interest litigation plea which sought to ensure that collection, storage, processing and transmission of sensitive personal data of passengers at airports is conducted in strict compliance with the provisions of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 and the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025.

The court observed that the petitioner's concerns could not be ignored as it was found that the privacy of citizens was being compromised.

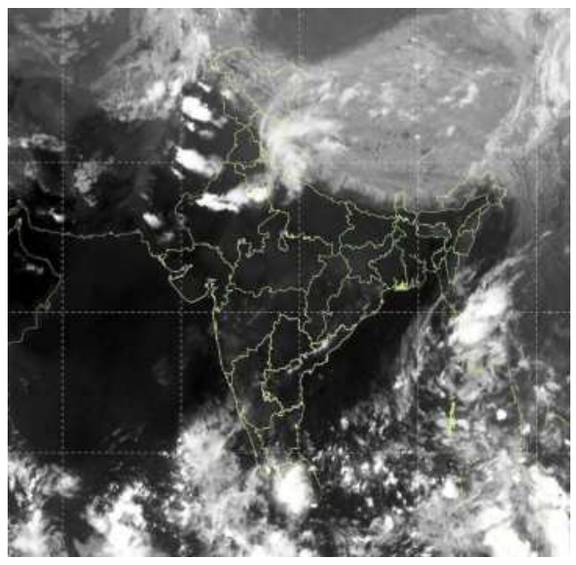
Question of valid proof

The court had earlier directed that Digi Yatra, a portal that collects personal data at airports for identity verification, could not insist on Aadhaar details to establish identity of travellers. In this regard, the Digi Yatra Foundation informed the court that along with the Aadhaar card, driver's licence was accepted as a proof of identity.

In future, the court expected that the authorities may also consider Voter ID as valid proof.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 17.00 HRS)

Forecast for Monday: Thunderstorm accompanied with lightning and gusty winds likely at isolated places over Chhattisgarh, Haryana, Chandigarh, Delhi, Punjab, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal. Strong surface winds likely at isolated places over Andhra Pradesh.

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	—	33.6	24.2	Kurnool	—	37.8	25.2
Ahmedabad	—	36.1	23.8	Lucknow	—	32.9	21.8
Aizawl	—	32.2	21.9	Madurai	—	37.5	24.6
Bengaluru	—	30.1	20	Mangaluru	—	34.3	24.4
Bhopal	—	35.4	17.8	Mumbai	—	—	—
Bhubaneswar	—	33.6	22.6	Mysuru	—	30.6	20.0
Chandigarh	—	25.4	21.9	New Delhi	—	31.0	23.6
Chennai	—	34.8	26.6	Patna	—	31.7	23.2
Coimbatore	—	34.6	23.4	Port Blair	—	31.9	26.8
Dehradun	—	—	—	Prayagraj	—	33.8	22.5
Gangtok	6.0	22.4	12.8	Puducherry	—	32	25
Goa	—	36.3	25.3	Pune	—	34.5	20.5
Guwahati	—	33	21.3	Raipur	—	—	—
Hubballi	—	—	—	Ranchi	—	28.2	19.0
Hyderabad	—	—	23.0	Shillong	—	22.7	13.2
Imphal	—	31.1	17.1	Shimla	—	16.4	12.5
Jaipur	—	—	22.7	Srinagar	—	—	—
Kochi	—	30.8	25.4	Thiruvananthapuram	—	33	24
Kohima	—	29.4	20.5	Tiruchirappalli	—	36.3	25.6
Kolkata	—	32.5	25.5	Vijayawada	—	—	—
Kozhikode	—	34.4	27.4	Visakhapatnam	—	33.8	27.0

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO_2	NO_2	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE
Ahmedabad	.55	..36	37	 75	...118	
Bengaluru	.20	..21	21	 81	...103	
Chennai	...6	..13	51	 95	...116	
Delhi	...9	..14	44	... 101	...142	
Hyderabad	...1	3	29	... 102	...105	
Kolkata	...7	..48	37	... 157	...136	
Lucknow	...5	..29	35	 75	96	
Mumbai	.15	..56	46	 28	...327	
Pune	..—	..67	65	... 118	...112	
Visakhapatnam	.15	..65	28	... 112	...132	

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

Yesterday

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Gummidipoondi, Tamil Nadu recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 227 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Naharlagun, Arunachal Pradesh recorded a healthy AQI score of 11.

SO_2: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_2: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Rights and wrongs

The government must not clamp down on dissent and protest

The Constitution of India guarantees all citizens the fundamental right to peaceful assembly and protest. The right to organise, assemble, and speak is at the core of democracy, and the curtailment of any of the fundamental rights is a curtailment of democracy itself. That being the promise of the Constitution to every citizen, regardless of gender, caste, or status, it is unsettling that the Government of India under Prime Minister Narendra Modi is brazenly knocking down those rights through police high-handedness across the country, particularly in Delhi, the capital. Youth and student organisations, such as the CJP, the AISA, SFI and AISF, had called for a peaceful protest on October 10. Instead of ensuring peaceful assembly, as per the law of the land, the Centre ordered a country-wide swoop, where thousands of young people were taken into preventive detention and Delhi was locked down as if under martial law. Trains were cancelled and stopped, passengers waylaid, and journalists, activists, academics, and lawyers assaulted and detained, all in shocking misuse and weaponisation of the law against democracy itself. In the heart of Delhi, police personnel without identification badges have been recorded on video. What Delhi witnessed on Saturday was a repeat, in a greater degree, of the police high-handedness in July against youth protesters. Despite video evidence of male police personnel assaulting women protesters during that episode, months later, neither the government nor the Supreme Court of India has held anyone accountable for the law enforcement excesses.

On October 9, the Court had said that a blanket ban on travel or assembly could not be allowed. But that is exactly what was done in Delhi, as people, including several former Chief Ministers, senior politicians, and lawyers, were rounded up from around the city. On Sunday, the Court, in its hearing, acknowledged the urgency and seriousness of the issue, and repeated its directives. But piecemeal orders and half-hearted lamentations by the Court have had no restraining impact on a government that seems to be doubling down on its practice of branding critics as foreign agents and anti-nationals instead of coming clean on its record. The BJP government is going this far in defence of an official – the Chief Election Commissioner of India, Gyanesh Kumar. Instead of calling for accountability from the Election Commission of India, which has disenfranchised millions of Indians in a clear act of illegality, the BJP and its central and State governments are deploying the strong arm of the state to defend him. That itself suggests that Mr. Kumar's relationship with the BJP is different from his relationship with all other parties. The Modi government should play by the rules, and not misuse power against citizens.

Message of peace

The Nobel Committee has redeemed itself by awarding Navi Pillay

By awarding the 2026 Nobel Peace Prize to South African jurist Navi Pillay, the Norwegian Nobel committee has sought not only to restore its credibility, tarnished by controversial decisions in the recent past, but also to strengthen the voices defending international law. Ms. Pillay served on the International Criminal Tribunal for Rwanda and the International Criminal Court (ICC), and chaired the UN Independent International Commission of Inquiry on the Occupied Palestinian Territory. Born in Durban in 1941 to a family of Indian Tamil origin, Ms. Pillay grew up in apartheid South Africa, opened her own legal firm in the 1960s and defended anti-apartheid political prisoners and activists on the notorious Robben Island, including Nelson Mandela. Her contributions as a jurist have shaped international criminal law. In 1998, as a part of the Rwanda war crimes tribunal, she co-authored the judgment against Jean-Paul Akayesu, a local politician, recognising that rape and sexual violence constitute acts of genocide. Last year, the Palestine commission that she led concluded that Israel had committed acts of genocide in Gaza and that Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu and former Defence Minister Yoav Gallant had "incited the commission of genocide" in their speeches and statements. Compared to Barack Obama, the 2009 winner who bombed Libya two years later, or Maria Corina Machado, the 2025 winner who supported Washington's economic strangulation of Venezuela and its illegal strikes on boats in the Caribbean, Ms. Pillay has an untarnished record of standing up for the victims of international crimes.

Ms. Pillay has been honoured at a time when the world is witnessing conflicts, which have effectively jeopardised the law-based international order. Russia's invasion of Ukraine is a challenge to the fundamental principles of sovereignty and territorial integrity. Israel continues to bomb Gaza, Syria and Lebanon and tighten its occupation of Palestinian territories, with impunity. The U.S. under President Donald Trump – who believes he deserved a Nobel Prize – started a war on Iran on February 28 and killed its Supreme Leader, a flagrant violation of international law and norms. He has also launched a frontal attack on international institutions, including the ICC that has been placed under sanctions. What prevents the world from becoming a Hobbesian jungle where the mighty do as they please is the existence of international law and institutions that hold them accountable. The message of the 2026 Peace Prize is that the fight to strengthen those rules and institutions is part of the struggle for a more peaceful and accountable world.

Changing the guard, confronting the democratic crisis

Mehbooba Mufti

President, Jammu and Kashmir Peoples Democratic Party

Will the exit of Chief Election Commissioner of India Gyanesh Kumar be enough to correct an electoral process that, over the years, has come to be seen as increasingly compromised in favour of the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) government at the Centre and in several States? With protests now growing across the country, he may eventually be forced out, just as Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan was forced to step down following sustained public pressure. But even then, he could simply be replaced by another, perhaps worse, "yes man". Mr. Kumar's exit may therefore be a starting point, but much more will need to be done to restore the credibility of the electoral process in the "mother of democracy".

Under a cloud

The present controversy is not merely about one Election Commissioner. It is about the credibility of the institution. The Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls has already resulted in over 13 crore names being excluded from draft rolls. This has raised grave concerns about the fate of millions of genuine voters and their basic right to vote – concerns that cannot be dismissed so arbitrarily. There are also apprehensions about the integrity and transparency of electronic voting machines (EVMs), including the security of electoral technology, the custody of machines and the auditing process.

Today, all institutions meant to act as checks and balances, including the media, judiciary and executive, are increasingly seen as influenced by a particular ideology, with their independence compromised. The Anna Hazare movement became so powerful largely because the media then did its job with honesty, neutrality and without fear or favour. It questioned those in power relentlessly and brought the concerns of ordinary citizens into every living room. That kind of fearless and independent media scrutiny is nowhere to be seen today.

Then there is the judiciary, which is supposed to oversee the functioning of the executive and intervene whenever constitutional rights are threatened. Where required, it can take *suo motu* cognisance and provide the last line of institutional protection to citizens whose rights have been violated. Yet, during the SIR controversy, serious allegations of wrongful deletions, including cases in which living voters were shown as dead and physically produced before the courts, have not resulted in any tangible action.

> The crisis extends beyond one Election Commissioner to democracy's weakened institutional safeguards

In West Bengal, the then Mamata Banerjee government also approached the judiciary over the Election Commission of India (ECI)'s handling of the SIR process. The response, however, has been deeply disappointing, to say the least. The possible disenfranchisement of genuine voters deserved the most rigorous scrutiny, yet the process appears to have been gradually normalised. When institutions meant to safeguard citizens' rights and hold the executive accountable appear compromised, the government acquires enormous power without having to fear the consequences.

It is not just the SIR or the EVMs. It is also the raids and investigations involving Opposition leaders around election time, followed by media narratives that often criminalise individuals before a court has established their guilt. We have seen this over the last decade in the manner in which central investigative agencies have been weaponised not only against political opponents but also against individuals who dare to question the government. Sitting Chief Ministers, Members of Parliament, Ministers and political leaders have faced arrests and investigations over allegations that have yet to be established at trial. The repeated selective targeting of individuals, combined with the amplification of such accusations by sections of the media, has proved beyond doubt the nexus between the present regime and a system it is alleged to have corrupted to the hilt.

The great weakening of democratic checks

When the executive acts, the media amplifies its actions, and the judiciary appears reluctant to intervene, all three pillars of democracy can appear to be working in tandem against the public interest. Anyone who dares to speak up risks being pushed out of the system.

We have seen this within the ECI itself. Election Commissioner Ashok Lavasa openly dissented from decisions giving clean chits to Prime Minister Narendra Modi and BJP president Amit Shah over alleged violations of the Model Code of Conduct during the 2019 Lok Sabha campaign. He subsequently left the ECI before the end of his tenure to take up a position in a lead bank.

Today, one cannot help but ask what fate awaits Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi, who have reportedly recorded objections to several decisions of the ECI under Mr. Kumar, thereby exposing the rot within the system.

This is why the ongoing protests by political parties, civil society groups, non-governmental organisations, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and others cannot remain isolated demonstrations. They must evolve into a sustained democratic movement, perhaps closer in spirit to Gandhiji's Satyagraha, to reclaim what has been lost or weakened over the last decade.

Reclaiming the India we knew

The most difficult task, awakening public consciousness, may already have begun. The challenge now is to turn that awakening into a people's movement powerful enough to reclaim the India we once knew – an India where the judiciary could hold even a sitting Prime Minister, such as Indira Gandhi, accountable; where a robust media could question a Prime Minister without fear; and where an Election Commissioner such as T.N. Seshan could exercise his constitutional authority without fear or favour. The beginning has to be a genuinely free and fair electoral process. Removing Gyanesh Kumar may therefore be a necessary starting point, but it is certainly not the end. A democracy survives on public trust. Today, that trust has been severely eroded.

To expect a fully credible election without first rebuilding confidence in the institutions that conduct, monitor and adjudicate elections is like asking for water in the Sahara. What India needs is not merely a change of one Election Commissioner, but an independent system capable of organising elections whose fairness is beyond suspicion. Is the present BJP government willing to do that?

Much more than Gyanesh Kumar has to go if India is to restore the credibility of its electoral system and become a fully fledged democracy. The entire ecosystem that is eating away at the vitals of India's democracy has to go.

Barricades cannot silence the voice of democracy

M.A. Baby

General Secretary, Communist Party of India (Marxist)

The past few months have seen considerable action at the barricades of Jantar Mantar. A recent media investigation on happenings in the Election Commission of India (ECI) sparked a new wave of protests, this time against the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar. The demand for Mr. Kumar's resignation has become a demand for electoral integrity itself. On October 2, 2026, prohibitory orders under Section 163 were imposed across the New Delhi district ahead of the protest against the CEC at Jantar Mantar. A number of Metro stations were closed, and major traffic restrictions were announced.

These measures did not deter protesters, but the mass detentions and restrictions imposed by the Delhi Police raise difficult questions that await answers: Whose capital is this? Whose streets are these? In July 2026, Jantar Mantar, the capital's designated protest site, witnessed one of the biggest youth protests of the year, which eventually culminated in a major victory for the protesters. Since the July 20 NEET protests, the Delhi Police have substantially increased barricading in the area. Closing of the streets and manipulation of the ballot are two sides of the same coin. To protest against the government, citizens must first seek the government's permission. At Jantar Mantar, the Delhi Police have reportedly made it mandatory to submit applications 10 days in advance. The oppressed are allowed to speak against the oppressor only when the oppressor allows it.

The erasure of protest geography

The history of Delhi's protest geography is slowly being erased. The Boat Club was once the designated site for demonstrations before they were shifted to Jantar Mantar. Although Jantar Mantar remains the designated protest site, it is routinely blocked on the pretext of "permission denied". Until the COVID-19 lockdown, the customary rally route ran from Mandi House to Jantar Mantar or the Parliament Street Police Station. Large rallies often began at Ramlila Maidan and culminated on Parliament Street. Since the lockdown, barring a few exceptions, almost no permissions have been granted. Parliament Street was where people symbolically expressed their dissent before their elected representatives.

The legal instrument enabling these blockades is Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), which replaced Section 144 of the Code of Criminal Procedure. Repeated prohibitory orders have raised concerns about whether restrictions intended to regulate demonstrations are, in practice, preventing them altogether, and unchecked discretion to deny permission for demonstrations challenging the government or its policies.

> As protest spaces shrink, citizens must unite to defend the right to dissent

In its 2018 judgment in *Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan vs Union of India*, the Supreme Court recognised peaceful protest as a fundamental right and directed the authorities to formulate guidelines permitting regulated demonstrations at Jantar Mantar. Before that, in the Ramlila Maidan case of 2012, the Court affirmed the same principle.

It is not just Delhi. In Bengaluru, protests once held at Town Hall were moved to Freedom Park, only to face restrictions there as well. In 2022, the Karnataka High Court confined demonstrations to Freedom Park. In December 2025, the park was closed entirely for "redevelopment", with electricity and water supplies cut off. In Hyderabad, protests are permitted only at Dharna Chowk. Farmers marching to Delhi in early 2024 faced barricades, barbed wire, tear gas and even trenches along the Haryana border. Preventive detentions, prohibitory orders targeting workers' strikes and student marches, and Internet shutdowns have become standard responses across States. The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) is the main driver of this national pattern: protests are first relocated, then confined, and finally banned.

Dissent cannot be contained

History shows that whenever those in power curb, restrict or seal the public sphere, the masses always find a way around. The 2011 Tahrir Square movement, Occupy Wall Street, the Paris Commune and the Petrograd Soviets are some examples.

India, too, has witnessed major protests in recent years, including the historic Shaheen Bagh sit-in against the Citizenship (Amendment) Act (CAA) and the National Register of Citizens (NRC), the 2020-21 farmers' protests on Delhi's borders, and Left-led workers' and peasants' mobilisations such as the Mahapadav and the Kisan Long March. The Mahapadav of November 2023 brought workers and farmers onto the streets of State capitals across the country for a three-day sit-in.

Spaces are produced through struggle. When the state seals the formal public sphere, resistance creates new spaces at borders, on highways and campuses, across digital networks and in *mohallas*. Repression creates the conditions for such resistance. Every barricade becomes a symbol of dissent and a rallying point. Mohan Bhagwat, Narendra Modi and Amit Shah must understand that dissent cannot be abolished by decree. Internet shutdowns, Metro closures, preventive detentions and imprisonment have not ended people's democratic aspirations. As Pablo Neruda said, they can cut all the flowers, but they cannot prevent spring from arriving. Authoritarian confidence is brittle, and repression is often a sign of political insecurity.

On electoral exclusion

The fight for space is part of a larger fight to defend the Constitution and democratic institutions. The Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls threatens mass disenfranchisement of the poor, migrants, minorities, and women. The ECI's data shows that vulnerable sections including short-term migrants, illiterate voters and married women risk being deleted from the rolls. The 2023 Act on the appointment of Election Commissioners removed the Chief Justice of India from the selection panel and gave control to the executive. The Act gives total lifelong protection to the Election Commissioner from civil and criminal prosecution. Even the President of India has protection only as long as he or she is holding office.

By blocking dissent in public and tampering with rolls in private, the BJP regime is hollowing out our democratic republic from both ends. The democratic and secular forces need to link the street, the court, and the ballot into a single democratic offensive. The right to protest is the people's inherent right, won through the freedom struggle and enshrined in Article 19. We demand the restoration of the right to assemble and march at Jantar Mantar and along Parliament Street, and an end to the blanket, permanent use of Section 163 of the BNSS in New Delhi. The government must stop detentions and the violent suppression of peaceful protests. If the authorities barricade Jantar Mantar, we will not only defy those barricades but also, as the people of India, create countless Jantar Mantars in every nook and corner of the country.

Democracy can only be defended when it is practised, and our task is to build the broadest struggle to practise it.

Spring will come.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Electoral transparency

If a 'centralised computer system' can remove millions of voters — as if by a sleight of hand — can millions of aggrieved citizens not collectively demand accountability from a Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) of India whose functioning raises serious questions? Power cannot remain concentrated in one Commissioner, with opaque control over electoral data and arbitrary changes, without inviting public scrutiny. Nor can immunity become a licence for impunity. The ballot cannot be protected by machinery that risks eroding public faith in it.

M. Jameel Ahmed,
Mysuru

It is imperative that all citizens who value democracy, particularly the youth, come together to defend constitutional freedoms through peaceful and non-violent means. Their movement should draw inspiration from Mahatma Gandhi's principles of non-violence and civil resistance. As an octogenarian, I cannot help but feel anxious about the kind of India we will leave behind for future generations. We owe our young people a country in which democratic institutions remain independent, dissent is respected, elections inspire public confidence, and the government is accountable to the people. The time has come for all democratic-minded citizens to reflect seriously on these concerns.

Tharcius S. Fernando,
Chennai

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

The need to preserve the shine of Indian elections

Akshay Rout

Former Director General, Election Commission of India and a public policy commentator

The intense and unabated protests happening around and about the Election Commission of India (ECI) have thrown up a bigger question – whether the much vaunted Indian election is losing its shine. This concern is irrespective of when and how the immediate fire is doused, for the smoke could linger. The Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and its management have raised many questions during the last year, inviting attention, litigation and agitation. But the malaise facing the Indian electoral system is even wider. The unidimensional nature of the present noise might be drowning a larger challenge; the current scenario may only be a wakeup call.

Elections, branded as among India's topmost soft powers for decades, may have finally hit a phase of devaluation. The country's enviable delivery of democratic elections, compared to dozens of countries in Asia, Africa and West Asia, which became independent around the same time, might have had the evil eye cast on them. Not only election managers, but the executive, the legislature, the judiciary, the winners and the losers in elections, as well as the wider voting community need to be play an alert remedial role in order to properly address the concerns of the electoral system.

Prime asset

Popular and credible elections have given the Indian nation critical stability, reasonable governance, post-colonial reconstruction and a pathway to development, besides the tenacity to counter external threats. The exercise of equal franchise by the sick and the elderly and by a people who are unequal socially and economically is part of India's electoral folklore as also are the latest trends of women activism in voting. Despite rampart poverty and illiteracy at the time of independence, ordinary Indians have learned about the strength of their votes, and have nurtured a respect for the polling process. They wait for their turn periodically to place or remove candidates at positions of decision making.

The process has worked remarkably well compared to other parts of Indian enterprise. Apart from the framers of the Constitution led by Dr. Bhimrao Ambedkar, who laid the seeds of parliamentary democracy, the credit duly rests on the ECI machinery, from the Nirvachan Sadan in New Delhi to the million plus polling booths across the country. The scale of the task – the 2024 national elections saw about 98 crore electors spread across India's vast and varied topography – with the massive logistics that it entails, and the finesse of its disposal, have kept advanced nations wonder-struck. The ECI has justifiably emerged as a school for election managers from a range of countries which are still groping for ways to execute such a huge and sensitive mandate. Further, the Commission set up the India International Institute of Democracy and Election Management (IIIDEM) to impart lessons in conducting flawless elections. Younger nations look up to India's election management as a guiding star amidst other falling models.

However, there are grey, if not dark clouds on the horizon. It may still be an exaggeration to suggest that the Indian elections are corroded but malignant encroachments cause an unsettling feeling. While elections have always been fiercely contested, with even a few social faultlines such as caste and community getting interwoven into the outcome, the results were mostly received with stoic calm. But no more. What has taken over are chronic allegations about the partisan conduct of the poll body, and aggressive grievance bordering on a rejection of the electoral results. The argument that this is part of a global decline of democratic values, and has also infected developed democracies such as the U.S., holds no consolation. No country on earth needs democracy more than India does. No country needs elections more than India does.

A different game

Elections in India have changed with the times. Ground level campaigns and door-to-door canvassing have given way to digital battles where fast moving disinformation and deep fakes are the new weaponry. While muscular assaults such as booth capturing, voter intimidation, and bogus voting of the earlier decades were bad enough, they were still limited to certain pockets. Now, the possibility of manipulating the voter database through undue enfranchisement or disenfranchisement poses a threat at a larger scale.

The influence of money power over elections, with its ability to upset the sacred level-playing field, has grown enormously compared to localised distribution of cash or goodies in the past. Expenditure reports of candidates submitted to the ECI post-election, and accounted party spends are just tip of the icebergs; unofficial estimates of poll finances are much larger. The institutional release of cash into the wallets of population segments, touted as welfare, has distorted electoral integrity, besides public finance. The Economic Survey 2026 puts the strain of such unconditional cash transfers on States at a staggering ₹1.7 lakh crore. Such brazen transactions through the front door have subverted policy and candidate level contest, causing worries to the ECI and the Supreme Court.

Post poll subversion casts a darker shadow. Wholesale defections increasingly undermine the people's mandate for a candidate and party. Instead of reining in party hoppers, the anti-defection law has induced the bulk transfer of elected legislators thanks to exceptions allowed in the 10th Schedule. Opportunistic realignments have made a mockery of voters' choice in the absence of a recall system. The stream of present-day lawmakers dumping manifesto and ideology and switching parties at ease, make the earlier 'Aya Ram Gaya Rams' in Indian politics look like timid angels. The Speaker's recognition and symbol allocation by the ECI are critical follow ups to such mutations which have also not been free of partisan accusations.

Election management itself has got embroiled in institutional issues sparking opposition and street protests. The SIR exercise, which began a year ago, has left a trail of dust while approaching the finish line. Meanwhile, the provision of appointing Election Commissioners through a collegium under the 2023 enactment has not helped matters; and is still under the study of Supreme Court. The usual regulatory functions of the ECI such as the preparation of the electoral roll, the administration of the Model Code of Conduct, the announcement of results, and more recently, intra-organisational functioning are routinely moving into zones of contention, despite significant back up from higher courts. The distrust vocalised by polarised political entities can percolate down to ordinary citizens and create hopelessness.

Sukumar Sen, the Chief Election Commissioner for the first elections conducted in independent India in 1951, had unimaginable logistical challenges to handle, but certainly not one of trust. Today, after 75 years of experience and growing resources, while the massive logistics in elections is routine, trust has become the issue.

Urgent, collective imperative

Elections are by far the best organised expression of "we, the people" and hence cannot be allowed to fail. Political rhetoric is not part of the solution. The election process and its management are too precious to be made scapegoats in inter-party fights. Political parties need to do a collective and apolitical sit-down for the systemic fortification of Indian elections by building more safeguards and accountability and plugging structural and legal loopholes – basically, doing whatever is necessary and whatever it takes. The introduction of a three-member Commission to replace the single Chief Election Commissioner in 1993 had this very logic. There are multiple demands to be met: the better regulation of political financing and the menace of freebies; shielding of the electoral process from criminalisation; and dealing with the threat of AI-abetted fake narratives. Voters as well as those who are voted for must be insulated against inducements in discharge of their democratic functions. Arresting further deterioration will require collective work beyond partisan self-interest. And above everything else, trust has to be worked back into the system.

Views expressed are personal.

In full force: Security personnel in riot gear stand guard outside the Election Commission office ahead of a planned protest demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar in New Delhi, on October 10. AP

Elections are by far the best organised expression of "we, the people" and hence cannot be allowed to fail

The gaps in the implementation of the RTI Act

Section 4 of the RTI Act lists 16 types of information which are to be disclosed by public authorities; such voluntary disclosure has not been followed

DATA POINT

Sneha Gandla
Gauri Singavarapu
Sachin Swaraj

The Right to Information (RTI) Act completed 21 years today. Besides empowering citizens to demand information from public authorities, a key aspect of the RTI Act is the provision for *suo motu* mandatory disclosure of a variety of information on their websites so that people do not have to resort to filing requests under the Act for accessing basic information regarding any department.

Section 4 (1) (b) of the Act lists 16 types of information, ranging from contact details of officials to budgetary expenditure, which are to be made public at regular intervals. Moreover, the Department of Personnel and Training has issued guidelines for the disclosure of additional information, under eight broad categories, including information related to procurement, public-private partnerships, and all RTI applications received by each department. An analysis, however, showed that such voluntary disclosure has not been followed.

With the number of official websites of the Union government and State governments running into the thousands, the scope of this analysis is restricted to the departments listed as Public Authorities (PAs) in the Government of India's online portal for filing of applications under the RTI Act and the data presented in the annual reports of the Central Information Commission (CIC). To ensure compliance with Section 4 of the RTI Act, the government has also made it mandatory for transparency audits to be conducted by third parties and the reports of such audits to be shared with the CIC.

The annual report for the year 2024-25 released earlier this year by the CIC says that of the 2,303 PAs from various departments registered with the Commission, only 1,446 had submitted third party audit reports, which is just 62.7% of the total registered **(Table 1)**. Of those submitted, more than 50% scored Grade C or below, which meant that they had scored 80% or below in the transparency audit. Those with Grade E had scored below 60% in the audit. Though nearly 37% of the registered PAs did not submit the audit reports, a look at the trend in the last five years showed that the compliance has improved year-on-year **(Chart 1)**. In 2020-21, only 754 had submitted. This doubled to 1,443 in 2024-25.

The Hindu independently verified the websites of the 94 departments under which these PAs come under. The guidelines recommend the uploading of the transparency audit reports on the websites. However, only 33 of the 94 websites had the audit reports for the year 2024-25. While a majority of them did not have the latest audit reports, a few had older reports. An analysis on the information that is to be mandatorily disclosed under the RTI Act showed that, of the 94 departments, 56 authorities, or 62% have complied with this section on most categories, and have information from 2025-26. The websites of 26 departments did not have the information covered under the Act. For the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, there was no information available **(Table 2)**. The remaining websites had either minimal or dated information on their websites.

Meanwhile, the number of new RTI requests and its pendency with the CIC has grown over the years **(Chart 2)**. The Act states that PAs should provide "as much information *suo motu* to the public ...so that the public have minimum resort to the use of this Act". The efficient implementation of Section 4 can not only improve transparency but also reduce the pendency piling up with the CIC and State Information Commissions.

In defense of transparency: Workers during the laying of the foundation of the National RTI Museum in Beawar, Rajasthan. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

1 Section 4(1) (b) of the RTI Act mandates suo motu disclosure of a range of information by every government authority

2 Public authorities covered under the Act are mandated to conduct independent transparency audits to ensure compliance with Section 4 (1) (b)

3 In 2024-25, only 62.3% of the public authorities had submitted these audit reports to the CIC

4 Most sites checked by *The Hindu* had disclosed only minimal information available

Voluntary non-disclosure

Data for the charts were sourced from the Central Information Commission (CIC) and websites of 94 government departments listed in the RTI portal of the Government of India. The authors are interning with The Hindu's Data team

Table 1: Number of public authorities (PAs) who submitted transparency audit reports to the CIC and their grades

Number of PAs	2,303
Audit report submitted to CIC	1,446
Grade A	410
Grade B	253
Grade C	302
Grade D	215
Grade E	266

Table 2: Availability of transparency audit reports in the websites of 94 departments listed in the RTI portal

Compliance	No. of depts.
Report available with section-wise scores and required compliance classifications	33
Report available, but the latest recorded audit year is older	7
No report found in the portal material reviewed	43
While audit is mentioned or information is available, the full report or expected details are missing	7
Report reference, total score or audit mentioned without complete accessible report	3
Portal did not display the relevant audit information	1
Total	**94**

Chart 1: The number of public authorities (PAs) registered with the CIC and those who submitted the transparency audit reports to the Commission in the last five years

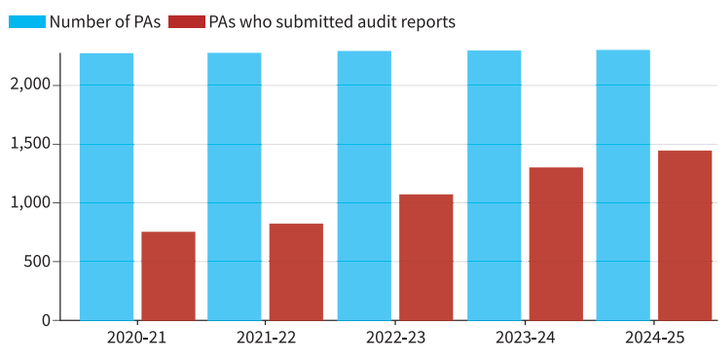
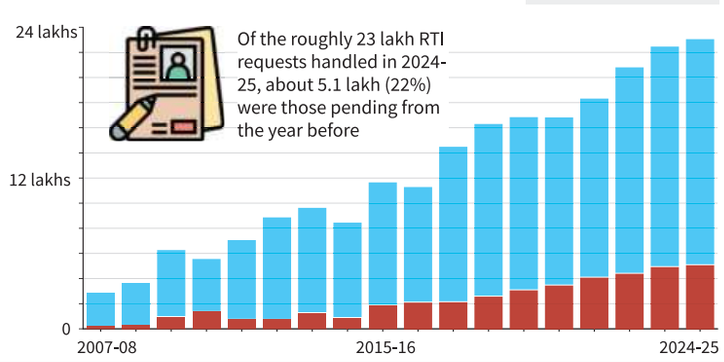


Chart 2: The number of RTI requests filed every year and the pendencies from previous years have consistently grown over the years



FROM THE ARCHIVES
The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 12, 1976

Expert's survey of ENT diseases in Male Island

Madras, October 11: Fishing is their primary occupation and practically every one of them swims and dives. Their staple food is fish and rice. Occupational hazards, vitamin-deficient food and the inclement weather conditions add up to make the 1,25,000 people living in the Maldivian Archipelago "extremely prone to upper respiratory tract infections". "I have never seen so many cases of chronic tonsillitis, adenoiditis and mastoiditis", says Dr. S. Kameswaran, Director of the Institute of Otorhino-laryngology, Madras Medical College, who had been there on a short WHO assignment.

The first ENT expert ever to set foot on the soil of MALE, the capital-island of the Republic of Maldives, Dr. Kameswaran had been asked to conduct a sample survey of ENT diseases, hold special clinics, organise training course for health personnel and to assist and advise the Maldivian Government in setting up ENT units in health centres.

Of the 2,000 islands forming the archipelago, only 192 are permanently inhabited, the total land area being 115 square miles. Male Island, which has a population of 20,000, has a 52-bed modern hospital, with an operational theatre.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 12, 1926

Presenting India to people of Canada

London, October 11: Sir T. Vijayaraghavachariar arrived in London to-day from Canada and will leave for India in a few days to take up his position on the Public Services Commission. Interviewed by Reuter he said he was very glad he had an unequalled opportunity of presenting India to the people of the great Dominion.

He had a wonderful greeting everywhere. He found India little known in Canada, but one of the Dominion Ministers, on his departures, declared that India had at length become more real to the Canadians.

It was no longer a land of mystery for them and its place in the Empire was better understood and appreciated.

Sir T. Vijayaraghavachariar said that he had always emphasised the unity of the Empire and the subordination of local to Imperial results.

From Page One

Stop illegal detentions, says SC amid crackdown

The top court's repeated emphasis on the "subject to law and order" rider signalled a deliberate balancing act of upholding constitutional protections against illegal detention and securing rights to free movement, access to courts and Internet connectivity, while preserving the State's power to enforce reasonable restrictions to maintain public order.

The top court issued notices to Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan, Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar, and Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) chairperson D. Thara on a petition filed by advocate Shailendra Mani Tripathi seeking contempt action against them for allegedly violating an October 9 order which barred any "outright prohibition on the movement of Metro trains" and public transport on Saturday.

Justice Bagchi, dictating the order, observed there would be no detentions except by law outside the four-km prohibitory zone in central Delhi, which includes Jantar Mantar, the designated site for protests. The court said people should be allowed to assemble peacefully outside the restricted zone.

Sunday's session began with Justice Bagchi assuring that the judiciary was in the service of the nation. He expressed serious concern over the "flagrant violations" committed by the police and security personnel on Saturday. Senior advocate and petitioner-in-person Menaka Guruswamy asked how many people were detained on Saturday. "It is not just that there was no free movement allowed; it is not just that Opposition leaders were picked up from their homes; it is not just that protesters were hurled into vans and driven away by police officers without name tags... It is about young people taking to peaceful protests because they think the electoral system is not free and fair. Is this an undeclared Emergency? . The last time we came to court against a situation like this was 50 years ago during the Emergency. Has Article 19 been suspended? ," she submitted.

Senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan said the Emergency had reached our doorsteps. "A board advertising the prohibitory order is fixed outside this very court as we speak," he said. The court ordered its removal immediately.

Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta maintained, on instructions from the government, that there was "zero reduction in the total volume of Metro service". "Of the 303 Metro stations in Delhi, entry and exit were restricted to 45 stations. Internet was restored last night itself," he said to loud guffaws from the courtroom. "We want clarity on this point in an affidavit. Were Metro stations on either end of Delhi open while those in the middle closed?" Justice Bagchi asked. Loud boos echoed in the courtroom when a counsel submitted that lawyers' job was inside courtrooms and not protesting on streets.

To a submission that police officers were injured too, Justice Bagchi said the court was agnostic about the identities of the injured, but would look into grievances equally. "Please file a response by Tuesday along with compliance," Justice Bagchi directed the authorities.

Capital choke-hold: Police personnel detain a protester near Connaught place on Sunday. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Journalists, youth held as protest continues

Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das, Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) leaders who were released on Sunday after being detained a day earlier, asserted that the protests would continue till the CEC resigns. In a post on X, Mr. Ranka said that the group's leaders would would visit the Parliament Street police station on Monday at 10 a.m. to seek a date for holding a peaceful protest at Jantar Mantar. "Delhi Police can give us a date for Jantar Mantar in 24 hours, or we will give another protest call ourselves," he said. He also called Prime Minister Narendra Modi the biggest "coward" and urged people to protest peacefully wherever they were.

While mobile Internet was restored on Sunday, residents continued a cautious approach. Despite the festive season, footfall and business remained low in Connaught Place and the central Delhi area still interspersed with police barricades.

As security forces continued to block all entrances to Jantar Mantar on Sunday, the designated protest site in the capital, the agitation shifted to other parts of the city, with Connaught Place in the heart of Delhi becoming the new epicentre of the protest. A series of protests broke out in the outer circle of Connaught Place, starting from a march carried out by various students groups. All of the participents were detained by security personnel. The police claimed that the protesters were being adamant and not cooperating at the time of detention.

In the evening, women SFI activists doing a 'Tiranga Yatra' were detained from Connaught Place after 6 p.m. and taken away in a bus by security forces. The SFI termed the detention of women post 6 p.m. as illegal and alleged that the women activists were beaten by male officers.

Hindu outfit backs its men arrested over Delhi assault

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

A day after a video showing four men attacking a male protester and a woman during Saturday's protest in central Delhi circulated widely on social media, the Delhi Police arrested all four men on Sunday morning. Hindu Raksha Dal president Pinky Chaudhary subsequently claimed that the accused were members of his organisation and vowed to protect them.

The accused were identified as Raman Saini (50) ;Vivekanand, alias Vivek, (32);Kapil Kumar (27); and Ravinder Singh, alias Govind,k Hindu (35).

The arrests followed the circulation of a video that drew widespread condemnation over the assault and the conduct of police personnel present at the scene. The footage shows four men assaulting the male protester. When the young woman runs towards the scene, the men throw her to the ground, after which one of them begins attacking her.

Police personnel subsequently intervened and walked the attackers away from the scene. The manner in which the personnel appeared to handle the alleged assailants, rather than restraining them firmly, drew criticism across social media platforms.

Rahul urges citizens to join INDIA march to top court

'Every single person who believes in democracy' can take part in the march, he says; Congress leader K.C. Venugopal accuses the Delhi Police of turning the capital into a 'torture chamber'

Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

A day ahead of the Opposition's planned march to the Supreme Court on Monday, Congress leader Rahul Gandhi appealed to all citizens to join in "as Indians", irrespective of their affiliations. The Opposition alliance plans to submit a memorandum to Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant on the issue of alleged vote *chori* (theft).

Mr. Gandhi, in a video statement, said they would ask the CJI to halt the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, sack Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, and remove electronic voting machines (EVMs) from the electoral process.

Though the CJI has declined a meeting with Opposition leaders, citing the SIR matter to be *sub judice*, the Congress hasn't called off the march to the top court. "Every single person who believes in democracy, who wants to stand for democracy, please come with us. [It] doesn't matter what your affiliation is, as long as you are affiliated to the Constitution of India and you want to protect it," he said.

Taking centrestage: Mallikarjun Kharge and Rahul Gandhi ahead of the protest at Rajghat on October 8. AICC/PTI

In a post on X, Mr. Gandhi said the march to the Supreme Court would be held by Indians united beyond parties, gender, caste, community and State. Referring to Saturday's protests, called by several youth organisations, including the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), the Opposition leader said the nation's youth had come out in Delhi to protest peacefully but were "beaten, both by "BJP goons and the police".

"This is not the India we want," Mr. Gandhi said, adding, "Come with us and there is nothing to fear. These cowards can do nothing to us."

Earlier, party president Mallikarjun Kharge told reporters in Bengaluru that Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the Home Minister had imposed an "undeclared emergency". Opposition leaders had requested an appointment with the CJI between 4 p.m. and 5 p.m on Monday, he said.

"With folded hands, we will apprise [the CJI] of the situation. Chaos is being created in the country by the Home Minister and the Prime Minister, and an undeclared emergency has been imposed everywhere," Mr. Kharge said.

The details of Monday's protest plans are not yet public, but Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal is coordinating with other Opposition parties of the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA), as well as the party's own State units.

Sharp post

In an unusually sharp social media post, Mr. Venugopal accused the Delhi Police of turning Delhi into a "torture chamber where innocent citizens exercising their fundamental rights are being chased, thrashed and detained".

"All this, while vigilante groups aligned with the ruling regime are given a free hand to assault protesters – under full police protection. Modi-Shah are criminal-minded dictators who have decided to go to any lengths to save their regime from collapsing," Mr. Venugopal said in a post on X. In video statement, Mr. Venugopal said the Monday's march isn't a political one but to "protect people's basic right to vote".

Though the Congress was formally not part of Saturday and Sunday's protests, several INDIA bloc leaders, including Mamata Banerjee and Pinarayi Vijayan, took part and were detained. The Congress, on the other hand, had been protesting in the capital for four days, beginning October 6, as part of the INDIA bloc.

CJI declines request by Rahul for meeting today

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant on Sunday declined a request by the Leader of the Opposition, Rahul Gandhi, for a meeting on Monday.

The CJI's office confirmed to *The Hindu* that the request for a meeting was "declined with reasons". The office informed mediapersons that the response to Mr. Gandhi was sent to his official mail.

Sources said the meeting was declined as the issues likely to be raised were already sub judice in the Supreme Court. Besides, the court cannot intervene in matters of governance and functioning of the state on its administrative side.

While leaders of Opposition parties are expected to lead a march to the Supreme Court on Monday, sources said the response of the Chief Justice of India was that they could raise questions on fundamental rights with the court on its judicial side. Sources clarified that the CJI has not expressed any view on the proposed march to the Supreme Court.

The court has already listed for October 12 petitions connected to the protest against the Chief Election Commissioner and October 10 clampdown in Delhi.

Detained protesters accuse Mumbai Police of using 'excessive force'

Yohaan Varghese
MUMBAI

The Mumbai Police on Sunday detained several people who gathered near Shivaji Park in Dadar to protest demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. The protesters alleged that they were prevented from reaching the protest site despite assembling peacefully and accused the police of using disproportionate force.

They said police was deployed at multiple entry points around Shivaji Park and several people were detained even before they could join the demonstration. Some alleged that people who were standing or walking in the area were taken into custody.

Police detain CJP workers at Shivaji Park during the protest against CEC Gyanesh Kumar in Mumbai on Sunday. ANI

Shafqat Khan, a protester, said demonstrators were denied entry through Gate 6 and other entrances of Shivaji Park. "We came to Dadar for the protest, but we were not allowed to enter. Even some people who had not come for the protest were detained simply because they were moving around in groups," he said.

Mr. Khan accused the police of using excessive force while detaining demonstrators. "We did nothing wrong, did not misbehave with the police and did not engage in any violence or raise provocative slogans," he said.

Meera Shah, a resident of Mulund, said she had decided to participate in the demonstration after seeing reports of police action against the Cockroach Janta Party protesters in Delhi a day earlier. Manya Yadav (name changed), 24, alleged that male police personnel dragged demonstrators by their shirts and verbally abused them. She said she was detained but released around 7 p.m.

Screen-grab of video showing officers informing Abhijeet Dipke of his grandmother's death and offering to arrange travel for him.

Offered help to Dipke after grandmother's death: Delhi Police

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

The Delhi Police on Sunday said they had offered all possible assistance to Cockroach Janta Party founder Abhijeet Dipke after learning of his grandmother's death, responding to his allegation that a delay in his release from detention prevented him from attending her funeral.

At a press meet, Deputy Commissioner of Police (DCP) Neha Yadav shared a 1.45-minute video showing officers informing Mr. Dipke of his grandmother's death and offering to arrange travel for him to attend the last rites.

According to Ms. Yadav, the officers approached Mr. Dipke as soon as they received information about the death and sensitively conveyed the news. They offered to help arrange a flight or bus journey and repeatedly asked whether he wished to speak to his parents or another family member, she said.

In the video, a uniformed police personnel is seen informing Mr. Dipke about the death, while another officer in civilian clothes offers him water. The officers then ask whether he wishes to travel for the final rites and offer to arrange tickets by bus or flight. Mr. Dipke responds, "I will stay here."

The officers also offer to connect him with a family member using an official phone number, but he declines. He is subsequently told that the funeral is scheduled for the following day. Ms. Yadav said Mr. Dipke was also given enough time to process and think.

Mr. Dipke, however, had alleged that the police delayed his release and that he was consequently unable to attend his grandmother's funeral.

Later, Mr. Dipke asked: "Why did you delete the part where I was asking for my phone so that I could retrieve my cousin's number? And where I was asking to let me speak to my lawyers? The same Delhi Police who are now taking the moral high ground for informing me about my grandmother's demise and offering me a ride home came to me at 3.30 a.m. with arrest papers, demanding that I sign them. Where did all that humanity go at 3.30 a.m.? Despite knowing that I had just lost my grandmother, they still insisted that I sign the arrest papers. I refused until I was allowed to speak to my lawyers."

Mr. Dipke, along with CJP's Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das, was detained on Saturday ahead of the protest against SIR.

How the Mahatma's court statement in 1922 echoes amid Delhi detentions

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The protesters courting detention while peacefully demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar on October 10 brings back to life Mahatma Gandhi's statement during a 1922 sedition trial in a colonial court on how dissent must confront power.

The youth protesters had called for passive resistance amidst the massive build-up of security forces in the national capital.

March 18, 1922, which happened to be a Saturday like October 10, saw Mahatma Gandhi accept an offer from the Ahmedabad District and Sessions judge, C.N. Broomfield, to make a statement in open court.

The former lawyer and the future Father of the Nation stated that "affection cannot be manufactured or regulated by law". "If one has no affection for a person or system, one should be free to give the fullest expression of his disaffection, so long as he does not contemplate, promote or incite to violence," Gandhiji stated.

Mahatma Gandhi

He urged against what he called "violent non-co-operation", which he said "only multiplied evil". He said that non-violence implied a "voluntary submission to the penalty for non-co-operation". Gandhiji was on trial for publishing three articles in his journal *Young India*. He and his editor, Shankarlal Ghelabhai Banker, pleaded guilty and were sentenced to six months' imprisonment.

Post-Independence

The Supreme Court, in post-Independence India, has enshrined the spirit of dissent voiced by Gandhiji in Article 19 of the Constitution, making the right to free speech and expression and the right to association and peaceful assembly fundamental rights.

"The state can only make regulations in aid of the right of assembly of each citizen and can only impose reasonable restrictions in the interest of public order... While prior to the coming into force of the Constitution, the right to assemble could have been abridged or taken away by law, after the coming into force of the Constitution, the right cannot be abridged except by imposing reasonable restrictions," a Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court held in a 1972 judgment in *Himat Lal K. Shah v. Commissioner of Police, Ahmedabad*.

Half a century later in 2016, the court ensured that the right to peaceful and public dissent did not wane by declaring that holding a peaceful demonstration to air grievances was a fundamental right. "Organised, non-violent protest marches were a key weapon in the struggle for Independence, and the right to peaceful protest is now recognised as a fundamental right in the Constitution," the apex court had observed in *Anita Thakur vs Government of Jammu and Kashmir*.

Breaking barriers: Activists during a protest march demanding the resignation of CEC in New Delhi on Sunday. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Leading charge: AISA leader Neha Bora grapples with the police at Connaught Place. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Unstoppable force: Police personnel forcibly removing a student activist. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Under siege: Rapid Action Force personnel seen patrolling the Connaught Place area on Sunday. ANI

Sporadic protests break uneasy calm in capital

Protests continue despite security deployment and restrictions on gatherings; throughout the day, police chase and detain demonstrators; a few shoppers return to Connaught Place; journalists covering the demonstrations were rounded up; several protesters say they returned on Sunday because they did not want to abandon the cause, though they were unable to reach Jantar Mantar

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Hundreds of protesters, including Rajya Sabha member John Brittas and All India Students' Association (AISA) president Neha Bora, were detained as sporadic protests against the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar continued across Delhi for the second consecutive day on Sunday amid heavy security deployment and barricading across central Delhi to prevent protesters from reaching Jantar Mantar.

With shops in Connaught Place reopening after 24 hours and metro services resuming at stations shut on Saturday, normalcy returned in the morning. Shoppers trickled into the market, but the relative calm was disrupted as student organisations and other groups attempted to march through the commercial hub, only to be detained by the police. The heavy deployment of police personnel and barricades at key junctions appeared to make visitors hesitant to venture further into the area, as people walked past rows of shops but paused to assess the security arrangements.

Activists take part in a protest on the Yamuna in Delhi; and, right, security personnel detaining a person at Connaught Place in Delhi on Sunday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT & PTI

Protests continue

The protests, called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), continued despite restrictions on gatherings and movement in New Delhi. With demonstrators unable to assemble at Jantar Mantar, several groups attempted to mobilise at different locations across the city and the Outer Circle of Connaught Place became the epicentre.

Representatives of student and youth organisations, including the All India Students' Federation (AISF), the Students' Federation of India (SFI), the Democratic Youth Federation of India (DYFI) and the Krantikari Yuva Sangathan (KYS), attempted to take out a march in the morning.

'Leave the chair'

Around noon, 60 to 70 protesters began marching from Gate 1 of Rajiv Chowk Metro station towards Gate 6 of Palika Bazaar with banners and placards, and raising slogans of "vote chor, *gaddi* chhod (vote thieves, leave the chair)" .

The protesters demanded the rollback of the SIR exercise and the resignation of Mr. Kumar. The police and the Rapid Action Force (RAF) detained the protesters, and tense scenes unfolded as several demonstrators lay on the road, refusing to leave. Police personnel forcibly lifted some of them and shoved them into a bus. Some protesters sustained injuries and a man was seen bleeding from his forehead.

Barricades erected

By 12.30 p.m., barricades had been erected and access to Janpath Road was cut off, further restricting movement through the area.

Around two hours later, a few AISA representatives gathered near Ramakrishna Ashram Marg Metro station and attempted to march towards Connaught Place. The police quickly moved in to stop them, and the ensuing chase halted traffic.

Police personnel, Central Reserve Police Force personnel and RAF members converged on the junction and detained protesters.

Journalists covering the demonstrations were also rounded up. Ms. Bora and other AISA representatives managed to cross a barricade and run towards Panchkuian Road before being intercepted and detained by a large contingent of police personnel.

Around 4 p.m., nearly 350 people associated with the Revolutionary Workers' Party of India, Disha Students' Organisation, Naujawan Bharat Sabha and Stree Mukti League began a rally from Connaught Place's outer circle. The protesters moved along the inner circle before being picked up by the police near the Pind Balluchi square. Later in the evening, women activists of the SFI were detained after 6 p.m. while taking out a 'Tiranga Yatra'.

Protesters return

Several protesters said they returned on Sunday because they did not want to abandon the cause, even though they were unable to reach Jantar Mantar.

"I was here yesterday, but the police did not allow me to cross even the first barricade, so I had to stand outside the entire day. Today, they at least let me till here. I will come tomorrow, I do not want to give up," said a protester who had travelled from Mumbai.

Sarthak Mishra, a student at Central University of Haryana and who hails from Jharkhand, arrived in Delhi on Saturday night. "I had an exam on Saturday, which is why I missed yesterday, but I made sure I am here today. But no one else has arrived and the protest is not happening," he said.

Questioning the scale of the security deployment, Mr. Mishra said the protesters were ordinary citizens who had come to raise concerns about voting rights. "We are unarmed normal civilians and the police are having the most dangerous weapons, batons for us. Is this needed for us? This is for terrorists, murderers or rapists and not for commoners like us," he said.

"If the government is taking away our basic right to vote, it is a waste to call ourselves a democratic country," he added.

Fanning out

As police action continued in central Delhi, KYS organised demonstrations outside the Supreme Court and on the Yamuna River, saying its activists were being prevented from protesting.

Several KYS activists staged a protest outside the Supreme Court against alleged police brutality. Minutes later, the participants, mostly women, were dragged away.

In a separate demonstration, KYS activists took boats and protested on the Yamuna, describing the river as the "new Jantar Mantar". The organisation said it would continue its mobilisation against the CEC and the Election Commission.

Protests will go on across the country till CEC resigns: CJP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), the Students' Federation of India and the All India Students' Federation urged people to protest peacefully across the country. They vowed that protests would continue till Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar resigned.

Ashutosh Ranka, Saurav Das.

Addressing a joint press conference, Ashutosh Ranka, co-convener of the CJP, said the "fight" has now started and that, the way it has been treated like "a war", Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah should be "ashamed". "The fight was against the Election Commission and Gyanesh Kumar. Narendra Modi and Amit Shah have turned it into a fight against themselves," he said.

Saurav Das, CJP co-convener, alleged that there is an "open emergency-like situation" and the state is at "war with its own citizens" to save Mr. Kumar.

"We want to ask Modi and Shah, what such information does Gyanesh Kumar have about you that you are fighting a war with your own citizens? Why are you protecting him? We have been told that RSS is also pressuring the Modi government to remove him, else they will lose power," he said.

"Does he (CEC) know anything about the 2024 election, when Modi was trailing in Varanasi and suddenly he started leading? Does Gyanesh Kumar know how that happened? Does Gyanesh Kumar know how elections were done in other BJP-ruled States," he asked.

The CJP leaders said that they were "kidnapped" from the flight on Saturday by the police. Mr. Das said that after being detained, the police did not allow them to speak to their lawyers. He said they were worried that their phones would have been hacked and evidence planted after the phones were seized by the police.

A Special Executive Magistrate court on Sunday directed Delhi Police to release CJP leaders Abhijeet Dipke, Mr. Das and Mr. Ranka from detention on condition of "no breach of peace for a year".

Mr. Dipke said that they will protest again. "Haven't signed any bond that says we won't protest. We will hit the streets again," he posted on *X*. Referring to it, Mr. Ranka accused Mr. Modi, Mr. Shah, and Mr. Kumar of distubring peace.

Protesters and journalists allege getting roughed up; police defend their actions

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

About a dozen journalists were among those detained by the Delhi Police during Sunday's protests in central Delhi, with several alleging that they were manhandled, shoved into detention vehicles, and prevented from reporting on police action against demonstrators.

The incidents took place at multiple locations, including Connaught Place and near Ramakrishna Ashram Marg Metro station. Several journalists said they had displayed their press cards and identified themselves as media personnel but were detained nonetheless.

Pressing concern: Police detain a media representative during a protest at the Connaught Place area in New Delhi on Sunday. PTI

Journalists detained

In the morning, minutes after several student organisations staged a demonstration in Connaught Place, *Peek TV* journalists Vedanta Agarwal and Sara Khan were allegedly dragged by police personnel while reporting on the detention of protesters.

Ms. Khan said she and her colleague were trying to document the police action against demonstrators when officers intervened.

"We were just trying to get in to show how they were brutally handling detainees. A male cop grabbed me by the neck and pushed me towards a woman security personnel. 'She is press, take her first,' he said, and then pushed me," Ms. Khan alleged.

In another incident near Ramakrishna Ashram Marg Metro station, at least seven journalists, including those working for prominent newspapers such as the *Hindustan Times*, were detained and pushed into a van while questioning police personnel about the detention of a journalist moments earlier at the same location.

Three journalists working for the Hindi edition of *The Indian Express*, identified as Shashwat, Siya and Vijay Kumar, were also detained.

They were released after around 45 minutes at Chhatrasal Stadium, nearly 12 km from where they had been detained. Videos also showed journalist Shyam Meera Singh being manhandled and shoved into a detention bus while reporting on the protests. Responding to the incidents, a senior Delhi Police official said some journalists may have been detained because of confusion arising from their proximity to protesters.

"The reporters may have been detained due to confusion, as they worked very close to the protesters and did not back off while protesters were being detained," the official said.

Several protesters reported injuries and alleged that police personnel had assaulted them during detention and while transporting them to detention centres.

The Delhi Police, however, said protesters were "unwilling to cooperate" during detention operations, requiring personnel to use force to remove them. According to the police, some demonstrators refused to get up or move when asked to leave, forcing personnel to lift them and put them into vehicles. The police maintained that such action was necessary when protesters did not cooperate with instructions.

DYFI to move SC over 'illegal detention' of its activists

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Democratic Youth Federation of India (DYFI), the youth wing of the CPI (M), will move the Supreme Court challenging what it described as the "illegal detention" and "custodial torture" of its activists, Rajya Sabha member and national president of the organisation, A. A. Rahim, said on Sunday.

Mr. Rahim alleged that DYFI members were holding a peaceful protest when police personnel "dragged them off the road and forced them into a bus". He claimed that, instead of a police station, the detainees were driven to a location without CCTV coverage.

According to Mr. Rahim, the detainees were then segregated by gender and assaulted inside the buses. Accusing the police of subjecting them to brutal treatment, he said, "These vehicles were nothing short of Guantanamo Bay on wheels."

Mr. Rahim further alleged that the police failed to follow established legal procedures, including preparing arrest memos, informing family members, producing them before a magistrate and conducting medical exams.

Police personnel detain CPI (M) MP John Brittas during the protest in Connaught Place area, New Delhi, on Sunday. PTI

Police turned Delhi into a war zone, says Left; MP hospitalised

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Left parties condemned the continued police action against protesters in Delhi on Sunday, which saw Rajya Sabha member John Brittas of the Communist Party of India (Marxist) get injured as police detained and forcibly dragged him to a detention van while he was speaking to the media.

Mr. Brittas was admitted to the Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital, where he was visited by CPI(M) general secretary M.A. Baby.

"The police have turned Delhi into a war zone," Mr. Baby said, adding that scores of activists from the party's student wing, the Students' Federation of India (SFI), including its president Adarsh M. Saji and Democratic Youth Federation of India (DYFI) leader Jaick C. Thomas, were assaulted inside police vehicles. "They have turned police vans into torture camps. Women are being cruelly attacked and detained for hours inside mobile jails," Mr. Baby said.

The clampdown will not stop the protests, Mr. Baby asserted, saying, "[Prime Minister Narendra] Modi, [Union Home Minister]Amit Shah, and [Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh chief] Mohan Bhagwat must not be under the impression that unleashing state repression will kill the movement to oust [Chief Election Commissioner] Gyanesh Kumar. The students and the youth are fighting to save our democracy."

Mr. Brittas, who continues to be under treatment as of Sunday evening, said in a post on X: "Even if we are dragged through the streets, beaten with lathis, trampled with boots, or choked to death, we will not step back even an inch. We will forge ahead until victory in this protest to reclaim the democracy of our nation!"

INBRIEF

Mamata AITC MLA attacked; Abhishek served police notice

A legislator of the Mamata All India Trinamool Congress suffered injuries when his vehicle was attacked late on Saturday night. Bibhas Sardar, MLA from Baruipur Purba, was attacked on his way home from his MLA office. Mr. Sardar said his vehicle was stopped by a group of persons while returning towards his residence. Mamata AITC general secretary and Diamond Harbour MP Abhishek Banerjee spoke to Mr. Sardar following the alleged attack. In a separate incident, police personnel also visited the residence of Mr. Banerjee on Sunday and served a notice summoning him for another round of questioning in connection with the Camac Street party office billboard case.

Two die of gas exposure at ESL steel plant in Jharkhand

Two workers died following gas exposure at a steel plant in Jharkhand's Bokaro district on Sunday, prompting the administration to order a probe into the accident. The incident occurred at ESL Steel Limited, a subsidiary of Vedanta Iron and Steel Limited. The two deceased individuals had been identified as Sohan Mahato from Ramgarh in Bokaro, and Samir Ansari from Dhanbad district. "*Prima facie*, it appears that the deaths occurred due to exposure to carbon monoxide. However, we will wait for the probe report and post-mortem reports before making any comment," State Chief Inspector of Factories, Manish Kumar Sinha said. PTI

Delhi High Court acquits man convicted in POCSO case

The Delhi High Court has set aside the conviction and 20-year prison sentence of a man accused of sexually assaulting a minor girl, holding that material contradictions in the testimonies of the victim and her mother created reasonable doubt about the prosecution's case. Justice Madhu Jain allowed the appeal filed by the accused, who had been convicted by a trial court in November 2025 under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act and various provisions of the Indian Penal Code. The High Court, in its September 30 judgment, directed that the man be released from jail forthwith if he was not convicted in any other case.

IIIT-Ranchi student found dead in hostel, protest erupts

A first-year student of the Indian Institute of Information Technology (IIIT) in Ranchi was found dead in his hostel room late on Saturday, leading to a protest on campus. The student was from Bihar's Bhagalpur district. The incident came to light at around 11.30 p.m. on Saturday after his friends, worried because he was not opening his room, broke the door and found him unresponsive. He was taken to a private hospital, where doctors declared him dead. The students then protested, blocking the Khelgaon-Tatisilwai road and called for the sacking of the institute's director.

Manipur CM calls for peace as clashes leave nine dead

Authorities have been directed to take immediate and effective steps to control the situation, says Yumnam Khemchand Singh after two days of conflict between Kuki and Naga communities

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

As tension prevailed in Manipur following two days of armed conflict between Kuki and Naga communities that claimed nine lives across three districts, Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh on Sunday condemned the killing of civilians and appealed to public leaders and community-based organisations to exercise restraint and cooperate in defusing the situation.

The unofficial death toll stood at 11, with two members of the Kuki National Army-Burma, a Myanmar-based armed group, reportedly killed in a gunfight near the Myanmar border.

"I have instructed the authorities concerned to take immediate and effective steps to control the situation, and ensure the safety of all citizens," Mr. Singh said. He said additional security forces have been dispatched to Kamjong and Kangpokpi, the two worst-hit districts. The violence began in Kamjong on Friday night and spread to the interior areas of Kuki-majority Kangpokpi district by Saturday afternoon.

Over 50 have died in Kuki-Naga clashes since February. PTI

The first victim in the latest string of violence was a 42-year-old Kuki woman who was killed by unidentified gunmen in Kamjong's Chassad Kuki village on Friday night. The killing led to a gunfight between armed groups, during which a 22-year-old Kuki man was killed.

Spread of violence

The violence spread to other areas of the district on Saturday , resulting in the death of two Naga men. Almost simultaneously, suspected extremists killed a Gurkha farmer travelling to his leased farm in Ukhrul district.

Hours later, four Nagas were killed in two separate attacks in Kangpokpi district. One of them was beheaded, locals said.

Leishiyo Keishing, a Naga MLA, wrote to the State's Home Minister Konthoujam Govindas on Saturday, urging him to deploy adequate security personnel to the district to protect lives and public property. On Sunday, the All Naga Students' Association condemned the "calculated terror attacks" against Naga people "by Kuki National Army-Burma in pursuit of their imaginary dream of Kukiland." Kuki organisations, in turn, accused the National Socialist Council of Nagalim, or the Isak-Muivah faction of the NSCN of targeting Kuki members.

More than 50 people have died in the Kuki-Naga clashes in Manipur since they began in February over an alleged drunken brawl. More than half of them have been killed since August 27.

Mizoram to count refugees separately during 2027 Census

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Mizoram has decided to enumerate refugees living temporarily in the State as part of the 2027 Census, with their details recorded on a list separate from that of Indian citizens, officials said.

The decision followed a State-level meeting in Aizawl on Saturday to review preparations for the second phase of the Census. Mizoram Chief Secretary Khilli Ram Meena chaired the meeting.

Mizoram Home Minister K. Sapdanga told the State Assembly a few weeks ago that 38,213 refugees had been registered as of August 20. Of them, 29,575 were from Myanmar, 6,959 from Manipur and 1,679 from Bangladesh, he said. Local organisations, however, put the figure at over 60,000.

Refugees from Myanmar, mostly members of the Chin community, began arriving in Mizoram after the military coup in February 2021. A military offensive in Bangladesh forced members of the Bawm community to flee to Mizoram in November 2022, while the Kuki-Zomi people of Manipur fled ethnic conflicts in May 2023.

Ethnically related

The Chins, Bawms, and Kuki-Zomi people are ethnically related to Mizoram's dominant Mizo community. Mr. Sapdanga also told the House that biometric enrolment of the Bawms had been completed, while that of the Chins reached 98.9%. "Individuals who do not wish to share their Aadhaar numbers will not be compelled to disclose them," an official said after the meeting on Saturday.

Mr. Sapdanga also said people excluded from the electoral rolls during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) would be counted in the Census. Altogether, 78,442 names were deleted from the draft electoral rolls published on July 4.

Musk can't pressure India on Starlink, says House panel chief

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Nishikant Dubey

India does not frame its security policy under pressure from social media or any external influences, Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) MP Nishikant Dubey, who chairs the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Information Technology, said on Sunday, responding to billionaire businessman Elon Musk's criticism of resistance to his satellite Internet service Starlink's entry into the Indian market.

Mr. Dubey said the committee had examined the security concerns associated with the satellite internet service provider. "As the Chairman of the Parliamentary Committee, our committee has understood the challenges facing the country's security agencies through Starlink," he said.

He added that the Defence Ministry, the Home Ministry, and investigation agencies had raised concerns about what he described as "dangerous games". He claimed that similar concerns had been flagged by the Congress-led government in 2013-14, though he did not elaborate on the nature of the alleged threats. He said India could not be pressured through social media campaigns.

He rejected suggestions that financial considerations had influenced government policy. "If our policy were driven by money, we would have rolled out the red carpet for you despite opposition from the security agencies," he said. Questioning Mr. Musk's criticism of India's approach, Mr. Dubey said, "First, provide connections to the poor in your own country, America, at affordable rates, and then level accusations."

Appointment of new Deputy Election Commissioner puts ECI work hierarchy in focus

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

Prakash Rajpurohit

Prakash Rajpurohit, an IAS officer of the 2010 batch, has been appointed as Deputy Election Commissioner (DEC) in the Election Commission of India (ECI), filling the vacancy caused by the premature repatriation of Sanjay Kumar, who was incharge of the Electoral Rolls and Information Technology division.

What will be the work allocation in the ECI after this new appointment is crucial, as Sanjay Kumar, who had been DEC from August 2024 to August this year, had been responsible for the Electoral Rolls and IT division of the ECI, and had signed the ECI's June 24, 2025, order initiating the SIR in the country.

It is also important because Election Commissioners S.S. Sandhu and Vivek Joshi had written to the Cabinet Secretary on how files of the IT Department head Seema Khanna not being routed through Mr. Kumar, who was a seasoned officer, was a violation. Dr. Khanna joined the ECI in 2025 on deputation from the National Informatics Centre. She heads the commission's IT Department, and oversees its digital infrastructure, including systems for electoral-roll management.

Officer's repatriation

According to ECI sources, before the repatriation of Mr. Kumar to his parent cadre, Dr. Khanna's files had been routed through him till she was given a promotion to Level 15, which is equivalent to the rank of an Additional Secretary. Since Mr. Kumar was of the rank of Joint Secretary (Level 14), Senior Deputy Election Commissioner Manish Garg issued an internal order that Dr. Khanna's files should go straight to the Election Commissioners from then.

This order was, however, never implemented. Dr. Khanna's files were being routed through Mr. Garg himself following the repatriation of Mr. Kumar, as he was his link officer, which made him responsible for his departments in his absence.

Mr. Rajpurohit's appointment was cleared by the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet late on Saturday as per the order by the Department of Personnel and Training. The Rajasthan-cadre officer has been appointed to the post for a tenure up to April 8, 2030.

It remains to be seen how work allocation is done now and whether it addresses the concerns of the two ECs, specially ahead of the crucial Assembly elections.

'Indo-French satellite set for launch in 12-16 months'

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Indo-French satellite TRISHNA (Thermal Infra-Red Imaging Satellite for High-resolution Natural Resource Assessment) will be launched in the next 12-16 months, said Jasvinder Singh Khoral, Director (Projects) of the Indian Space Research Organisation's U.R. Rao Satellite Centre (URSC), on Sunday.

He said this was the third satellite that India and France were developing after Megha-Tropiques and SARAL (Satellite with ARGOS and ALTIKA) satellites. "This particular project has been around for a decade or so in its conceptualisation and formalisation. Now it has come to the realisation stage. It is at a point where, in the next 12 -16 months, we will be due for launch," Mr. Khoral said while speaking at the TRISHNA Water for Tomorrow workshop.

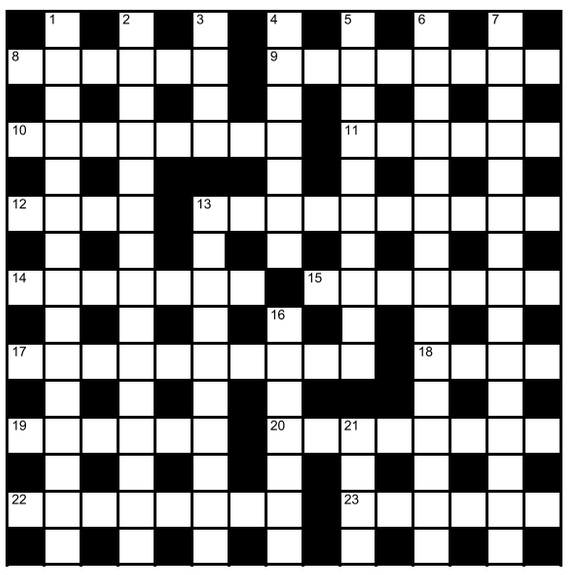
The TRISHNA mission is a collaborative endeavour between the ISRO and the French space agency CNES.

TH CROSSWORD + 14921

(set by Vidwan)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



Across

8 British National limit for Spooner's sleep (6)
9 Laugh out loud! Almost high, father gets sticky candy! (8)
10 Alien about alien phase or something similar (2,6)
11 Talk about retaining the French country house (6)
12 Intense part of pride! Epiphany! (4)
13 Macho guys having no power before love! No wonder! (10)
14 Talk about India's Himalayan tree (7)
15 Weak, heartless and say vile wish (7)
17 Praise fellow to obtain unlimited dates (10)
18 Pay attention to main killer eliminating sons (4)
19 Pick well regularly within group (6)
20 Train going around hot and popular country (8)
22 Emergency provision for Spooner's dangerous quartet (4,4)
23 Loses sleep over work in constituencies (6)

Down

1 Standard article on regressive units of heredity is describing reproduction without fertilisation (15)
2 One who explains without exhibition and advertising and one competed over support for poor (15)
3 Not the first omission by section of Church (4)
4 Wise burying a hatchet (7)
5 Voters somehow tolerate EC! (10)
6 I retraced the log rolling mouthpiece that prevents lip stains (9,6)
7 Pull head back with the one short string wound for support (5,2,8)
13 Clues regularly ignored in love forecast (10)
16 Large insect occasionally bearing light (7)
21 Further exposed fake love (4)

SUDOKU

							1	
			2	9				8
8	9	6					2	
		4	9		8		5	
	8						7	
	5		3		7	4		
	3					1	4	6
2				4	5			
	7							

No.SS7029 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★☆

Solution to previous puzzle

D	A	I	L	S	P	C		
D	E	S	C	E	N	D	A	N
T	E	X	I	T	P	H	I	W
I	C	T	P	O	V	E	R	T
Y	S	T	R	I	C	K	E	N
A	R	I						
S	T	A	N	D	A	R	D	M
I	D	O	F	F	M	E	L	U
A	I	I	F	E	T	E	L	A
P	E	L	L	I	N	T	N	D
E	E	T	L	G	S	T	O	L
I	D	D	O	W	J	O	N	E
S	E	H	R	F	O	R	W	A
R	D	T	H	I	N	K	I	N
G	V	O	U	R	S	A	A	F
E	A	R	B	L	O	C	K	C
H	A	I	N	R	K	Y	Y	Y
N	L							

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

4	3	9	8	6	5	1	7	2
6	5	7	2	9	1	4	3	8
8	1	2	7	4	3	9	5	6
5	6	1	9	3	8	2	4	7
7	9	3	5	2	4	8	6	1
2	8	4	6	1	7	3	9	5
1	7	5	3	8	9	6	2	4
3	2	8	4	7	6	5	1	9
9	4	6	1	5	2	7	8	3

FAITH

Shakti, strength of Siva

As per sastras, pleasures enjoyed by one are all temporary and give one pain; real *anandham* (bliss) comes from knowing the Paramatma, said Damodara Deekshithar in a discourse.

How does one know this formless, nameless entity? The Paramatma gets form, characteristics etc. when He creates, which is known as Parashakti: before Shakti, there is no formation, with Shakti, there is the formed world. This is similar to have before a pot is shaped, there is only clay.

A potter decides to form it into a pot. The shape first takes form in his mind which is not visible to others. When the pot is crafted from that clay, everyone can see and appreciate the pot. Similarly, there is *aviyaktam* (not perceivable by the physical senses) before srishti. Then comes the formation (Parashakti), and She is called *Sarva Jaganmata*.

Adi Sankara says in Soundarya Lahiri, "Lord Siva becomes capable of creating and manifesting the universe when He is united with Shakti. Otherwise, the divine is not even capable of a slight movement or a tremor. Therefore, how can one who has not accumulated great merit even dare to bow to You or praise You, O Goddess?"

This highlights the inseparable relationship between Siva (pure consciousness) and Shakti (dynamic energy). Consciousness needs energy to act. One is very familiar with this concept in daily life and the common line, uttered by one, "I do not have the Shakti (strength) to go to the temple, *Sivvanenu* (in the name of Siva), I will stay at home," drives home the point.

'Excess': More to pay, not more to receive

COVERNOTE

K. Nitya Kalyani

When you read your insurance policy, if you read it, you may come across a term called 'excess'. Usually, it says 'excess on this policy is ₹1,000' or something like that.

And no, it does not mean the insurance company is going to give you something extra.

It means the exact opposite, that you will pay something. In this case, the first ₹1,000 of each claim in this policy. The insurance company starts paying only after you have picked up your share.

Some policies have a compulsory excess. You can also opt for a voluntary excess which will be over and above any compulsory excess.

Why ever would you opt for bearing part of your own claim? Because of the small silver lining that you get a premium discount for it.

And we all love discounts, remember?

The general insurance industry is reportedly considering imposing a compulsory co-payment of 10% of the claim amount on all new hospitalisation policies from the new year in lieu of a lower premium.

'Deductible'

An excess is also called a 'deductible'. A close cousin is 'co-payment' which denotes that you bear a percentage of the claim rather than a flat sum.

The principle behind all this is risk-sharing. You have heard of profit-sharing; this is loss-sharing. You retain a small part of the risk and the insurance company takes on the rest.

An excess discourages small claims that can cost an insurance company disproportionately in administrative time, paperwork and money. If repairing that scratch on your car costs around your deductible amount, you won't claim. You will choose cost-effective hospital treatment options because you are going to bear part of it.

But should you opt for a voluntary excess? Suppose a ₹2,500 voluntary excess on your car means a ₹750 discount on the Own Damage premium and you have no claim that year, then you are ₹750 ahead. If you have a claim that crosses ₹750, that saving has disappeared. You could end up bearing up to ₹2,500 to save ₹750. So, it's a view for you to take.

Dissect the discount

You will come across excesses in many personal insurance policies. Motor Own Damage policies have a regulator mandated deductible on every claim, with no premium discount for it. Health policies can have deductibles and co-payments. Travel policies frequently have excesses too. Home insurance has them in some covers and add-ons. The idea remains the same: a specified first part of the loss stays with you.

A spin-off series!

And then there is an insurance product built around the idea of excess.

A hospitalisation top-up policy has a pre-agreed deductible called a threshold. If it is set at ₹10 lakh, the top-up responds only after your bills are more than that.

The expenses up to ₹10 lakh should be met by your basic hospitalisation policy or from your pocket. That is also why top-ups can offer large sums insured at relatively attractive premiums. The insurer is not paying from rupee one and smaller claims are more likely and more frequent. So, when your policy says 'excess', don't get carried away by the English. In insurance, 'excess' is one thing you are not getting more of.

(The writer is a business journalist specialising in insurance & corporate history)

Send queries on personal finance and investing to the moneywise@thehindu.co.in ID. Our experts in personal finance will respond to select queries, but will not give specific recommendations for investment in a particular mutual fund, share or fixed deposit.

Whither safety: Where money once left a paper trail, it now casts a perpetual digital shadow. GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCK

When our meandering money leaves a mark

If every penny we spend leaves a digital footprint, what happens when strangers follow that indelible trail? For, a trail of transactions can reveal who a person actually is

PRIVACY PARADOX

Sincy Wilson
Vaishali R. Venkat

A cup of coffee, a grab of hot samosas, a premium movie ticket, the book you bought, a health insurance policy you opted for, a stock or mutual fund you invested in, a debt you cleared and what not? From the first Rupee spent to the last one of the month, our financial journey is increasingly out there in the open. Not just us; our money's meandering voyage is also under the scanner.

Money has always left clues in every hand it touches. For instance, from the ledger books of ancient times, one could glean how affluent or frugal a family was, how much it spent, how much it saved and how much it borrowed. Yet, following such a manual trail, leaf by leaf through voluminous, timeworn tomes, was an arduous task, like tracing a tiny creature through a dense forest by the faint paw marks it left behind. In stark contrast to the dust-ridden ledgers, today, we live in the era of digital wallets. The money-paws of our transactions can be traced from mice to monkeys to monsters, all at the click of a button.

Where money once left a paper trail, it now casts a perpetual digital shadow. So, what happens when a stranger wanders into our digital woods?

> The information in our meandering money trail is not a ball that can simply be passed from one player to another; legal safeguards come into play at every stage

To cut a long story short: If every Rupee leaves a trace, are we giving away a slice of our 'financial privacy'? Every single Rupee we spend can reveal something about us: our tastes, interests, habits, preferences, priorities and even our way of life. A transaction may record an amount, but a trail of transactions can reveal who a person actually is.

Yet, safeguarding our so-called 'financial privacy' does not mean that we must return to a time when our money's journey left fewer footprints. Once we progress, there is no looking back to the dusty past. No doubt, digital money is the way forward, and for predominantly good reasons: instant payments, round-the-clock access to financial services, automatic records of transactions, easier tracking of monthly expenditure, seamless payment of subscriptions, instant execution of investments, quicker loan processing, instant alerts for unusual or fraudulent transactions, handy proof of payments, reduction in the costs of printing or handling currency, and much more. Why should we lose all these advantages in the name of 'privacy'?

> The real power lies not in erasing our money footprints, but in learning to notice them, interpret them and, ultimately, master our own money

Yet, on the flip side, the very convenience that digital money offers comes with a trade-off. The same digital trail that makes our financial lives faster also creates a vast pool of information about us. The question now is not whether we should leave a digital trail at all in the first place, but to know how we can use that information to study our own financial behaviour and be aware of what happens to the information left behind.

This drives us naturally to another question: who gets to see this information, and what protection does the law provide for it? The Constitution of India recognises privacy as a fundamental right; but does that extend to our financial lives as well? After all, the right to privacy is not an absolute right to live without leaving any trace. The Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023 addresses this tension.

While the Constitution provides the foundation for our fundamental right to live with dignity and autonomy, the DPDP Act provides a modern legal framework to protect personal data in the digital world. Perhaps, the DPDP Act is a form of digital armour. It acts as a guardrail by regulating how our personal data is collected, processed and used. The law labels the banks, apps, and platforms that determine why and how our personal data is processed as *Data Fiduciaries*. Thus, the information in our meandering money trail is not a ball that can simply be passed from one player to another; legal safeguards come into play at every stage.

Let's face it. We may not have much say in stopping the digital trails that feed external algorithms. Yet, we can turn the same trail into a money mirror: one that tracks our cash flow, spots leakages, curbs unnecessary expenditure and helps us make better investment choices. The trail that tells others about us can also teach us about ourselves. Perhaps, the real power lies not in erasing our money footprints, but in learning to notice them, interpret them and, ultimately, master our own money.

(Dr. Sincy Wilson is an assistant professor of Law and a legal researcher specialising in constitutional and administrative law. Dr. Vaishali R. Venkat is an NISM & CRISIL-certified Wealth Manager and certified in NISM's Research Analyst module)

Investing in sector and thematic funds

THINKINVESTOR

Sectoral and thematic funds are structured as active funds or passive funds (either index funds or ETFs)

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

Asset management companies continually launch new fund offers (NFOs). In the recent times, several of the NFOs have been sectoral funds and thematic funds. In this article, we discuss whether such funds fit into your investment portfolio.

Sector funds are positioned to bet on specific sectors such as the banking sector and chemicals sector. Thematic funds are positioned to take a bet on multiple sectors at the same time. Defense, for instance, has been a popular theme in recent times. This theme constitutes capital goods, automobile and chemicals sectors. Sectoral and thematic funds are structured as active funds or passive funds (either index funds or ETFs).

We explore how these funds fit into your portfolio from a core-satellite framework. The core portfolio is a goal-based portfolio whereas the satellite portfolio is a trading portfolio. You can also look at the core portfolio as a bet primarily on market movements and the satellite portfolio as a bet to beat the market. Beating the market means you are expecting to earn alpha- returns greater than a benchmark index. You can do this in two ways. One, trade actively in the market. So, market timing becomes the primary factor in generating alpha. Alternatively, you can bet on sectors through sector funds. While betting on sectors is much better than betting on individual stocks, you must have a view on which sector is likely to do well in the near term. Typically, sector funds and thematic funds are launched in response to market interest, not necessarily in anticipation of sectors doing well in the future. You could instead look at funds that are focused on mid-cap and small-cap stocks. Such funds are likely to rotate across sectors based on fund managers' forecast of near-term sector movements.

You must be mindful that mid-cap (small-cap) active funds do not invest only in mid-cap (small-cap) stocks. SEBI regulation allows these funds to invest 35% outside of their chosen benchmark. If you want pure exposure to mid-cap (small-cap) stocks, you must buy units of mid-cap (small-cap) index fund or mid-cap ETF. It is important that you have an outlook on the mid-cap or small-cap index. For instance, you must have a view that mid-caps are likely to outperform other styles (large-cap and small-cap) in the near term. That requires understanding of technical analysis. You can also subscribe to fee-based technical analysis research to enable you to bet on sectors or themes.

(The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments)

Personal Loans

Rates and Charges		Loan amount 5 lakh Tenure 5 years	Loan amount 1 lakh Tenure 5 years	(% of loan amount)
Name of Lender	**Interest Rate (%)**	**EMI (Rs)**	**EMI (Rs)**	**Processing fee**
Axis Bank	8.90 onwards	10,355 onwards	2,071 onwards	Up to 2%
Bajaj Finserv	10.00-30.50	10,624-16,177	2,125-3,235	Up to 4.13%
Bank of Baroda*	10.15-18.00	10,660-12,697	2,132-2,539	Up to 2% (Max. Rs 10,000)
Bank of India	10.85-16.15	10,834-12,199	2,167-2,440	Up to 1% (Min. Rs 250; Max. Rs 15,000)
Bank of Maharashtra	9.75-15.00	10,562-11,895	2,112-2,379	Up to 1% (Max. Rs 10,000)
Canara Bank	9.70-15.75	10,550-12,093	2,110-2,419	0.25% (Rs. 500 - Rs. 2,500)
Central Bank of India	11.25 onwards	10,934 onwards	2,187 onwards	Up to 1%
Federal Bank	11.75 - 18.99	11,059 - 12,968	2,212 - 2,594	Up to 3%
HDFC Bank	9.99 onwards	10,621 onwards	2,124 onwards	Up to Rs 6,500
HSBC Bank	9.70 onwards	10,562 onwards	2,112 onwards	Up to 1%
ICICI Bank	9.99 onwards	10,621 onwards	2,124 onwards	Up to 2%
IDFC FIRST Bank	9.99 onwards	10,621 onwards	2,124 onwards	Up to 3.5%
Indian Overseas Bank	10.25 onwards	10,685 onwards	2,137 onwards	Up to 0.75%
IndusInd Bank	10.49 onwards	10,744 onwards	2,149 onwards	Up to 3.5% (2% for instant personal loans for limited period)
Kotak Mahindra Bank	10.99 onwards	10,869 onwards	2,174 onwards	Up to 5%
Poonawalla Fincorp	9.99 onwards	10,621 onwards	2,124 onwards	Up to 4%
Punjab & Sind Bank	9.65-13.90	10,538-11,608	2,108-2,322	0.50%-1%
Punjab National Bank	10.25-16.80	10,685-12,373	2,137-2,475	Up to 1%
State Bank of India	10.00-15.00	10,624-11,895	2,125-2,379	Up to 1.50% (Rs. 1,000 - Rs. 15,000)
Tata Capital	10.99 onwards	10,869 onwards	2,174 onwards	Flat Rs. 49
UCO Bank	9.95 - 13.20	10,611-11,428	2,122-2,286	Up to 1% (Min. Rs 750)
Union Bank of India	8.90 - 12.65	10,355-11,287	2,071-2,257	Up to 1% (Max. Rs 7,500)

*Interest concession of 0.10% to customers opting for group credit life insurance.

Car Loans

Rates and Charges		Loan amount 5 lakh Tenure 5 years	(% of loan amount)
Name of Lender	**Interest Rate (%)**	**EMI (Rs)**	**Processing fee**
Bank of Baroda	7.60 - 11.35	10,043 - 10,959	Up to Rs. 2,000
Bank of India	7.60-12.55	10,043 - 11,262	Up to 0.25% (Rs. 2,500 - Rs. 10,000)
Bank of Maharashtra*	7.45-11.75	10,007 - 11,059	Up to 0.25%
Canara Bank**	7.45-11.45	10,007 - 10,984	0.25% (Rs 1,000 - Rs 5,000)
Central Bank of India	7.50-9.30	10,019 - 10,452	NIL (Till 31.12.2026)
Federal Bank	7.90-9.00	10,114 onwards	1% (Rs. 1,000 - Rs. 50,000)
HDFC Bank	8.25 onwards	10,198 onwards	Up to 0.5% (Rs. 3,500 - Rs. 8,000)
ICICI Bank	8.40 onwards	10,234 onwards	Up to Rs. 8,500
IDBI Bank	7.75-9.30	10,078 - 10,452	Rs. 2,500
Indian Bank	7.55-9.65	10,031 - 10,513	Rs. 1,200
Indian Overseas Bank	7.55-12.00	10,031 - 11,122	NIL
Karnataka Bank	8.16-11.66	10,177 - 11,037	Up to 0.60% (Rs. 2,500 - Rs. 11,000)
Punjab and Sind Bank***	7.55-14.05	10,031 - 11,647	0.25% (Rs. 1,000 - Rs. 15,000)
Punjab National Bank	7.60-10.70	10,043 - 10,797	Up to 0.25% (Rs. 1,000 - Rs. 1,500)
State Bank of India	8.30 - 9.35	10,307 - 10,587	Rs. 1,000 - Rs. 4,000
UCO Bank	7.35-10.00	9,983 - 10,624	0.5% (Max. Rs 5,000)
Union Bank of India	7.50-10.00	10,019 - 10,684	Up to Rs 1,000

*0.25% rate concession for home loan borrowers/other customers with at least 6 months banking relationship
**50% waiver on processing fee till December 31
***Concession of up to 50% on processing fee for PSB Apna Vahan Sugam.

Rates and charges as on October 7 **Source: Paisabazaar.com**

CONCORD

Shooting leaves 9 dead including suspect in Pennsylvania, police say

GETTY IMAGES

A man killed eight people including a pregnant woman, children and other relatives at his home in Erie, Pennsylvania, before taking his own life as well, U.S. authorities said on Saturday. Erie Police Chief Rick Lorah said the 45-year-old man was related to seven of the victims in the previous day's shooting. AP

KATHMANDU

Nepal flash floods sweep away houses, five people missing

AFP

Flash floods hit central Nepal on Sunday, sweeping away about 45 houses and leaving at least five people missing, officials said, weeks after devastating flooding that killed hundreds. Three hydropower projects and four bridges were damaged. Evacuation efforts were hastened as water levels in the Budhi Gandaki continued to rise. AFP

ISTANBUL

11 killed, 27 hurt as coach crashes into truck in Turkey: authorities

AFP

Eleven people were killed and 27 hurt in western Turkey on Sunday when a coach turned over after colliding with a truck, authorities said. The coach crashed near the entry to a motorway between the city of Bursa and the seaside city of Izmir, the governor's office of the local Manisa district said on X, stating the toll. AFP

NAIROBI

139 migrants dead, 84 missing as boat capsizes off Djibouti: UN

AFP

At least 139 migrants died, including 15 children, and 84 went missing when an overcrowded boat sank while heading from Djibouti to Yemen, the UN's International Organization for Migration said on Sunday. The boat was carrying 305 people when it capsized north of the Djibouti town of Obock on the night of October 8-9. AFP

Riyadh airport struck again a day after 12 killed in Houthi escalation

300 people wounded in Saturday's strikes and airport was still closed on Sunday; Indian embassy says one citizen killed and at least 10 others injured; Trump says he is planning to speak to Saudi crown prince as as he weighs joining the fight

Associated Press
CAIRO

A projectile struck a passenger terminal at the international airport in Riyadh on Sunday, a day after a missile hit the same terminal and killed 12 people, the Saudi-led coalition fighting Iran-backed Houthi rebels in Yemen said. The Houthis claimed responsibility for those attacks and others.

Saudi authorities said there were injuries in the latest attack on the King Khalid International Airport complex for terminals 3 and 4 for domestic flights. Saturday's missile attack was the deadliest in a Gulf Arab nation since the Iran war began, with another 300 people wounded, some critically. The airport was still closed on Sunday.

A file photo shows King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh. Terminals for domestic flights were attacked on Sunday. AFP

The sharp escalation in the new front threatens to draw in greater U.S. military involvement, as President Donald Trump has said he is weighing joining the fight against the Houthis. There was no immediate White House comment on Sunday.

The latest strike in Riyadh came shortly after the Houthis said the airport in the rebel-held Yemeni capital of Sanaa had been struck again, and blamed the Saudis.

India's embassy in Saudi Arabia said one of its citizens died on Sunday of injuries sustained in Saturday's attack, which would bring the toll to 13. The embassy said at least 10 other Indians were among those injured in the attack.

U.S. intervention

Mr. Trump on Saturday also said he planned to speak with Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman, who has been seeking assistance.

A U.S. intervention could prompt the Houthis to halt shipping through the Bab el-Mandeb Strait at the southern end of the Red Sea off Yemen and further restrict the flow of oil out of the Persian Gulf.

Earlier on Sunday, the Houthi-run health ministry said a child was killed and six people wounded in a suspected Saudi airstrike on a house in Sanaa. The ministry also said 91 Yemenis have been killed by the Saudi-led coalition in five weeks, 60% of them women and children.

There was no immediate comment from Saudi authorities on the claims.

On Sunday, the Houthis also claimed attacks on King Fahd Airport in the city of Damma, as well as oil and gas facilities in the kingdom's east.

Russia and Ukraine agree to 'energy ceasefire': Trump

Associated Press
WASHINGTON

U.S. President Donald Trump said on Sunday that Russia and Ukraine had agreed to an "energy ceasefire", but offered no details on its terms.

Mr. Trump's brief social media post said only that the ceasefire took effect immediately and that both sides had agreed to it. "Do not break it!" he wrote.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on X: "We discussed the energy ceasefire announced by President Trump. Ukraine supports the ceasefire, and it is important that Russia support it as well. We are awaiting details from the American side."

Moscow did not immediately comment on the announcement, and The White House did not clarify the President's post.

Donald Trump

However, Mr. Zelensky later said that Russia had attacked an energy plant after Mr. Trump announced the "energy ceasefire" between the two countries. "The Russians struck a power plant in Kyiv with a 'shahed' drone," Mr. Zelensky said in a social media post, adding that strikes on other energy facilities followed in the Kharkiv region.

Mr. Zelenskyy, in an interview aired on Sunday, said Ukraine was ready to stop striking Russian refineries if Moscow halted attacks on Ukraine's energy system, and asked Mr. Trump to press the Kremlin to agree.

Mr. Trump said on Saturday it was time for Ukraine to get a new president, suggesting Mr. Zelenskyy has not done enough to end the war and blaming him for high diesel prices in the U.S.

In response, Mr. Zelenskyy said Ukraine could hold elections if Russia agreed to a 60-day ceasefire. "Give us two months, 60 days off. Total ceasefire, 60 days, and we will organize elections," he said, adding that Ukraine would be ready to accept whatever choice its people made.

"With all respect to President Trump, it's up to our society, up to our people to choose one or another leader," he said.

India acknowledged Katchatheevu is ours, says Dissanayake

Meera Srinivasan
COLOMBO

New Delhi has acknowledged that Katchatheevu belongs to Sri Lanka, President Anura Kumara Dissanayake said on Sunday, while referring to the island nation's "good relations" with India.

At a rally to mark his completion of two years in office, Mr. Dissanayake pointed to the recent reference to Katchatheevu in India's Supreme Court. "We maintain good bilateral relations with India. The Central government of India has acknowledged before the Supreme Court that Katchatheevu Island belongs to Sri Lanka," he said. Last week, India's top court heard a batch of petitions challenging the "unconstitutional ceding" of Katchatheevu island to Sri Lanka in the 1970s. According to news reports, Attorney General R. Venkataramani told the court that India had "excellent relations" with Sri Lanka and did not intend reopening the Katchatheevu agreements of 1974 and 1976.

Pakistan declares emergency in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, suspends provincial govt.

Press Trust of India
ISLAMABAD

Pakistan on Sunday declared an emergency in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province over "deteriorating law and order situation", bringing the provincial government led by jailed former Prime Minister Imran Khan's party to an end.

An emergency allows the federal government to assume key executive and legislative powers in a province during a security crisis or breakdown of constitutional governance.

Based on the federal cabinet's recommendation, President Asif Ali Zardari issued a proclamation under Articles 232(1) and 234 (1) of the Constitution, citing rising terrorist attacks and a breakdown of constitutional machinery in the province, according to the presidential declaration. Under the proclamation, the chief minister, provincial ministers, advisers, special assistants and advocate general will immediately vacate their offices.

Police guard a road leading to the 'Red Zone' in Peshawar, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, in Pakistan on Sunday. REUTERS

The move comes amid an ongoing protest march led by Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Chief Minister Sohail Afridi, who is pressing for Mr. Khan's release and his medical treatment.

The presidential declaration said a report by the provincial governor had highlighted a breakdown of constitutional machinery and the provincial government's inability to function in accordance with the Constitution.

Brazil's Lula accuses Meta of interference in country's elections

Agence France-Presse
BRASILIA

The campaign of Brazilian President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva accused tech giant Meta of election interference on Saturday after his social media content was allegedly blocked on the company's platforms.

The leftist leader is seeking a fourth non-consecutive term in the October 25 runoff, where he will face Senator Flavio Bolsonaro, the son of far-right former president Jair Bolsonaro.

In a statement, Lula's campaign reported instances where platforms owned by Meta, the parent company of Facebook, WhatsApp, and Instagram, allegedly restricted the distribution of his content.

"The series of technical issues... raises strong suspicions that Meta's actions constitute an attempt to interfere in the Brazilian electoral process to the benefit of Flavio Bolsonaro's candidacy," it added.

Meta in Brazil denied the charges, calling them "simply false" and "not supported by the facts."

Sport

Ankita, Venkatram set meet records

ATHLETICS

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

RSPB's Ankita took off almost four seconds for a new meet record in the women's 3000m steeplechase on the fourth and final day at the 65th National Open athletics championships at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium on Sunday.

The 24-year-old Ankita clocked 9:34.86 to better Lalita Babar's 11-year-old record set in 2015.

The talented 21-year-old Mogali Venkatram Reddy, the 2025 junior National champion, added the senior title to his belt in the men's 800m, completing in a personal best time of 1:47.01 for a new meet record even as reigning National record holder Mohd. Afsal pulled out midway.

Steeplechaser Ankita bettered a 11-year-old record.

Gujarat's Murad Sirman, representing Services, broke the 50-seconds barrier for the first time ever, clocking 49.86s in the 400m hurdles.

Sandeep Kumar won the marathon race walk while Ramandeep Kaur took the top spot among the women in a race that had only five entries.

The results (day 4):
Men: 200m: 1. Jishnu Prasad PK (AIPSCB, 20.62s), 2. Abhin Devadiga (RSPB, 20.91s), 3. Adesh Garsa (Raj, 20.96s); **800m:** 1. Mogali Venkatram Reddy (AP, 1:47.01), 2. Aman Kumar (SSCB, 1:47.33), 3. Anant Gautam (Del, 1:48.03); **400m hurdles:** 1. Murad Sirman (SSCB, 49.86s), 2. Shakti Singh (SSCB, 50.13s), 3. Aryan Kashyap (Kar, 50.38s); **3000m Steeplechase:** 1. Sharukh Khan (RSPB, 8:30.54), 2. Price Raj Mishra (RSPB, 8:31.38), 3. Sumit Rathee (ONGC, 8:36.17); **4x400m relay:** 1. RSPB (3:06.36), 2. SSCB (3:06.59), 3. Tamil Nadu (3:08.29); **Marathon race walk:**1. Sadeep Kumar (Har, 3:19.52), 2. Vishvendra Singh (MP, 3:21.11), 3. Resham Midhun (SSCB, 3:22.46); **Long Jump:** 1. Mohd. Sazid (7.99m), 2. Sarun Payasingh (Odi, 7.79m), 3. Sunny (Bih, 7.65m); **Javelin:** 1. Aditya (Har, 79.40m), 2. Anand Singh (SSCB, 77.77m), 3. Arshdeep Singh (RSPB, 77.56m).

Women: 200m: 1. Priyanka Sikarwar (AIPSCB, 23.68s), 2. Parthipa Selvaraj (TN, 24.09s), 3. Samriti Jamwal (HP, 24.14s); **800m:** 1. Lili Das (RSPB, 2:05.37), 2. Kavitha V (TN, 2:05,58), 3. Thota Sankeertana (Chg, 2:05.70); **400m hurdles:** 1. Sinchal (RSPB, 58.40s), 2. Harshita R (TN, 59.51s), 3. Deekshita Gowda (Kar, 59.57s); **3000m steeplechase**: 1. Ankita (RSPB, 9:34.86), 2. Vandana Mori (Guj, 10:00.02), 3. Komal Jagdale (RSPB, 10:05.34).

4x400m relay: 1. RSPB (3:38.40), 2. Haryana (3:40.29), 3. Tamil Nadu (3:43.99); **Marathon race walk:** 1. Ramandeep Kaur (RSPB, 3:59.23), 2. Sonal Sukhwal (Raj, 4:16.06), 3. Deepika Sharma (Raj, 4:22.55); **High jump:** 1. Reet Rathore (UP, 1.78m), 2. Abhinaya Shetty (Kar, 1.73m), 3. Pallavi Patil (Kar), Manshi (RSPB), Kevina Annavi (TN) all 1.73m; **Heptathlon:** 1. Pooja (RSPB, 5468 pts), 2. Anamika K.A. (RSPB, 5334 pts), 3. Mubassina Mohd. (ONGC, 5265 pts).

India women suffer heavy defeat to Russia

Sports Bureau
KOLKATA

India's women's national team suffered a heavy 0-8 defeat to Russia in the second international friendly here on Sunday.

The world No. 27 Russian side demonstrated its technical and physical superiority over India, ranked 69th, leaving head coach Crispin Chettri with plenty to ponder as he assesses emerging under-20 and developmental players.

The result:
India 0 lost to Russia 8 (Darina Ishmukhametova 21, 42-pen, Marine Achoian 25, 45+1, Daiana Kishmakhova 29, Natalia Mashina 50, 51, Elizaveta Semenova 74).

Shedge gives India-A victory

AUSTRALIA-A IN INDIA

Anish Pathiyil
PUDUCHERRY

He found a place only due to Hardik Pandya's injury, but Suryansh Shedge has arguably been India-A's best player this series. After impressing with the ball earlier, his back-against-the-wall fifty helped India-A beat Australia-A by 49 runs in the third one-day at the CAP Siechem Ground here on Sunday.

The Mumbai all-rounder (66, 60b, 7x4, 2x6) helped India-A post a fighting total of 275, which was enough to prevent a clean sweep as the visitors were bowled out for 226 in reply.

India-A's opening pair, Priyansh Arya (49, 45b, 3x4, 2x6) and Prabhsimran Singh, made good use of the new ball in the first PowerPlay. The duo helped post 82 in 10 overs, but one wicket brought four as the hosts stumbled to 118 for five, unable to adjust to the lack of pace.

Shedge. CAP

The seventh-wicket stand between Shedge and Vipraj Nigam dug India-A out of the hole. Nigam holed out for 40, but not before playing his part in the side's best partnership of the series (85 off 77 balls). Suryansh's second List-A half-century helped push the total to 275.

Australia followed the same template in its batting innings. Promoted up the order, Josh Philippe (56, 48b, 6x4, 2x6) took on Gurjapneet Singh and ensured a steady flow of runs in the first ten overs. The Indian spinners used the available turn to remove the set top order. The ever-climbing required rate forced risky shots, and the last seven wickets fell for just 49 runs.

The scores: India-A 275 in 47.3 overs (Priyansh Arya 49, Suryansh Shedge 66, Vipraj Nigam 40, Dwarshius 3/38, Sutherland 3/44) beat Australia- A 226 in 46.2 overs (Josh Philippe 56, Gurjapneet 3/56). **Toss**: Australia-A. **PoTM**: Vipraj Nigam.

T20I RECORD

Abhishek reaches the 2000-run milestone in least number of balls

K.R. DEEPAK

Abhishek Sharma became the fastest batter to score 2,000 T20I runs in terms of balls faced, reaching the milestone in 1,024 deliveries. Abhishek, who laid the foundation for India's win in the Indore T20I on Sunday, eclipsed Suryakumar Yadav's record (1,164 balls). The left-hander also scored his 14th half-century in international cricket.

MR. SAFE HANDS

Smith breaks record for the most catches by a fielder in Tests

AFP

Steve Smith broke the Test record for the most catches by a fielder when he caught South Africa's David Bedingham on the third day of the first Test at Kingsmead on Sunday. It was Smith's 221st catch in his 126th Test, one more than Joe Root. He had equalled the record earlier, *in pic.*, when he caught Temba Bavuma at slips.

IMPRESSIVE

Pacer Mahmud's hat-trick puts Bangladesh in command

FILE PHOTO

Pacer Hasan Mahmud took a hat-trick to help Bangladesh gain a commanding lead over Afghanistan in the one-off Test in Abu Dhabi.**The scores:** Bangladesh 346 & 223/6 in 72 overs (Shanto 82, Mushfiqur 81) vs Afghanistan 240 in 89.1 overs (Abdul Malik 62, Rahmat Shah 105 n.o, Hasan Mahmud 5/55, Ebadot Hossain 4/56).

ON A ROLL

Farhan, Sadaqat star in Pakistan's easy victory against Sri Lanka

AFP

Skipper Sahibzada Farhan (73) and Maaz Sadaqat (96) starred in Pakistan's 82-run win against Sri Lanka in the second T20I in Rawalpindi on Sunday as the host took an unassailable lead in the three-match series. **The scores:** Pakistan 215/3 in 20 overs (Farhan 73, Sadaqat 96) bt Sri Lanka 133/7 in 20 overs (Mohd Imran 3/11).

Abhishek, Arshdeep shine as India wins a run-fest

The opener blasts a 30-ball 69 to power the hosts to another 200-plus score while the left-arm pacer takes three, including the wicket of Hope; Windies fall short despite Kamil and Hetmyer's knocks

WI IN INDIA

S. Shrivathsan
INDORE

After the batathon in Ranchi, it was Indore's turn to celebrate a festival of runs.

But this time though, the result was different. At the Holkar Stadium possessing pocket-sized boundaries, India kept intact its spectacular four-year streak of not losing back-to-back T20Is on home soil as it defeated the West Indies by 14 runs on Sunday.

Asked to set a target, the Men in Blue breached the 200-run mark yet again, recording 223 courtesy opener Abhishek Sharma's blast (69, 30b, 6x4, 5x6). While the West Indies batters kept themselves within touching distance for most part of the chase, they eventually could not pull off an encore, their pursuit ending at 209 for seven.

That the red-hot Shai Hope fell cheaply – missed one completely from Arshdeep Singh (three for 44) to have his stumps rearranged – did not help the Caribbean outfit's cause.

Naman Dhir (two for 39) did the job with his secondary skill by removing set batters Shimron Hetmyer and Kamil Pooran. The off-spinner removed Hetmyer after the ball deflected off the southpaw's pads and onto the stumps and had the last laugh against Kamil in a phase that included three sixes from the opener.

Earlier, Abhishek's street-smart approach in the PowerPlay paid rich dividends.

The left-hander, who had been dismissed in his 20s by off-spinner Roston Chase in the first two games, had a few sighters before going on the rampage.

The 26-year-old showed once again why he is the 'Dada of off-side' in the shortest format, making enough room to find and clear the boundary between sweeper-cover and long-off with elan.

Abhishek was the protagonist in the 108-run second-wicket alliance (40 balls) with Ishan Kishan, which followed the early departure of Sanju Samson. But once Chase inflicted a double blow on the home side with the scalps of Kishan and skipper Shreyas Iyer in the ninth over, the visiting team marched right back into the contest.

By striking at regular intervals - the Men in Blue went from 115 for one to 223 all out – West Indies did not allow India to operate in the gear that Abhishek drove at.

The stretch included the punishment imposed on Tilak Varma in the 17th over, by when Shreyas and Co. lost all their frontline batters.

The casual attitude and not-so-great phase, however, did not haunt India in the end as the host went 2-1 up in the five-match series.

Lights on, lights out! Abhishek provided the launchpad for India's big total before Hetmyer's dismissal derailed West Indies' chase. K.R. DEEPAK

SCOREBOARD

INDIA
Sanju Samson c Kamil b Shamar 3 *(6b)*, Abhishek Sharma c & b Springer 69 *(30b, 6x4, 5x6)*, Ishan Kishan st. Hope b Chase 37 *(18b, 6x4, 1x6)*, Shreyas Iyer lbw b Chase 1 *(2b)*, Tilak Varma run out 28 *(16b, 4x4)*, Naman Dhir c Springer b Motie 10 *(5b, 1x6)*, Nitish Kumar c Hope b Paul 21 *(14b, 3x4)*, Axar Patel run out 20 *(14b, 2x4)*, Arshdeep Singh lbw b Springer 11 *(8b, 1x6)*, Prince Yadav (not out) 13 *(6b, 3x4)*, Mayank Yadav b Shamar 0 *(1b)*; Extras (b-5, lb-1, w-4): 10; Total (in 20 overs): 223.

FALL OF WICKETS
1-7 (Samson, 1.4 overs), 2-115 (Kishan, 8.2), 3-117 (Shreyas, 8.5), 4-124 (Abhishek, 9.5), 5-135 (Dhir, 10.5), 6-169 (Nitish, 14.2), 7-194 (Tilak, 16.4), 8-202 (Axar, 18.1), 9-210 (Arshdeep, 18.6).

WEST INDIES BOWLING
Chase 4-0-38-2, Shamar 4-0-54-2, Paul 4-0-38-1, Springer 4-0-50-2, Motie 4-0-37-1.

WEST INDIES
Shai Hope b Arshdeep 5 *(5b, 1x4)*, Kamil Pooran c Arshdeep b Dhir 42 *(27b, 3x4, 3x6)*, Shimron Hetmyer b Dhir 43 *(26b, 6x4, 2x6)*, Rovman Powell c Kishan b Axar 5 *(7b)*, Sherfane Rutherford b Arshdeep 32 *(20b, 2x4, 2x6)*, Quentin Sampson c Tilak b Nitish 21 *(15b, 1x4, 1x6)*, Keemo Paul c Tilak b Arshdeep 10 *(6b, 1x6)*, Shamar Springer (not out) 35 *(11b, 2x4, 4x6)*, Roston Chase (not out) 5 *(4b)*; Extras (b-1, lb-2, nb-1, w-7): 11; Total (for seven wkts. in 20 overs): 209.

FALL OF WICKETS
1-7 (Hope, 1.5), 2-67 (Hetmyer, 6.6), 3-82 (Powell, 9.4), 4-105 (Kamil, 10.6), 5-151 (Sampson, 15.3), 6-169 (Paul, 17.2), 7-174 (Rutherford, 17.5).

INDIA BOWLING
Mayank 4-0-34-0, Arshdeep 4-0-44-3, Prince 4-0-37-0, Dhir 3-0-39-2, Axar 3-0-33-1, Nitish 2-0-19-1.

Toss: WI; **PoM:** Arshdeep.
India won by 14 runs to lead five-match series 2-1.
Fourth T20I: October 14, Hyderabad, 7 p.m.

Cummins... roaring back. AFP

Bowlers hand Australia the advantage

Agence France-Presse
DURBAN

Steve Smith broke the Test record for the most career catches by a fielder as Australia played itself into a strong position on the third day of the first Test against South Africa at Kingsmead on Sunday.

Smith held four catches, taking his total to 223, as South Africa was bowled out for 284 in reply to Australia's first innings of 390. Nic Maddinson (17 not out) and Travis Head (10 not out) added 33 runs to stretch Australia's overall lead to 139 before bad light ended play.

Captain Pat Cummins took three for 54 and Mitchell Starc, Josh Hazlewood and Nathan Lyon claimed two wickets each as the bowling quartet combined with efficiency. Six batters reached 30 but David Bedingham's 49 was the top score.

The scores: Australia 390 & 33/0 in 5.4 overs vs. South Africa 284 in 78 overs (Bedingham 49).

Archers too hot for Knights; Yodhas lord over Chiefs, Marathas pip Royals

APL

Anirudh Velamuri
HYDERABAD

Chero Archers registered a clean sweep against Kakatiya Knights in Sunday's opening clash of the Archery Premier League season 2 at People's Plaza. A third win in four matches pushed it to the top spot in the standings.

The first set was neck-and-neck before Elia Canales shot a 7 to give Archers the advantage. While Casey Kaufhold could only manage a 6, her team had enough in the bank to nose ahead.

Atanu Das led Archers' charge in the second set before the third turned into a thrilling one.

But once Atanu and Casey bagged 10s, there was no fight left in the Knights.

Gatha Anandrao Khadake came up with some clutch arrows under pressure to power Prithviraj Yodhas past Chola Chiefs 6-2.

Her 10 at the end of the third set was crucial as it gave her side a 77-76 scoreline before Chiefs faltered in the decider.

The final match of the day was a close affair. Kushal Dalal, picked ahead of Ojas Pravin Deotale, gave Rajputana Royals a good start while Mete Gazoz anchored it with a high-pressure 10.

Hogging the limelight: Atanu and Gatha were in their element and made it a special Sunday for their teams. SIDDHANT THAKUR

The contest panned into a keen battle between Gazoz and Dhiraj Bommadevara. The latter barely missed a beat in the second set as Mighty Marathas bounced back.

The teams shared the third set before the final one boiled down to a showdown between Mete Gazoz and Dhiraj.

While the latter got 8 with his final arrow, the former managed only 7, sending Marathas into ecstatic celebrations.

The scores: Kakatiya Knights lost to Chero Archers 0-6 (74-75, 72-75, 76-77); Prithviraj Yodhas bt Chola Chiefs 6-2 (74-72, 74-77, 77-76, 76-71); Rajputana Royals lost to Mighty Marathas 3-5 (77-73, 76-77, 76-76, 74-76).

Verstappen finally wins the Singapore GP

FORMULA ONE

Agence France-Presse
SINGAPORE

Max Verstappen won the Singapore Grand Prix for the first time in his career on Sunday to complete a perfect weekend where he also finished first in the sprint and was on pole for both races.

Red Bull's Verstappen finished 7.335 seconds ahead of Ferrari's Charles Leclerc with championship leader Kimi Antonelli third for Mercedes after 62 laps under the lights of the Marina Bay Street Circuit.

The four-time World champion had previously never won or even achieved a pole position in nine previous attempts going back to his debut for Toro Rosso in 2015.

"It has taken a while but I think this race was very good," said a delighted Verstappen, who was celebrating back-to-back wins after triumphing in Malaysia seven days ago, his first victory of 2026. "We had pace when we needed to have it on the soft tyre and the medium. So of course very happy to win here."

The results: 1. Max Verstappen (Red Bull); 2. Charles Leclerc (Ferrari) +7.335s; 3. Kimi Antonelli (Mercedes) 24.573; 4. Lando Norris (McLaren) 40.506; 5. Oscar Piastri (McLaren) 49.644; 6. Lewis Hamilton (Ferrari) 53.188; 7. Liam Lawson (Racing Bulls) 1:21.666; 8. Nico Hulkenberg (Audi) 1:23.386; 9. George Russell (Mercedes) 1:24.677; 10. Isack Hadjar (Red Bull) 1:30.862. **+1 Lap:** 11. Pierre Gasly (Alpine); 12. Oliver Bearman (Haas); 13. Esteban Ocon (Haas); 14. Carlos Sainz (Williams); 15. Arvid Lindblad (Racing Bulls); 16. Fernando Alonso (Aston Martin). **+2 laps:** 17. Sergio Perez (Cadillac). **+3 laps:** 18. Valtteri Bottas (Cadillac). **DNF:** Lance Stroll (Aston Martin), Franco Colapinto (Alpine), Gabriel Bortoleto (Audi), Alexander Albon (Williams).

Standings: Drivers: 1. Antonelli 340; 2. Russell 238; 3. Hamilton 229; 4. Verstappen 221; 5. Leclerc 215.

Constructors: 1. Mercedes 578; 2. Ferrari 444; 3. McLaren 339; 4. Red Bull 332; 5. Racing Bulls 100.

Long time coming: Verstappen tasted success at the Marina Bay Street circuit on his 10th attempt. AFP

Haaland. AP

City routs Liverpool

Agence France-Presse
LIVERPOOL

Manchester City shrugged off the threat of swingeing sanctions to beat 10-man Liverpool 3-0 in its first game since being found guilty on more than 100 charges of breaking Premier League financial rules.

Japan forward Keisuke Goto's late header fired ten-man Freiburg over Bayern Munich and Borussia Dortmund to the top of the Bundesliga with a 2-1 win over Schalke on Sunday.

The results: Premier League: Crystal Palace 3 (Kamada 41, Lerma 45+4, Pino 59) bt Nottingham Forest 1 (Ndoye 3); Hull 2 (Gelhardt 48, Belloumi 74) drew with Everton 2 (Dewsbury-Hall 55, Barry 68); Liverpool 0 lost to Manchester City 3 (Haaland 65, Doku 68, Cherki 78). **Serie A:** Como 0 drew with Roma 0; Lazio 3 (Tavares 3, Isaksen 23, Pinamonti 88) bt Monza 1 (Goglichidze 46); Lecce 1 (Fatah 64) lost to Bologna 2 (Orsolini 17, Enem 75).
On Saturday: LaLiga: Real Madrid 1 (Diomande 63) bt Villarreal 0. **Serie A:** Napoli 3 (De Bruyne 29-pen, 90+4, Lang 32) bt Frosinone 0.

INBRIEF

India U-17 women enter Asian Cup second time running

The Indian Under-17 women's football team qualified for the AFC U-17 Women's Asian Cup 2027 to be held in China after beating Malaysia 4-0 at Selayang on Sunday. India will take part in the continental competition for the second consecutive time after reaching the quarterfinals in its latest appearance earlier this year.

The result: Malaysia 0 lost to India 4 (Redima Devi 30, Pritika Barman 51, Anushka Kumari 57, Nidhi Pawan Kumar 87).

Arunachal forfeits its Ranji game against Nagaland

A Ranji Trophy match was forfeited for the first time in 17 years after Arunachal Pradesh failed to field a team for its Plate Group fixture against Nagaland in Ahmedabad on Sunday due to a legal tussle within its cricket association. The BCCI had informed the stakeholders that the fixture would not take place. There's uncertainty over Arunachal's next match, against Sikkim, given the legal impasse.

Allen, Ferguson, Seifert back in NZ squad for India ODIs

Rachin Ravindra and Mark Chapman were on Sunday named in New Zealand's squad for its home one-day series against India after injury sidelined the batting pair from the preceding Twenty20 clashes.

The squad: First three ODIs: Mitchell Santner (Capt.), Michael Bracewell, Mark Chapman, Devon Conway, Jacob Duffy, Matt Henry, Kyle Jamieson, Tom Latham (wk), Daryl Mitchell, Glenn Phillips, Rachin Ravindra, Nathan Smith, Will Young, and Blair Tickner.

Last two ODIs: Santner (Capt.), Finn Allen, Michael Bracewell, Chapman, Kristian Clarke, Duffy, Matt Fisher, Lockie Ferguson, Mitch Hay (wk), Nick Kelly, Tim Seifert (wk), Tickner, and Will Young.

The schedule: Nov. 4 (Auckland), Nov. 7 (Wellington), Nov. 10 (Hamilton), Nov. 13 and 15 (both Mount Maunganui).

Udhayveer claims 10m air pistol gold at Cairo ISSF WC

India's Udhayveer Sidhu shot his way to a gold medal in the men's 10m air pistol event at the ISSF World Cup Rifle/Pistol in Cairo on Sunday. The 24-year-old shot a total of 240.6 in the final to finish ahead of Germany's Christian Reitz (240.1) and Italy's Paolo Monna (219.8). The other Indian in the fray, Jonathan Gavin Antony, finished second in qualification but was competing for ranking points only.

Italy's Bezzecchi wins MotoGP Grand Prix in Indonesia

Marco Bezzecchi stormed to victory in Indonesia on Sunday as Jorge Martin was third to retake the lead from Marc Marquez in the Indonesian MotoGP world championship.

Smriti named UNICEF India celebrity advocate

Smriti Mandhana has been named a celebrity advocate by UNICEF India, with the organisation seeking to leverage her influence to promote equal opportunities, health and well-being for adolescent girls. The announcement was made on Sunday to mark the International Day of the Girl, which draws attention to girls' rights, safety, leadership and potential, while highlighting the barriers that continue to restrict their choices. In her new role, Smriti will build on her previous association with initiatives promoting equal rights and opportunities for children and young people, and advocate for an environment in which girls can participate in sports and realise their potential.

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricket: TNCA U-14 round-robin tournament, Tamil Nadu-I vs Tamil Nadu-II (Tagore); Tamil Nadu-III vs Tamil Nadu-IV (Wahe Guru-A), 9.30 a.m.

Karan returns to Ranji Trophy in style, puts Rajasthan in control against TN

His stand with debutant Rohan, who missed out on a three-figure score by a whisker, keeps the visitors at bay; Saravana Kumar scalps three

CRICKET

S. Prasanna Venkatesan
JAIPUR

If Samuel Beckett's Waiting for Godot was a meditation on hope deferred, the opening day of the Elite Group-D Ranji Trophy match between Tamil Nadu and Rajasthan at the Sawai Mansingh Stadium here on Sunday was a story of opportunities seized when they finally arrived.

Karan Lamba struck an unbeaten 103 (135b, 11x4, 1x6) on his return to the Ranji Trophy after two years, debutant Rohan Rajbhar fell five runs short of a hundred (95, 220b, 13x4, 1x6), and Sumit Godara, drafted into the XI after Mukul Choudhary sustained an injury during the pre-match warm-up, made 49 as Rajasthan reached 286 for four.

Tamil Nadu pacer P. Saravana Kumar, playing only his third Ranji match at 37, returned his best figures of three for 52.

On the go: Karan took the attack to the Tamil Nadu bowlers while making an unbeaten hundred. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Karan's knock had a distinctly attacking streak.

He struck three successive boundaries off debutant D. Deepesh - a square drive, a pull to long-on, and a cut - before charging Sai Kishore and lofting him over long-off for six to bring up his fifty off 45 balls. He completed his hundred off 133 balls with a back-foot square drive for four against Saravana Kumar.

Meanwhile, for 219 balls, Rohan negotiated the demands of First Class cricket with the composure of someone who had been there before. But with a maiden hundred beckoning tantalisingly, he gloved Saravana Kumar through to the 'keeper, walking off the field reluctantly.

Though his innings was restrained, there were moments of adventure.

Rohan stepped out to loft Sai Kishore over long-on for six, then charged him again two balls later to drive straight for four. He also brought out the sweep for a four off the left-arm spinner.

He was dropped on 80 when Sai Sudharsan put down an edge at first slip off medium-pacer Nidhish Rajagopal.

Rohan added 104 runs for the second wicket with Sumit and 125 for the third with Karan.

Tamil Nadu suffered a potential setback when all-rounder Sonu Yadav hobbled off after going down at backward point while attempting to stop a cut from Mahipal Lomror.

The scores:

Rajasthan — 1st innings: Sachin Yadav lbw b Saravana Kumar 1, Rohan Rajbhar c Jagadeesan b Saravana Kumar 95, Sumit Godara c Jagadeesan b Saravana Kumar 49, Karan Lamba (batting) 103, Kartik Sharma c Deepesh b Washington 1, Mahipal Lomror (batting) 31; Extras (lb-1, w-5): 6; Total (for four wkts. in 85 overs): 289.

Fall of wickets: 1-1, 2-105, 3-230, 4-231.

Tamil Nadu bowling: Deepesh 13-3-54-0, Saravana Kumar 19-4-52-3, Sonu Yadav 16-3-38-0, Sai Kishore 12-0-57-0, Nidhish 9-2-35-0, Washington 16-2-49-1.

Toss: Rajasthan.

Focus on consistency helped me make a comeback, says Karan

S. Prasanna Venkatesan
JAIPUR

Karan Lamba, who announced himself with an unbeaten century on his Ranji Trophy debut in 2023, last played for Rajasthan in the competition in February 2024. He marked his return to the side with an unbeaten 103 against Tamil Nadu here on Sunday.

Patience pays

The 21-year-old said he continued to focus on his performances in the u-23 circuit during his two-year absence from the Ranji side, knowing that an opportunity could come at any time.

"I focused on my game and tried to perform as consistently as possible in u-23 cricket. You never know when selectors might pick you, so I never took any match lightly. The only thing was that the u-23 matches do not get as much live coverage, so you are not always in the limelight. But I believe that if you perform well, the selectors keep an eye on you, irrespective of the level you play at," he said.

Piling on the runs

Karan was Rajasthan's highest run-getter in the Vijay Hazare Trophy last season.

He said it gave him the confidence that a Ranji opportunity would follow. "I felt I had established my place and felt I would get an opportunity the following season. That allowed me to focus on how I could take my game to the next level," he said.

Converting the start

Karan said he was determined to make the most of a good batting surface and convert his start into a substantial score. "The wicket was very good (for batting), and you rarely get such flat tracks. I wanted to make the most of the opportunity and bat for as long as possible," he said.

RANJI SCORES — ROUND ONE, DAY ONE

Elite: Group A: At Rajgir: Uttar Pradesh 287/3 in 84 overs (Madhav Kaushik 124 batting, Rinku Singh 109 batting) vs. Bihar. **Toss:** Bihar.

At Panaji: Baroda 204/3 in 85 overs (Shivalik Sharma 62, Shashwat Rawat 40 batting) vs. Goa. **Toss:** Baroda.

At Srinagar: Madhya Pradesh 196 in 74.2 overs (Shubham Sharma 79, Sunil Kumar 4/69, Rohit Sharma 5/36) vs. Jammu & Kashmir 3/1 in three overs. **Toss:** J & K.

At Nagpur: Vidarbha 300/5 in 85 overs (Yash Rathod 131 batting, Akshay Wadkar 112 batting) vs. Pondicherry. **Toss:** Vidarbha.

Group B: At Hyderabad: Tripura 134 in 44 overs (Bikramkumar Das 50, Aniketh Reddy 5/21) vs. Hyderabad 121/4 in 41 overs (Tanmay Agarwal 48 batting, Sandip Sarkar 4/44). **Toss:** Tripura.

At Vijayawada: Karnataka 274 in 82.2 overs (R. Smaran 126, K.L. Shrijith 58) vs. Andhra 16/2 in five overs. **Toss:** Karnataka.

At New Chandigarh: Assam 68/3 in 23 overs vs. Punjab. **Toss:** Punjab.

At Rajkot: Saurashtra 308/4 in 90 overs (Chirag Jani 83, Ravindra Jadeja 72 batting, Prerak Mankad 92 batting) vs. Chhattisgarh. **Toss:** Chhattisgarh.

Group C: At Jamshedpur: Jharkhand 289/5 in 90 overs (Shikhar Mohan 143, Utkarsh Singh 71) vs. Kerala. **Toss:** Jharkhand.

At Kalyani: Delhi 240 in 77.3 overs (Ayush Doseja 45, Hrithik Shokeen 56, Mohammed Shami 4/30) vs. Bengal. **Toss:** Bengal.

At Ahmedabad: Odisha 272/3 in 90 overs (Gourav Choudhary 121 batting, Sandeep Pattnaik 69 batting) vs. Gujarat. **Toss:** Odisha.

At New Delhi: Maharashtra 287/5 in 90 overs (Prithvi Shaw 70, Ankit Bawne 105 batting) vs. Services. **Toss:** Maharashtra.

Group D: At Lahli: Himachal Pradesh 153/7 in 77 overs (Akash Vasisht 49 batting, Anshul Kamboj 4/32) vs. Haryana. **Toss:** HP.

At Mumbai (Brabourne Stadium): Railways 278 in 87.5 overs (Vivek Singh 112, Devendra Bora 5/49) vs. Uttarakhand. **Toss:** Uttarakhand.

At Jaipur: Rajasthan 286/4 in 85 overs (Rohan Rajbhar 95, Sumit Godara 49, Karan Lamba 103 batting) vs. Tamil Nadu. **Toss:** Rajasthan.

At Mumbai (Wankhede Stadium): Mumbai 249/5 in 84 overs (Ayush Mhatre 48, Musheer Khan 65, Siddesh Lad 80 batting) vs. Chandigarh. **Toss:** Chandigarh.

Plate: At Rangpo: Sikkim 245 in 80.5 overs (Satyajeet Bachhav 45, Ram Gurung 5/32) vs. Meghalaya 2/0 in one over. **Toss:** Meghalaya.

At Nadiad: Mizoram 183 in 62.3 overs (Kishan Singha 6/52) vs. Manipur 39/4 in 26 overs. **Toss:** Mizoram.

Blasters blank Kashi, begin with a bang

ISL

Press Trust of India
PUNE

Vibin Mohanan and Andre Green struck a goal each to help Kerala Blasters FC begin its Indian Super League (ISL) campaign with a 2-0 victory over Inter Kashi at the Shree Shiv Chhatrapati Sports Complex in Balewadi here on Sunday.

Vibin opened the scoring in the 18th minute before Green struck in stoppage time to seal three points for Blasters.

The visitors started aggressively, with Freddy Lallawmawma firing from distance as early as the fifth minute.The breakthrough came when Korou Singh provided the assist to Vibin, who finished with a right-footer from the centre of the box.

Blasters sealed the deal in the fourth minute of stoppage time when Mohammed Sanan set up Green, who made no mistake.

The results: At Pune: Inter Kashi 0 lost to Kerala Blasters 2 (Vibin Mohanan 18, Andre Green 90+4).

At Margao: Churchill Brothers 2 (Gaurav Bora 57, Sebastian Guiterrez 86) bt Mumbai City FC 1 (Sergio Llamas 90+5-pen).

Secret Saint for the Taj Mahal Plate

HYDERABAD: The five-year-old gelding Secret Saint may score over his rivals in the Taj Mahal Plate, the chief event of Monday's (Oct. 12) races.

1 NIRMAL PLATE (DIV. II) (1,200m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 12.40 p.m.: 1. Shooting Star (3) Deepak S 60, 2. American Affair (1) Ashad Asbar 56.5, 3. Windsor (9) Surya Prakash 53, 4. Goddess Of Light (8) Gaurav 52.5, 5. Magical Touch (7) Afroz K 51, 6. Star Councillor (11) D.S. Deora 51, 7. Taaliyah (5) Uday Kiran 51, 8. Celestial (10) Kuldeep Jr. 50.5, 9. Sugriva (2) B. Nikhil 50.5, 10. Svalpaviryasaktih (4) Santosh Raj 50.5 and 11. Silver Lining (6) Arjun 50.
1. SHOOTING STAR, 2. STAR COUNCILLOR, 3. GODDESS OF LIGHT

2 NAWAB MEHDI JUNG BAHADUR MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. II) (1,100m), 5-y-o and upward, rated 40 to 65 (Cat. II), no whip, 1.10: 1. Detective (4) Rajpratap S 62.5, 2. Shadow Fax (3) Surendra S 61, 3. Arthisha (1) D.S. Deora 58.5, 4. Clara (8) Arjun S 57.5, 5. Flying Fury (2) G. Naresh 557, 6. Vital Sign (5) Vikram S 56.5, 7. Crimson Flame (6) Surya Prakash 54 and 8. Shah Of Iran (7) Uday Kiran 52.5.
1. FLYING FURY, 2. SHADOW FAX, 3. ARTHISHA

3 SADDLE UP PLATE (2,000m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 1.40: 1. Hoping High (2) Mohit S 60, 2. Hoping Star (6) Sohan K 59, 3. Aakarshaka (5) Md. Ismail 56, 4. Concordia (3) B.R. Kumar 55.5, 5. Vidyutprabhava (4) Santosh Raj 54.5 and 6. Vespucci (1) Arjun 54.
1. HOPING STAR, 2. AAKARSHAKA

4 NAWAB MEHDI JUNG BAHADUR MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. I) (1,100m), 5-y-o and upward, rated 40 to 65 (Cat. II), no whip, 2.10: 1. Dali's Destiny (5) Gaurav S 62.5, 2. Romantic Grey (2) Surendra S 62.5, 3. Leather Back (4) Raique Sk. 60, 4. Kalki (9) Surya Prakash 58.5, 5. Shoolin (6) D.S. Deora 57.5, 6. Bold Beauty (7) Bhawani S 56.5, 7. Petra Act (1) B. Nikhil 53, 8. Sunny Day (3) V.S. Shekhawat 52.5 and 9. Juramento (8) Uday Kiran 50.
1. SHOOLIN, 2. ROMANTIC GREY, 3. LEATHER BACK

5 NIZAMABAD PLATE (1,100m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 2.45: 1. Trust Me (12) G. Naresh 60, 2. Marissa (7) Sonu K 57.5, 3. N R I Crypto Power (4) Trevor 57.5, 4. Divine Ascend (5) Mukesh K 55, 5. Farsiris (3) Kuldeep Jr. 55, 6. Costa Mesa (1) P. Sai K 54, 7. Barbarossa (8) Ajay K 53.5, 8. Miri (10) Arjun 53.5, 9. Miss Lovely Angel (2) Gaurav S 53.5, 10. Lego (9) Kuldeep Sr. 53, 11. Nkalanzinzi (6) B. Nikhil 52.5 and 12. Santorini Sky (11) D.S. Deora 52.5.
1. N R I CRYPTO POWER, 2. FARSIRIS, 3. COSTA MESA

6 MIRZA ZUNNUR AHMED MEMORIAL CUP (1,400m), 4-y-o and upward, rated 40 to 65 (Cat. II), 3.20: 1. Pole Star (8) Trevor 62.5, 2. Greif (9) Swarup S 62, 3. Miss Smiley Angel (6) Sonu K 62, 4. Prince Of Wales (10) Mukesh K 61.5, 5. Mystical Dawn (3) V.S. Shekhawat 60.5, 6. N R I Ultrapower (7) Deepak S 60.5, 7. Divine Secret (5) Vikram S 56, 8. Lifes Journey (1) Gaurav S 55.5, 9. Federer (4) Arjun 55 and 10. Surrealist (2) Ajay K 50.
1. POLE STAR, 2. MYSTICAL DAWN, 3. PRINCE OF WALES

7 WWW.HYDRACES.COM TROPHY (1,200m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 40 to 65 (Cat. II), 3.55: 1. Dontblockmyway (2) Sonu K 60, 2. Catchme If You Can (4) B. Nikhil 58, 3. Rival (7) Kuldeep Sr. 58, 4. Yali (5) Trevor 58, 5. La Quinta (1) P. Sai K 57.5, 6. Mix The Magic (3) Mukesh K 57.5, 7. French Lieutenant (6) Kuldeep Jr. 56.5 and 8. Her Ladyship (8) Afroz K 55.5.
1. CATCHME IF YOU CAN, 2. LA QUINTA, 3. YALI

8 TAJ MAHAL PLATE (1,600m), 5-y-o and upward, rated 60 to 85, (Cat. II), 4.30: 1. Vivaldo (10) Bhawani S 60, 2. Celestial (5) M.S. Deora 57.5, 3. Silver Act (6) Mukesh K 56.5, 4. Victoria Doresaani (2) B.R. Kumar 56, 5. Secret Saint (3) Trevor 54.5, 6. Glorious Power (4) Md. Ismail 53.5, 7. Shadow Of The Moon (1) Rafique Sk. 52, 8. Tiger Ruby (9) Surya Prakash 52, 9. Dapper Look (11) Gaurav S 51.5, 10. Lucky Zone (7) Kuldeep Jr. 51.5, 11. Noble Heart (8) Afroz K 51.5 and 12. Krystallos (12) P. Sai K 50.5.
1. SECRET SAINT, 2. GLORIOUS POWER, 3. LUCKY ZONE

9 NIRMAL PLATE (DIV. I) (1,200m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45, (Cat. III), 5.05: 1. Double Bubble (9) Mukesh K 60, 2. Suryavanshi (6) Surya Prakash 58.5, 3. Nyanza (4) Uday Kiran 53.5, 4. Anemara (10) B.R. Kumar 52.5, 5. Ashwa Vivegam (11) Gaurav S 51.5, 6. Dhanadeepa (7) B. Nikhil 51.5, 7. Queen Dali (8) Ashad Asbar 51.5, 8. Aloy (1) Arjun 50.5, 9. Anemoi (2) Kuldeep Jr. 50.5, 10. My Day (5) M.S. Deora 50.5 and 11. Veera's Lakshmi (3) Ajay K 50.5.
1. DOUBLE BUBBLE, 2. ANEMARA, 3. QUEEN DALI

Day's Best: N R I CRYPTO POWER
Jackpot: (i) 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 & 5, (ii) 5, 6, 7, 8 & 9.
Mini Jackpot: (i) 3, 4, 5 & 6, (ii) 6, 7, 8 & 9.
Treble: (i) 2, 3 & 4, (ii) 4, 5 & 6. (iii) 7, 8 & 9.
Tanala: All races.

LIVE TELECAST

Ranji Trophy: day 2, JioHotstar, 9 a.m.
Afghanistan vs Bangladesh: One-off Test, day 4, FanCode, 11 a.m.
South Africa vs Australia: First Test, day 4, Eurosport & FanCode, 1 p.m.
ISL: Sony LIV, App 7.30 p.m.
Premier League: SS Select 1 & JioHotstar, 12.30 a.m. (Tuesday)
Serie A: Unite8 Sports 1, 2 & Z5 App, 12.15 a.m. (Tuesday)
LaLiga: FanCode, 12.30 a.m. (Tuesday)

Memorable day for Gutte and Ishaan

Great finish: Ishaan, winner of Race 3 in the Formula 2000 class.

MOTORSPORTS

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

Mumbai's Krishay Gutte and Ishaan Madesh of Bengaluru won a race apiece in the premier MRF Formula 2000 class as the third round of the MRF National Racing Challenge 4W concluded at the Madras International Circuit on Sunday.

The results (provisional, all 10 laps unless mentioned):

MRF Formula 2000 (Race-2): 1. Krishay Gutte (Mumbai) 16m 05.519s; 2. Ishaan Madesh (Bengaluru) 16:08.403; 3. Saishiva Sankaran (Pune) 16:10.092.

Race-3 (8 laps): 1. Ishaan (12:48.891); 2. Saishiva (12:52.037); 3. Gutte (12:58.348).

MRF Formula 1600 (Race-2): 1. Shivansh Bejoy (New Delhi) 17:29.757; 2. Evan Shrawan (Mumbai) 17:50.229; 3. S. Gyan (Chennai) 17:50.374. **Race-3 (8 laps)**: 1. Gyan (14:09.009); 2. Bhuvan Bonu (Visakhapatnam) 14:13.738; 3. Shivansh (New Delhi) 14:14.674.

Formula LGB 1300 (Race-2, Open): 1. Viswas Vijayaraj (Nellore, DTS Racing) 18:53.100; 2. T.S. Diljith (Thrissur, DTS Racing) 18:53.550; 3. Liron Jaden Samuels (Tirunelveli, DTS Racing) 19:20.125. **Race-3 (8 laps):** 1. Viswas (Nellore, DTS Racing) 16:07.296; 2. Vinithkumar (Tirupur, DTS Racing) 16:07.838; 3. Diljith (Thrissur, DTS Racing) 16:08.063.

Junior (Race-2): 1. Augustine Boby (Greater Noida, DTS Racing) 19:07.657; 2. Kaveen Rajapaksa (Colombo, Momentum Motorsports) 19:09.751; 3. Neythan McPherson (Pune, Delta Speeds) 19:21.053.

Race-3 (8 laps): 1. Augustine (Greater Noida, DTS Racing) 16:10.519; 2. Shatveer Shetty (Bengaluru, Meco Racing) 16:11.894; 3. Kaveen Rajapaksa (Colombo, Momentum Motorsports) 16:18.355.

Super Stock (Race-2): 1. T.S. Diljith (Thrissur) 20:53.561; 2. Lal Kattikulam Bharathan (Thrissur) 20:54.722; 3. Deepa S. John (Thiruvananthapuram) 20:57.362.

MRF Saloons (Race-2): 1. Alisha Abdulla (Chennai) 21:36.180; 2. Aakash Vivek (Chennai) 21:36.592; 3. R. Hemachandran (Puducherry) 21:40.599. **Race-3 (8 laps):** 1. Aakash (Chennai) 17:07.238; 2. Qian Jun Kek (Kuala Lumpur) 17:21.821; 3. Alisha (17:22.071).

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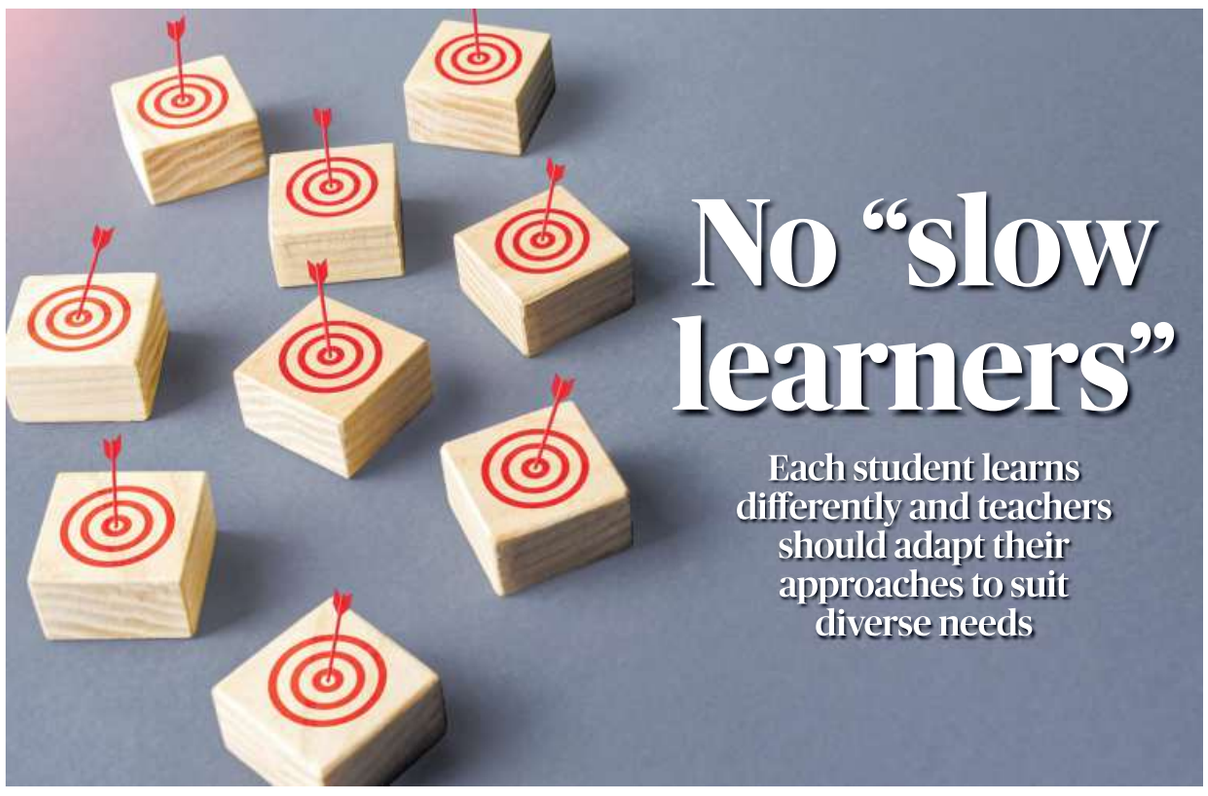

GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

No "slow learners"

Each student learns differently and teachers should adapt their approaches to suit diverse needs

"You are a slow learner. Your performance in class tests is not good. Maths and you can never be friends." Several years ago, a friend shared that this is what a teacher had said to his daughter after she had performed poorly in a class test and how deeply the remark had affected her.

Imagine that someone labelled a "slow learner" as a student later became a great scientist and won a Nobel Prize. What would we conclude?

Would we blame the teacher for wrongly judging the student? Would we blame an education system that failed to recognise the student's abilities? Or would we accept that school performance does not necessarily determine a person's future and that every individual has the potential to excel?

Damaging label

History offers examples of individuals whose early academic performance was far from impressive but who later achieved remarkable success. Albert Einstein, Mahatma Gandhi, Winston Churchill, Walt Disney, and Richard Branson are often cited in this context.

What might have happened if they had been labelled "slow learners" and discouraged by their teachers? Their potential might have been overlooked and their achievements might never have been realised.

The term "slow learner" can, therefore, be a damaging label because it may cause teachers to underestimate a student's potential. Students do not learn at the same pace or in the same way. They come from different backgrounds and have different abilities, interests, prior knowledge, strengths, and levels of readiness. Recognising these differences is essential for effective teaching and learning.

Yet many classrooms continue to rely on a one-size-fits-all approach. Instead of expecting all students to adapt to a single teaching style, should teachers not also adapt their approaches to accommodate diverse learning needs?

Where is the problem?

During the past two decades, as a teacher trainer and educator, I have often been asked how teachers should deal with "slow learners". When I ask what they mean by the term, teachers usually describe students who take longer than others to understand certain concepts or who perform poorly academically.

I then ask: Have you tried to understand why these students take longer to grasp certain concepts? Have you explained the concepts in different ways? Could another teaching approach help them understand more easily? Finally, if someone called you or your child a "slow learner," how would you feel?

These questions often encourage teachers to look beyond the label and consider whether the difficulty lies entirely with the learner. Sometimes, the real problem may be a mismatch between how something is taught and the way a student is able to understand it.

The term "slow learner" is often a misnomer because it creates the impression that some students are inherently less capable of learning than others. In reality, students differ in how they process information, understand concepts, retain knowledge, and demonstrate what they have learned.

When a teacher's expectations about how students should learn do not produce the expected results, they are labelled "slow". Once attached, the label can influence a teacher's expectations and affect the student's confidence, participation, motivation, and performance.

Teachers' role

Students may benefit from different ways of learning: visual representations, discussion, demonstrations, practical activities, reading, writing, repetition, or learning through experience. The important point is to recognise differences among learners and provide multiple pathways to understanding.

The teacher's role, therefore, is not merely to identify who is 'fast' or 'slow'. It is to identify barriers to learning, vary instructional approaches, provide appropriate support, and create opportunities for every student to succeed.

Instead of asking "Why is this student a slow learner?", educators might ask a more productive question: "What is preventing this student from learning effectively, and how can I change my approach to help the student learn?" This moves the focus from labelling the learner to improving the learning environment.

A student who struggles in a conventional classroom may possess talents that examinations fail to reveal.

Therefore, rather than labelling students as "slow learners", educators should recognise individual differences, identify strengths, remove barriers to learning, and provide every student with opportunities to discover and develop their potential.

Perhaps, then, the more important question is not "Who is a slow learner?" but "Are we being flexible enough as teachers to help every learner learn?"

The writer is an ELT resource person and education columnist. Email rayanal@yahoo.co.uk

SCHOLARSHIPS

Infocepts Innovate for Impact Scholarship
An initiative of Infocepts Foundation.
Eligibility: Open to students studying or domiciled in Nagpur, Pune, Chennai, or Bengaluru who are in UG programmes in Computer Engineering, IT, AI, ML, or Data Science, scored 60% in Classes 10 and 12, and have an annual family income not exceeding ₹600,000.
Rewards: Up to ₹50,000 / year for four years.
Application: Online
Deadline: October 30
www.b4s.in/tndy/INFO3

Aditya Birla Capital Scholarship
Instituted by the Aditya Birla Capital Foundation.
Eligibility: Open to meritorious girl students in Classes 9 to 12 or in Polytechnic Diploma, UG, or PG courses at recognised government institutions across India with minimum 60% in the most recent academic year and have an annual parental income not exceeding ₹600,000.
Rewards: Up to ₹60,000.
Application: Online
Deadline: October 30
www.b4s.in/tndy/ABCC18

Ujjivan Small Finance Bank Transgender Scholarship
An initiative of Ujjivan Small Finance Bank Limited, implemented through Buddy4Study.
Eligibility: Open to transgender students pursuing secondary, senior secondary, or UG/PG studies through a government or private institution across India, who have scored minimum 35% in Class 10 and 12 and have an annual income not exceeding ₹1,000,000 a year.
Rewards: Up to ₹40,000 (one time)
Application: Online
Deadline: October 30
www.b4s.in/tndy/USFB2

Courtesy: Buddy4study.com

Reimagine Ideathon 2.0

The Central Depository Services (India) Limited (CDSL) has launched Reimagine Ideathon 2.0, an initiative that invites students to develop innovative solutions to strengthen financial awareness and cyber safety.

Eligibility: Students who have completed Class 12 and 18 years at time of registration and are currently enrolled in accredited Indian institutions. Team must have four students and one faculty mentor.
Deadline to register: October 30
For more details, visit https://ideathon.cdslindia.com/

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INTERVIEW

Pranavi Urs

My Olympics preparation is not going to change much

The golfer says the experience in Hangzhou helped her in Aichi-Nagoya where she won the individual gold and the team silver; feels that she benefitted by playing on the Ladies European Tour

Nihit Sachdeva

Lakshman Singh in 1982 (New Delhi). Shiv Kapur in 2002 (Busan). Pranavi Urs in 2026 (Aichi-Nagoya).

For only the third time in history, an Indian golfer won the individual gold at the Asian Games but this one was a bit more special - no Indian woman had achieved this before the 23-year-old from Karnataka. The journey to the top step of the podium had its ups and downs but Pranavi stayed strong, patient and eventually finished the job.

In a media interaction facilitated by the Sports Authority of India, Pranavi shares snippets from the dramatic final day in Japan and how a certain Rory McIlroy played a role in her victory, what this gold means for women's golf in India, and the way forward:-

What does being the first Indian woman golfer to win an individual Asian Games gold medal mean to you?

I'll always be the first. There are going to be multiple winners after me but I'm the one who set that record. For me, that means the world.

What is the next first that you want to chase after this?

Either to win a Major or an Olympic medal.

Can you recap the final hole?

When I hit that tee shot, I knew I hit it well and I was going to cover the water. It's a difficult hole. When Shannon (Singapore's Shannon Tan, the bronze medallist) was in the bunker, with that pin position, she wasn't going to hit it close. And Ruoning (China's Ruoning Yin, the silver medallist) also couldn't hit the shot because she had a long iron in.

With my distance, I had an advantage. I just had to keep the ball in play after the second shot. And at the time, I also didn't know I was going to win. I thought making par would force a playoff. Little did I know that the last putt that I hit was a putt to win.

You didn't know that you were putting for the win?

No, I didn't. I was, perhaps, too zoned in and I had one of Shannon's scores wrong on my scorecard because I was marking hers. I thought I needed to putt. Maybe, there's a playoff and I'll still have a medal chance. I didn't know and that's why I didn't celebrate after I won. I wish I had known.

If you could go back in time and you knew that the final putt would win you the gold medal, how would you celebrate?

I don't know because I haven't really thought about it. I've played so many different victory celebrations of mine in my head. I don't know which one I was going to do. Maybe just a fist bump. It was so surreal that that happened and I didn't know.

What went wrong when you had a triple bogey early in the final round?

I just got unlucky. It wasn't even a bad shot. I just started a bit right and ended up in the bunker. Normally, if it's a plugged ball, you still have a chance but I didn't really have one. Then, I hit the shot and it came back in my divot, which was deeper. I hit my shot again and it returned to the same spot. So, I was helpless. Now, looking back at it, I wish I had taken an unplayable and things could have maybe played out a bit different but I've still got the medal, so I'm not complaining.

How did you mentally bounce back from the triple bogey?

I've been working with my psychologist for years now. At the end of the day, the goal is to keep calm when you're nervous, stick to your game plan, don't think about anything else and just focus on what you need to do and what's in your control more than the outcome. On the fourth hole, she (Yin) went one shot ahead and I'm someone who loves chasing. I thought, "You've got nothing to lose. You've hit rock bottom now. The worst thing has already happened."

I just stayed patient.

Did the experience of Hangzhou help in the final stages in Aichi-Nagoya?

Yes. I knew what to expect this time and how it really works. Being in a team event as well, I knew what I was stepping into whereas in China, it was my first time playing and representing the country. I was not as experienced three years ago. Since China, I've secured my card on the LET (Ladies European Tour). I've played in a lot of different conditions. I've put myself in a lot of different positions. I've also put myself in positions where I was in Japan. So, that experience helped me calm my nerves a little bit.

When you said that you were so zoned in that you didn't know you were about to win, is it a good thing or is it a bad thing to be so locked in?

If I'm getting a gold, then it's definitely good. Maybe for my social media, it isn't because I didn't celebrate. So, I don't have a lot of pictures of me celebrating. But jokes apart, it's good as it shows how much you were invested in the game on that particular day, regardless of what happened or under the circumstances I was in. When we were on the 18th green, they called out our names before we could putt, saying we're so-and-so (positions). I don't remember that at all.

How significant is this gold when you look at the growth of women's golf, especially in India?

The greatest joy and pride that I have is to give back to the sport because the sport has given me everything.

It's given more than I could have asked for. If I could win a medal and grow the sport in India, that means the world to me. Not just people in bigger cities but even in villages and smaller towns, if they can see what I did and somehow pick up a club, enjoy the sport or even get to know about the sport, that's still growth.

You've played a lot on the LET tour and a few events on the LPGA as well. Going forward, what do you think you need to do to be a more permanent member on the LPGA tour?

There are certain stats that I need to work on. My coach (Steven Giuliano) and I have been working towards that.

And that's why I feel like my game has also improved so much from the first half of the season. I'm going to continue to do that.

Aditi Ashok's fourth-place finish at the Tokyo Olympics changed a lot of things for golf in India. Do you feel that you actually winning gold, albeit in a different competition, is a seminal moment in women's golf in India?

What Aditi did in Tokyo was unreal and that's when golf in India became popular. I would give all the credits to her. People are comparing me with Aditi and I don't think I'm as good as her. She's still way above me and she's my senior. What she's done for the sport, I wish and hope to do as much. She's also a silver medallist at the Asian Games in China.

What kind of decisions were the most important and challenging for you in Japan? Also, how does this gold change your preparation for the Olympics?

The thing that I did on the last hole, if you saw the video, I changed my club on my second shot after I hit the drive. I had a 6-iron but then, I said to my caddy that I'm feeling the adrenaline rush and I can't be hitting 6-iron because it's going to go over the green. I'm just going to hit a 7-iron

That was one of the moments where I thought this change might help me get the medal because I didn't know if it was gold or silver.

My preparation for the Olympics is not going to change much. I'm going to be playing a lot of events on the LET. The cutoff date is in June 2028.

How did you celebrate your win?

My parents were there with me. I don't think it hit all of us that I had won and we didn't know what was happening. They had a gazillion phone calls and texts so they were overwhelmed as well. And then, the next day we went shopping in Tokyo.

Do you also believe in the power of manifestation?

You can't just manifest and not do anything. You still have to work hard. Manifestation just shows that that's your dream and this is what you need to work towards. So, I wouldn't say you manifest and sit at home doing absolutely nothing.

If anything, you work harder because you've manifested that and that's what you want. I do believe in manifestation but that just gives me a goal to work towards.

How was your day prior to the final round?

The night before the final round, me and my psychologist spoke about different scenarios and what start I could have. For the first time, I was more aware of my breath work.

Normally, when we have sessions, I'm always goofing around. For the first time, I paid more attention to what she was saying because that's how nervous I was and that's how badly I wanted the gold. I had an advantage - a three-shot lead. I had to keep it all together as anything could happen. Till it's done, it's not done. While thinking about what I wanted to caption after winning, I was also thinking about things that could go wrong.

On the last hole, of course, you were focusing on yourself but you must have also seen that Yin had a lip out?

I played with her for two days and I don't think she made a single bogey in those two days and that's why she's world number six and former world number one. She's a Major champion but sometimes, if it's meant to be, it is, right? Nothing can stop you from winning. I think it'll just be it.

But at the same time, I feel like the way I handled my situation, coming down the stretch, I holed a few important putts, which she went on to miss after me. So, I had to put that pressure on her which I did.

Who is your favourite golfer?

Rory McIlroy.

After the third hole, he was one of the people I thought about. It was pretty random. But I thought if he can win the Masters (in 2025) after having a terrible start, so can I (win the gold). That's one way that got me motivated towards the round as well.

Are you thinking of going to Delhi during the DP World India championship and trying to meet McIlroy and have a moment with him if possible?

Absolutely. My partner (Karandeep Singh Kochhar) is also a golfer. So, he's playing that event. I'm going to go watch him play anyway. I've asked my sources a little bit to get me to meet him (McIlroy). Hopefully that happens. And if that happens, I think I'm going to be more nervous meeting him than winning the gold.

> The greatest joy and pride that I have is to give back to the sport because the sport has given me everything. It's given more than I could have asked for. If I could win a medal and grow the sport in India, that means the world to me

> What Aditi did in Tokyo was unreal and that's when golf in India became popular. I would give all the credits to her. People are comparing me with Aditi and I don't think I'm as good as her. She's still way above me and she's my senior

Global warming is turning sex reversal in frogs into extinction risk

Sex reversal is well documented in the animal kingdom, where an individual can begin life with one sex and later switch to another; but a warming planet is making these changes more frequent; in a population skewed towards one sex, individuals may run out of mates to reproduce with

Rupsy Khurana
BENGALURU

A 2017 photograph of an agile frog in the wild. As temperatures continue to give scientists are asking whether increased sex reversal could affect the long-term survival of amphibian populations. PETAR MILOŠEVIĆ (CC BY-SA)

THEGIST

In agile frogs as in mammals, the sex at birth is determined by chromosomes: two X chromosomes make a genetic female whereas an X and a Y make a genetic male

But excessive heat in the tadpole stage can override that genetic recipe and turn some genetically female tadpoles into physically normal and fertile male tadpoles

Researchers have found that sex-reversed male agile frogs in the wild sire fewer offspring — which are in turn more vulnerable to heat and infectious disease

These disadvantages could together speed up population declines as the planet keeps warming

Some fish can switch sex more than once over a lifetime. In lizards, genetically male hatchlings can be born looking and functioning as females. In some frogs, genetically female individuals can develop into fertile males.

This phenomenon is called sex reversal. It is well documented in the animal kingdom, from invertebrates to amphibians to birds, where an individual can begin life with one sex and later switch to another.

But a warming planet is making these changes more frequent and potentially more consequential for animals. In a population skewed towards one sex, individuals may run out of mates to reproduce with, slowing population growth, reducing genetic diversity, and ultimately raising the risk of extinction.

Agile frogs

Around 40% of amphibian species face the risk of extinction, which makes them the most threatened vertebrates on the earth. As temperatures continue to climb, scientists are asking whether increased sex reversal could affect the long-term survival of amphibian populations.

To answer this, a group of researchers turned to agile frogs in Hungary. They found that sex-reversed wild males sire fewer offspring – which are in turn more vulnerable to heat and infectious disease. These disadvantages could together speed up population declines as the planet keeps warming.

The results were published in *Science Advances* on September 3.

In agile frogs as in mammals, the sex at birth is determined by chromosomes. Two X chromosomes make a genetic female whereas an X and a Y make a genetic male. But excessive heat in the tadpole stage can override that genetic recipe and turn some genetically female tadpoles into physically normal and fertile male tadpoles.

"Theoretical models suggest that this threat can be mitigated, up to a certain severity of climate change, for example XX males siring all-XX offspring," said Veronika Bokony, the study's lead author and researcher at the HUN-REN Centre for Agricultural Research. However, "this mitigating effect can be lost if sex-reversed individuals cannot participate in reproduction."

Chance of mating

Bokony *et al*. first looked at whether animals whose sex differs from their genetic sex reproduce just as successfully in the wild. They paired 20 sex-reversed males with 20 sex-concordant males, matched for body size and arrival time at the breeding ponds, two traits known to affect mating success. They let each male mate with a female.

The team then tracked whether the female laid eggs, how long it took, and whether the eggs developed into tadpoles.

The team found that sex-reversed males were just as capable of winning mates and fertilised eggs did develop into tadpoles. However, sex-reversed males did not have an equal chance at mating. About one-third of females paired with sex-reversed males laid only part of their eggs, called the split clutch strategy in which they saved the rest for a better mate.

In an experimental set-up, females had no choice, so sex-reversed males could still coerce the female into mating and sire a clutch. "Had they been free in a real mating aggregation, this could have allowed the female to find another male who could replace the sex-reversed male by fighting," Dr. Bokony said.

Artificial heatwave

So the researchers turned to breeding ponds in the wild. They sampled more than a hundred egg masses from 16 different populations and found that even though the sex-reversed male agile frogs made up roughly 20% of the wild populations, only 4% of egg clutches belonged to them.

"This suggests that when the frogs mate freely, the sex-reversed individuals are not as successful at becoming sires as the sex-concordant males," Dr. Bokony said.

The few offspring they did sire were also not in the clear. As researchers tracked the development of lab-reared tadpoles, they found that 61% of the offspring of sex-reversed males underwent sex reversal, developing as males despite being genetically female. Only 17% of offspring of sex-concordant males did, however.

"We were suspicious that sex reversal might have negative consequences on individual fitness and on population viability," Dr. Bokony said.

A warming climate is also amplifying the threat of infectious diseases. The pathogen ranavirus is of particular concern: in some instances, it has wiped out more than 90% of tadpoles in a single event.

To understand how well these offspring could withstand such climate-driven stressors, researchers exposed eggs from sex-reversed and sex-concordant males to an artificial heat wave along with ranavirus. Under high temperatures, tadpoles of sex-reversed males carried higher viral loads.

With lower paternity, higher rates of sex reversal in offspring, and greater disease susceptibility all being plausible outcomes, the team turned to computer models to test how these combined pressures could affect wild agile frog populations.

Higher extinction risk

"What happens in the laboratory and what occurs in the field are two different matters, and the strength of this study lies in the assessment of the impact of sex reversal in the wild," University of Canberra professor Arthur Georges, who was not involved in the study, said.

Their results showed small populations were especially vulnerable, since losing even a few breeding females could affect a population's ability to reproduce.

While some populations may already have begun declining, others could disappear within 60 to 70 years as heat-driven sex reversal pushed populations towards more males with fewer females to mate with.

When the model factored in the mortality from ranavirus among the offspring of sex-reversed males, population decline began roughly 10 years earlier and extinction came about 9.5 years sooner.

Without ranavirus, populations still declined about eight years earlier – but the extinction occurred only about two years earlier.

"We, as scientists, underestimate the number of sex-reversed individuals in populations and species," Dominique Potvin, associate professor at the University of the Sunshine Coast, Australia, said.

She added that scientists need to know how the environment is affecting sex reversal and affecting the long-term survival of species to update their interpretations and management strategies for conservation.

(Rupsy Khurana is science communication and outreach lead at the National Centre for Biological Science, Bengaluru. khurana.rupsy@gmail.com)

BIG SHOT

The world's oldest-known terrestrial animal, an Aldabra giant tortoise named Jonathan (left) estimated to be about 194 years old, may owe his extraordinary longevity to a combination of genetic traits and an ability to keep key cellular systems functioning in a more youthful way, according to scientists. REUTERS

WHAT IS IT?

Type I and type II errors

Vasudevan Mukunth

The null hypothesis is a cornerstone of scientific experiments. It is the hypothesis that an experiment tests. For example, if a hospital is testing a new drug, the null hypothesis will be that the drug has no effect.

In this scenario, scientists are vulnerable to making two kinds of mistakes. One, the type I error, happens when a scientist rejects a null hypothesis that is actually true: they conclude the drug works when in fact it does not. This is called a false positive. In a type II error, a scientist does not reject a null hypothesis even though it is actually false, i.e. a false negative.

There are different ways to measure, and prevent, these mistakes. Often the most effective one is to ensure all involved parties have more information during the test. This way, scientists do not have to work with a too-tight false positive limit or a too-loose false negative error limit.

The Election Commission of India (ECI) is currently conducting a special intensive revision (SIR) of the electoral rolls where both these errors are in play. Say a registered voter is eligible. A false positive error happens if ECI officials wrongly remove that voter's name from the electoral rolls. A false negative error occurs if officials include a name on the rolls whereas that person is ineligible to vote.

There are different ways to track and prevent type-I and type-II errors. Representative photo. QUILIA/UNSPLASH

A good way to reduce both types of error rates would be for all stakeholders — including the ECI and people — is to have more information, e.g. data from the new Census, opportunities to challenge decisions, and independent audits.

For feedback and suggestions for 'Science', please write to **science@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Daily page'

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Number of FIRs registered by Delhi Police over CJP protest

20 Delhi Police have registered 20 FIRs in connection with the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP)-called protest demanding Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation. More than 7,000 people were detained across the national capital as over 30,000 police personnel were deployed to prevent protesters from reaching Jantar Mantar. PTI

FDI inflows this quarter from India's largest source, Japan

5.71 in $ billion. Japan has emerged as the largest source of foreign direct investment into India during April-June of the current fiscal year, according to government data. FDI inflows from Japan stood at $5.71 billion in the first quarter of 2026-27, surpassing the $3.74 billion India received from the country during the entire 2025-26 fiscal year. PTI

Maximum temperature levels recorded in the national capital

32 degrees Celsius. Delhi recorded a maximum temperature of 32 degrees Celsius on Sunday, which was 2.2 notches below the season's average, according to the India Meteorological Department (IMD). The minimum temperature was logged at 24.4 degrees Celsius, which was 3.4 notches above the season's average, the IMD data showed. PTI

Number of migrants dead in Djibouti boat accident

109 At least 109 migrants died, including 15 children, and 116 went missing when a boat sank off the shores of Djibouti on the night of October 8-9, a UN agency said on Sunday. Survivors said the vessel — which was carrying 305 people from Djibouti to Yemen — capsized north of the Djibouti town of Obock. About 80 people survived the shipwreck. AFP

Number of people who died in U.S. Cyclone Isaias

4 Cyclone Isaias was the first hurricane of an Atlantic season tamed by a historic El Niño weather phenomenon, and the first hurricane since 2024 to hit the U.S. mainland. At least four deaths were linked to the storm, including two people killed when trees fell onto homes. Nearly 700,000 customers were without power by midday. AFP

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Why UAPA demands urgent reform

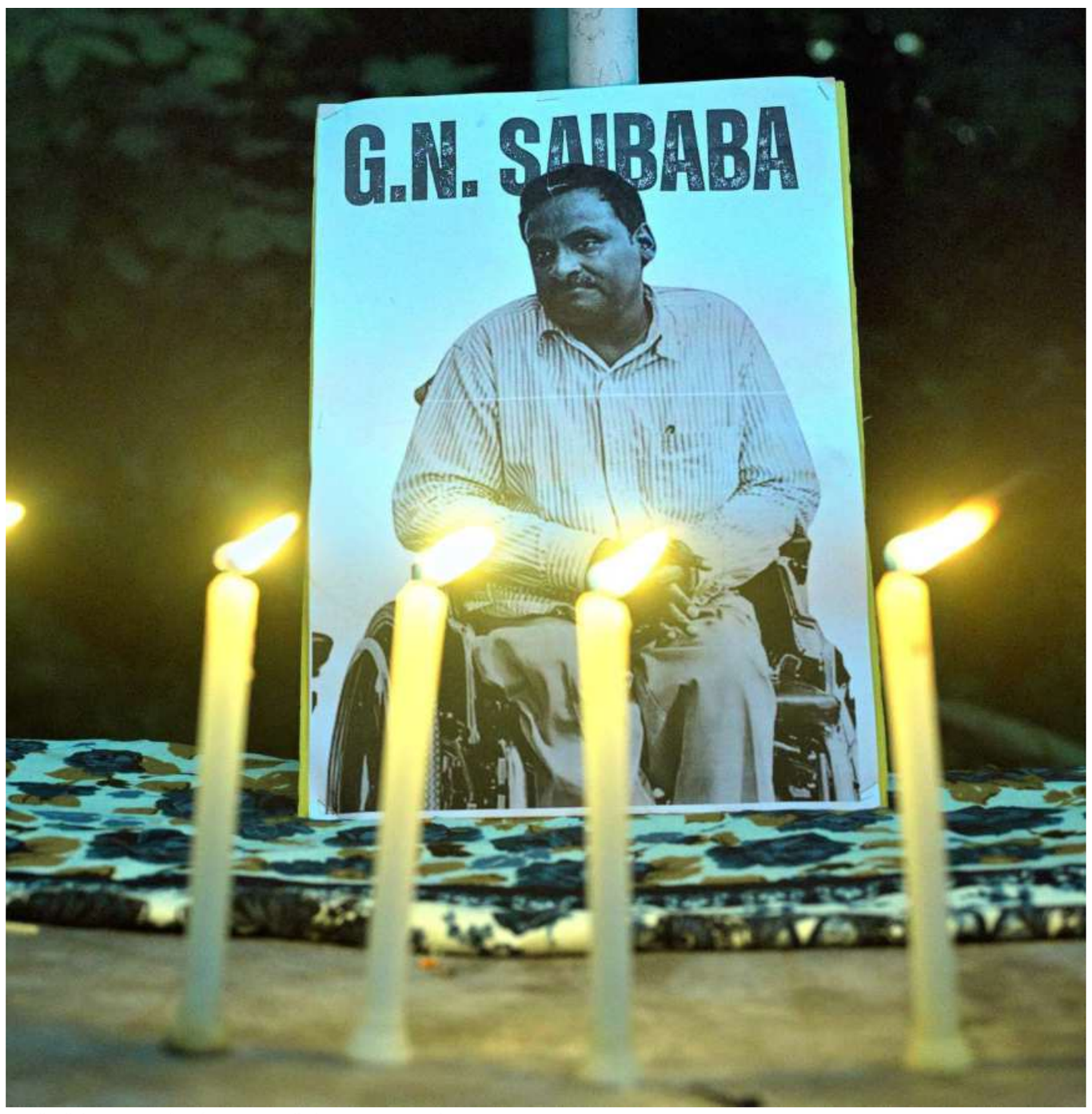
UAPA's vague provisions, stringent bail conditions and inconsistent judicial interpretations have enabled the prolonged imprisonment of activists, scholars and journalists without trial; Prof. G.N. Saibaba's experience shows the urgent need to reform a legal regime that undermines civil liberties, due process and rule of law

LETTER & SPIRIT

Gautam Bhatia

October 12 marks the second death anniversary of Professor G.N. Saibaba. Prof. Saibaba was a professor at Delhi University who was 90% physically disabled. He was arrested under the Unlawful Activities Prevention Act (UAPA) in 2014, on allegations of having links with Maoists. Denied bail, he remained in prison until a trial court convicted him in 2017 and sentenced him to life imprisonment – a judgment that this writer, in the pages of this newspaper, criticised at the time as being based entirely on guilt by association and insinuation.

Vindication eventually arrived in 2024, when the Bombay High Court acquitted him of all charges. By then, Professor Saibaba had spent a decade in prison, much of it in solitary confinement. In prison, his health had further deteriorated, and soon after his release, he passed away.



Candles lit in memory of Professor G.N. Saibaba at JNU on October 13, 2024. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

THE GIST

- Professor G.N. Saibaba was acquitted by the Bombay High Court in 2024 after spending a decade in prison under the UAPA, but died soon after his release as his health had deteriorated
- Activists, scholars and journalists accused under the UAPA, including those in the Bhima Koregaon and Delhi riots cases, have spent years in prison without trial, with bail often granted only after prolonged incarceration
- The Supreme Court has overturned judicial attempts to narrow the UAPA's provisions, while inconsistent interpretations of the law and delays in trials have expanded State discretion and weakened safeguards against arbitrary imprisonment

A law that punishes dissent

The anniversary of Professor Saibaba's death is an occasion to reflect on a legal regime that is designed to – quite literally – imprison dissent and deny justice. Over the years, the UAPA has been used to criminalise political opposition. Following the violence at the Bhima Koregaon commemoration event in 2018, UAPA charges were brought against 16 scholars and activists, all of whom were jailed. Eight years later, the trial has yet to begin, and the court has yet to frame charges against the accused.

Meanwhile, Father Stan Swamy died in custody after his health deteriorated. One after another, 14 of the remaining accused were granted bail, but only after spending years in prison without trial. Their bail conditions remain draconian and restrictive, imposing multiple reporting conditions, restricting travel and severely constraining their lives. The 16th prisoner, lawyer Surendra Gadling, was also granted bail in the case but remained in prison in connection with another case.

Similarly, after the Delhi riots in 2020, UAPA charges were levelled against multiple student leaders, scholars, and activists, accusing them of participating in, or being the brains behind, the riots. Notably, there was no direct evidence against any of these people, only vague charges of conspiracy and of being the "intellectual architects" of the riots.

While a few of these individuals were granted bail soon after, many students and scholars remained in jail for years, with their bail applications denied at all levels of the judiciary. It was only in early 2026, after more than five years in jail, that five of the seven appellants were granted bail by the Supreme Court. However, the Supreme Court denied bail to the remaining two – Sharjeel Imam and Umar Khalid – on the basis that they were "intellectual architects." The term "intellectual architect" is unknown to law and rests entirely on surmises and conjectures. The court also took the unusual step of effectively preventing Imam and Khalid from applying for bail for a year. It has now been more than six years – almost 10% of an average human lifespan – of imprisonment without trial. In the meantime, Khalid has published a book from prison, while Imam continues to work on his PhD, despite significant difficulties in accessing research materials.

In a third example, Khurram Parvez, a Kashmiri activist and the coordinator of the Jammu and Kashmir Coalition of Civil Society (JKCCS), was arrested under the UAPA in 2021 on allegations of terror financing and promoting secessionism. On March 20, 2023, a journalist, Irfan Mehraj, was also arrested and imprisoned in the case. The two were eventually granted bail in July 2026, after Parvez had spent five years in prison without trial.

The list of people who have spent years in jail under UAPA thus spans the length and breadth of the country: it also includes Soni Sori, the Adivasi leader who was allegedly tortured while in prison and eventually acquitted of all charges, Akhil Gogoi – the Assamese anti-CAA activist – and Siddique Kappan, the Kerala journalist who was arrested while travelling to Uttar Pradesh to cover the Hathras gangrape case, and spent two years in jail before eventually being granted bail by the Supreme Court.

The list also includes many other nameless people who do not have the same degree of public prominence, but have spent months and years of their lives in prison, under a law that defines offences in the vaguest of terms, and then makes the grant of bail virtually impossible.

Vague definitions

The UAPA, for example, criminalises "membership" of unlawful organisations without clarifying what the word "membership" means. It has a similar host of provisions that carry broad and vague wording, and which are susceptible to multiple interpretations – including, at their extreme, mere sloganeering or possession of literature.

The courts have not helped. On two occasions, judges have attempted to bring precision and narrowness to the UAPA to prevent, or at least mitigate, some of its excesses. Both attempts were overturned by the Supreme Court. In 2011, a Bench of the court restricted the term "membership" to "active membership", which in turn was defined to mean "incitement to violence." However, in 2023, acting under its "review jurisdiction" – which is only meant to correct "errors on the face of the record" – the Supreme Court overturned this judgment.

Similarly, in an early bail judgment in the Delhi riots cases, the Delhi High Court undertook an extensive analysis of the UAPA's "terrorism" clauses and gave them a specific, concrete interpretation to prevent wide discretion in their application. On appeal, however, the Supreme Court ruled that the judgment would "not be treated as precedent", thus rendering it effectively worthless as a statement of law. Thus, the UAPA's terms remain exceedingly broad and undefined, allowing State authorities wide leeway to bring almost any conduct within its scope by tenuously linking it to terrorism or unlawful activity.

The barriers to bail

Once that is done, the UAPA then makes the grant of bail extremely hard, by requiring the judge to deny bail if, on a reading of the police chargesheet, a prima facie case appears to be made out. Here again, courts have not helped: while one set of judges has accorded a degree of strict scrutiny to police chargesheets, another set has adopted an "eyes wide shut" approach that grants excessive deference to the police version. This inconsistency makes the grant of bail under the UAPA extremely judge-centric. Along with this, courts have also been inconsistent on the consequences of delay: the Supreme Court, for example, did not seem to think that five years in prison without trial was "excessive" delay when denying bail to Imam and Khalid, while other courts have held that five years does constitute excessive delay (for example, in the Khurram Parvez case).

All this leads to a state of affairs that is contrary to the rule of law and contrary to any legal system worth the name: a vague law with stringent punishments, that continues to be interpreted in a way that expands State discretion rather than contains it, and whose result then is long years of imprisonment without trial. The death anniversary of Professor Saibaba, one of the starkest victims of this system, reminds us yet again that an urgent rethink and reset of this system is necessary.

(Gautam Bhatia is a Delhi-based lawyer)

CACHE

Norway is not alone in addressing privacy risks surrounding wearable devices, as a patchwork of regulations and venue-specific restrictions are in progress across Europe and North America. REUTERS

Why is Norway considering a temporary smart glasses ban?

Norway is proposing temporary restrictions on smart glasses in public, sensitive spaces over concerns about covert recording, facial recognition and violations of privacy, as other countries explore similar curbs; this could affect device sales and push manufacturers to strengthen privacy safeguards

Haider Ali Khan

The story so far:

European regulators are training their sights on smart glasses, as the wearable device equipped with high-definition cameras, ambient audio recording, and artificial intelligence is becoming common in Europe, blurring the lines between technological innovation and citizens' privacy.

Norway is taking the lead as its government prepares a proposal seeking a temporary ban on smart glasses in select public and sensitive locations. Led by Minister of Digitalisation and Public Governance Torgeir Micaelsen, the initiative pauses device usage in places where individuals expect personal privacy.

What does the proposal seek?

The temporary restrictions target places frequented by children, including schools, playgrounds, and youth clubs, healthcare facilities, fitness centres, locker rooms, public beaches, parks, museums, and concert venues. Crucially, the government is not proposing a ban on sales of the devices or prohibiting their use in private.

Instead, the proposal is asking an expert committee to evaluate the technological challenges and formulate lasting legal frameworks. Oslo has already banned smart glasses across municipal schools.

The core argument behind Norway's intervention centres on the lack of consent in public spaces. Traditional smartphones require users to visibly hold up a device to record video or snap photos, providing a clear signal to surrounding people. In contrast, smart glasses allow wearers to capture high-resolution imagery, record ambient audio, or live-stream video directly at eye level without offering clear cues to bystanders.

This creates a surveillance system where citizens cannot easily determine whether they are being recorded. Privacy risks are especially acute in sensitive settings like changing rooms and medical clinics, or where unauthorised filming of children raises safety concerns. Furthermore, officials have highlighted risks surrounding real-time facial recognition software. When combined with AI eyewear, facial recognition could enable wearers to instantly identify strangers, access personal data, or facilitate doxxing. Norway's proposed rules acknowledge that traditional privacy frameworks were not designed for head-worn, ambient recording technology.

Is any other country attempting a similar moratorium?

Norway is not alone in addressing privacy risks surrounding wearable devices, as a patchwork of regulations and venue-specific restrictions are in progress across Europe and North America.

In the Netherlands and Germany, eyewear retailer Hans Anders suspended sales of Meta's Ray-Ban smart glasses across its Dutch and Belgian stores while awaiting regulatory clarity. Dutch lawmakers have discussed rules that await guidance from the European Data Protection Board (EDPB). Meanwhile, Hamburg is exploring regional restrictions.

The UK Cinema Association established guidelines restricting or prohibiting camera-equipped glasses in movie theatres to combat piracy and protect the privacy of viewers. Additionally, courts in England and Wales require visitors to surrender smart glasses at security checkpoints.

In the United States, several nightclubs, gyms, and courts in New York have implemented localised bans. California's governor vetoed legislation penalising covert recording in private spaces, but debate continues among state policymakers on next steps.

In Bangkok, smart glasses use is restricted in certain pubs and public places.

How are manufacturers of smart glasses adapting to this regulatory landscape?

To address privacy concerns, hardware manufacturers have built technical safeguards into current-generation devices. Devices such as Ray-Ban Meta glasses feature a white light-emitting diode (LED) on the frame beside the lens. The LED blinks when capturing photos and stays lit continuously during video recording.

Manufacturers have deployed firmware updates that detect if the LED indicator is covered or obstructed. If light obstruction is detected, the system automatically disables the camera's functionality. Devices enforce caps on continuous recording duration and play audible shutter sounds when taking photos.

But privacy advocates have said that small LED lights remain difficult to spot in bright, sunlit conditions or crowded environments, rendering hardware safeguards insufficient for complete bystander protection.

How will the moratorium impact device sales?

Although Norway's proposal focuses on restricting device usage rather than banning sales, the commercial impact on manufacturers could be substantial. The primary selling point of smart glasses is their seamless integration into daily public life. Restricting their use in public spaces like parks, beaches, shopping centres, and fitness clubs undermines their utility, rendering a versatile daily-use accessory into a device restricted to home use.

In addition, voluntary retail suspensions such as the sales halt by Hans Anders create immediate revenue hits in the European market. Regulatory uncertainty across different regions introduces consumer hesitation, discouraging buyers who worry about purchasing expensive hardware that might soon face usage restrictions in public.

How might smart glasses makers tweak functionality?

To comply with evolving privacy standards and maintain consumer trust, manufacturers may likely re-engineer both hardware and software features by implementing larger, brighter, or colour-shifting LED indicators, alongside louder audio signals that cannot be silenced.

Software updates could incorporate AI-driven face-blurring and audio pitch modification, redacting bystander identities before footage is saved or streamed. Smart glasses could utilise GPS data to automatically disable recording capabilities when entering designated privacy zones like schools, hospitals, or locker rooms. Manufacturers can explicitly block facial recognition software and APIs to prevent real-time profiling in public spaces.

Companies are expanding lines to include audio-focused smart glasses without cameras (such as Ray-Ban Meta Audio), catering to users who want AI features without privacy concerns.

THE DAILY QUIZ

Please send in your answers to dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

Test your knowledge of the Salem witch trials, where mass hysteria, religious fanaticism and judicial injustice led to accusations and executions

Prathmesh Kher

QUESTION 1
In which years did the Salem witch trials take place?

QUESTION 2
Which accused farmer was executed on August 19, 1692, after maintaining his innocence during the trials?

QUESTION 3
Which accused man was subjected to *peine forte et dure*, a form of judicial torture involving the application of heavy weights, after refusing to enter a plea?

QUESTION 4
How many people were hanged during the Salem witch trials, and how many others died in prison?

QUESTION 5
What was the name of the enslaved woman whose confession played a pivotal role in the early witchcraft accusations?

Visual Question:
This 1953 play by Arthur Miller dramatises the Salem witch trials and uses them as an allegory for political persecution in 20th-century America. Name the play. FRED FEHL/FRED FEHL COLLECTION, NEW YORK PUBLIC LIBRARY FOR THE PERFORMING ARTS

Questions and Answers to the previous day's daily quiz: 1. In 2018, no Nobel Prize in Literature was announced. It was postponed and awarded along with the 2019 Nobel. Why? Who won the 2018 Nobel Prize in Literature? **Ans: Due to a sexual abuse and financial crimes scandal involving Jean-Claude Arnault, an influential figure on the Swedish cultural scene and husband of Academy member and poet Katarina Frostenson; Olga Tokarczuk**
2. Which singer-songwriter won the Nobel Prize in Literature in 2016? **Ans: Bob Dylan**
3. This Nobel laureate's work includes *Sula, Beloved, The Bluest Eye, Jazz*, etc. She was the first Black woman to win the Nobel Prize in Literature. **Ans: Toni Morrison**
4. An upcoming dystopian science fiction film is based on a book by a Nobel laureate. Name the book and the author. Ans: ***Klara and the Sun*** by Kazuo Ishiguro
5. This philosopher, political activist, and writer was the only awardee to decline the Nobel Prize in Literature. **Ans: Jean-Paul Sartre**
Visual: This image shows the poet and novelist receiving the news that he won the Nobel Prize in Literature. However, he later rejected the award. **Ans: Boris Pasternak**
Early Birds: Aman kumar | Tamal Biswas | Arun Kumar Singh | Gauri Malviya

KNOW YOUR ENGLISH

I am afraid we can't offer you the job

She refused to collaborate with her temperamental colleague

S. Upendran

Is it okay to use the word 'dinner' for an afternoon meal? (V Janaki, Trivandrum)
Yes, it is; on Christmas Day, some people have their traditional Christmas dinner around two in the afternoon. The word 'dinner' comes from the French 'disner', and in 13th-century England, the word was used to refer to the first meal of the day – anything that people had to eat between early morning and noon. So, what we today refer to as 'breakfast' and 'lunch' was called 'dinner' in the past. With the passage of time, however, the terms 'breakfast' and 'lunch' were introduced to refer to what we eat in the morning and afternoon – and as a result, the word 'dinner' was used to refer to the last meal of the day. In countries like Britain, 'dinner' continues to be used to refer to the main meal of the day – a meal where an individual's intake is the maximum. So, if your main meal is in the afternoon, you can call it 'dinner'.

We're planning to have an early dinner before leaving for the airport.

What is the difference between 'collaborate' and 'corroborate'? (J Mukund, Hyderabad)
Although the two words sound somewhat similar, they have very different meanings. In terms of pronunciation, both words have the same number of syllables – four each. The vowels in the first and third syllables sound like the 'a' in 'china'. The second syllable in 'collaborate' is pronounced like the word 'lab', while in the case of 'corroborate', it sounds like the word 'rob'. The final syllable in both words is pronounced 'rate'. The two words are pronounced 'ke-LAB-e-rate' and 'ke-ROB-e-rate' respectively, with the stress on the second syllable.

When you 'collaborate' with someone, you work with him on something – it could be a project, report, etc. You team up with another individual; in other words, the two of you 'labour' (col-labor-ate) together! This is one way of remembering the meaning of the word.

Satish is very temperamental. No one wants to collaborate with him on the project.

When you 'corroborate', you provide evidence or proof for something that you or someone else has said. It is a word frequently used in a court of law and in the field of science.

Our findings did not corroborate the new hypothesis.

What is the meaning of 'I'm afraid' in the sentence "I'm afraid I can't help you"? (S Vinita, Vizag)
In isolation, the word 'afraid' is normally used to mean 'scared'. Some children, for example, are afraid of dogs, while many are afraid of being alone in the dark. In the expression 'I'm afraid', however, 'afraid' does not express fear. In informal contexts, the expression is used when you have bad news to pass on to someone; the use of 'afraid' is meant to soften the blow of the message you are about to deliver. When you preface a statement with 'I'm afraid', it means 'I'm sorry to say'.
upendrankye@gmail.com

Word of the day

Polemical:
of or involving dispute or controversy

Synonyms: contentious, aggressive, stubborn, irritable, disputatious

Usage: *The politician is known for his polemical remarks.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/polemical

International Phonetic Alphabet: /pəlemɪkəl/

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